CCS (Implementation of NPS) Rules, 2021 & Official Updates — Exam-Ready Revision Deck

Version: 2.2 (fully revised & audited; v2.2 = PDF edition + Module 13 case studies N-099–N-120 + Appendix K obsolete→current table)

Law as on: 01.11.2026 (1 November 2026)

Prepared for: Indian departmental / SAS / AAO / UPSC LDCE-type exam aspirants

Scope: CCS (Implementation of NPS) Rules, 2021 (G.S.R. 227(E)) — Rules 1–30 & Forms 1, 2, 3, 4-A to 4-E; CCS (Payment of Gratuity under NPS) Rules, 2021 & 2025 Amendment; CCS (Implementation of UPS under NPS) Rules, 2025; PFRDA Exit/Withdrawal Amendment Regulations (Dec 2025 & 13.07.2026); Railway Services (Implementation of NPS) Rules, 2025; AIS (Implementation of NPS) Rules, 2026; DoPPW/CPAO/CGA OMs 2022–2026; Income-tax Act, 1961 & Income-tax Act, 2025 (w.e.f. 01.04.2026).

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Source note. Every card carries a **Source/Status** tag: `Bare Rules` (text of G.S.R. 227(E) / sister Gazette rules), `DoPPW OM`, `PFRDA Regulation`, `Income-tax Act`, `Current-affairs update`, or `[VERIFY]` (claim could not be confirmed from an authoritative source in this audit — see the [VERIFY] Register, Appendix I). Gazette numbers, OM numbers, dates and 2025–2026 current-affairs items were cross-checked against official/near-official sources (egazette, DoPT/DoPPW portals, PFRDA, CPAO, PIB) where possible.

Disclaimer. This deck is an exam-study aid, not legal advice. For litigation or quasi-judicial purposes, rely only on the Official Gazette text and the latest DoPPW/PFRDA orders. Where this deck and an official source differ, the official source prevails.

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M1 — Preliminary & Application (Rules 1–2)

The CCS (Implementation of NPS) Rules, 2021 were made by the President under the **proviso to Article 309 AND clause (5) of Article 148**, after consultation with the **C&AG** for IA&AD personnel; notified as **G.S.R. 227(E) dt. 30.03.2021** (DoPPW) and in force from **publication in the Official Gazette** (Rule 1(2)) — prospectively, though they govern servants appointed **on or after 01.01.2004** (Rule 2). Eight categories are excluded under **Rule 2(a)–(h)**: Railway servants (now Railway NPS Rules 2025), casual/daily-rated, contingency-paid, AIS members (now AIS NPS Rules 2026), locally recruited staff in Indian missions abroad, contract employees, persons governed by the Constitution/other law, and persons to whom CCS (Pension) Rules apply by special/general order (e.g., pre-22.12.2003 vacancy cases per DoPPW OM dt. 03.03.2023; pre-2004 temporary-status casual labourers regularised later; mobility/technical-resignation cases per OM dt. 20.10.2023). The Rules do **not** apply suo-moto to autonomous bodies (OM dt. 25.10.2024) — EPFO adopted them expressly by its 2025 Staff Regulations with the UPSC-consultation proviso switched off. UPS (G.S.R. 599(E) dt. 02.09.2025, effective 01.04.2025) is an **option under NPS**, not a repeal.

M2 — Definitions (Rule 3)

Rule 3(1) defines 22 terms in clauses **(a)–(v)**: Accredited Bank (incl. RBI), Accumulated Pension Corpus, Annuity, Annuity Service Provider (IRDAI-registered + PFRDA-empanelled), Authority/PFRDA (Sec. 3(1) PFRDA Act, 2013, incl. interim PFRDA), CRA (Sec. 27), NPS (Sec. 20), DDO (Gazetted), CDDO (assignment account; CPWD/Forest/CPWA Code depts), Defence Services (MoD + DAD civilians not under Army/Air Force/Navy Acts), Emoluments (= Rule 5), Foreign Service (pay not from Consolidated Fund of India/State/UT — includes domestic PSU deputation!), Government, HOD (Sch. I DFPR + President), HOO (Rule 14 DFPR Gazetted + Competent Authority), IPA, Local Fund administered by Government ("complete and direct control"), PAO (incl. AG), Pension Fund (Sec. 27(3)), PRAN, Subscriber, Trustee Bank (Banking Regulation Act, 1949). Rule 3(2): residuary definitions from FR 1922, CCS (Pension) Rules (now 2021), PFRDA Act 2013, PFRDA Regulations.

M3 — Registration (Rule 4)

On joining, submit **CSRF + Form 1 + Form 2 immediately to the HOO** (Rule 4(1)). Chain: HOO→DDO within **3 working days of joining** (4(2)); DDO→PAO/CDDO within **3 working days of receipt** (4(3)); PAO/CDDO→CRA (online **plus signed physical copy**) within **3 working days of receipt** (4(4)). Reverse: CRA→PAO→DDO→HOO "immediately" (4(5)–(7)); HOO records PRAN in CSRF & Service Book and pastes a **certified copy** of CSRF within **5 working days** (4(8)). First contribution credited within **20 days of application OR last day of joining month, whichever is LATER** (4(9)). If PRAN is pending at first salary, salary is paid after withholding 10%, later credited **with Rule 8 PPF interest** (4(10)–(11)).

M4 — Emoluments (Rule 5)

NPS "emoluments" = **Basic Pay (FR 9(21)(a)(i)) + NPA + DA only** — HRA, TA, special pay, deputation allowance excluded. Paid leave: actual leave salary + DA/NPA (5(2)). Absence/EOL: pay actually drawn; nil if none (5(3)). Suspension: subsistence allowance + DA on it (5(4)). Deputation **in India**: actual pay (5(5)); **foreign service (incl. domestic PSU!) or deputation outside India**: notional parent-cadre pay (5(6)). Re-employed pensioner: pay + the pension element deducted from pay (5(7)).

M5 — Contributions, Interest & Investment (Rules 6–9)

Employee **10%**, Government **14%** (w.e.f. 01.04.2019) of emoluments, both **rounded up to the next higher rupee** (6(1), 7(1), 7(5)). During suspension the employee may opt out; if he opts out the Government also pays nil (7(3) 1st proviso); if the suspension period is finally treated as duty/paid leave, both shares are recalculated with **PPF interest** on the difference (provisos to 6(2)/7(3)). Proviso to 7(1): for leave on **medical ground / civil commotion / useful higher studies**, Government pays 14% on **notional full emoluments** even if leave salary is nil or half. Monthly calendar: DDO bill by **20th** (6(8)); PAO uploads SCF & generates Transaction ID by **25th** (6(10)(i)); remittance to Trustee Bank via Accredited Bank by **last working day** — **March contribution on the first working day of April** (proviso to 6(10)(ii)); same for Government share (7(6)). Delay compensation: Rule 8 — PPF rate, credited within **30 days** of principal credit; 2004–2012 period per DFS Notification F.No. 1/3/2016-PR dt. 31.01.2019 and DoE OM No. 1(21)/EV/2018 dt. 12.04.2019. Responsibility fixed by **HOD or CCA**; liability determined like delayed TDS under **Sec. 201(1A)** IT Act, 1961. Rule 9: PFRDA notifies pension funds/investment pattern — Default (≤15% equity, 3 PSU PFMs), Scheme G, LC25, LC50, and (from late 2025) **LC75 & BLC** for Central Govt employees under NPS & UPS.

M6 — Rule 10 (death/disability option)

Every subscriber exercises **Form 1** (OPS/EOP vs NPS) at joining — HOO verifies and keeps it in the Service Book, copy goes HOO→DDO→PAO→CRA, PAO enters it online (10(1)–(2)). **Form 2** (family details) stays with the HOO (10(3)); changes recorded in Col. 7 — original Form 2 is never substituted during service; judicially separated spouse counts; disabled child needs a Civil Surgeon-rank medical certificate both at reporting and at claim (10(3)(c), cross-ref proviso to Rule 54(6) CCS (Pension) Rules 1972 = Rule 50(9) of 2021 Rules). Option revisable **any number of times** during service; on invalidation discharge a **fresh option** must be offered (10(4)); on death in service the **last option is final** — family cannot revise (10(5)). Defaults (10(6)): OPS/EOP if death/invalidation occurs **before 15 years' service or within 3 years of notification** (window closed 31.03.2024); otherwise **NPS** (10(6)(iii)). If the OPS option is **infructuous** (no eligible family member), it is deemed invalid and the **full NPS corpus** goes to nominee/legal heirs (10(7)).

M7 — Rules 11–13 (superannuation, VRS, premature retirement)

Rule 11: superannuation (incl. post-extension) → PFRDA superannuation exit. Rule 12: VRS after **20 years' regular service** (ALL sanctioned leave incl. EOL & study leave counts; casual/ad-hoc/contract service does not), **3 months' written notice** to the appointing authority; not refused → deemed accepted at expiry (12(2) proviso); notice curtailable (12(3)); withdrawal only with approval, requested **≥15 days before** intended retirement (12(4) proviso); **not available** on ITEC assignments, postings abroad, or foreign-Government contract assignments until **1 year after resuming charge in India** (proviso (i)–(iii)); SVRS surplus retirees and absorption cases excluded (12(5)); VRS exit is at **superannuation level (60:40)**, not 20:80 (12(6)); IPA continuation/deferment option (12(7)). Rule 13: FR 56(j)/(k) premature/voluntary retirement and DoPT SVRS (OM No. 25013/6/2001-Estt.(A) dt. 28.02.2002) also get **superannuation-level exit** + SVRS ex-gratia (proviso to 13(1)).

M8 — Rules 14–15 (resignation & absorption)

Ordinary resignation (14(1)): **premature exit (max 20% lump sum / min 80% annuity; 100% if corpus ≤ ₹5 lakh)**, but payout only after **90 days** from effective resignation (1st proviso); if the subscriber dies within 90 days, pay immediately (2nd proviso); may continue same PRAN as non-Government subscriber (3rd proviso). **Technical resignation** to another NPS-covered Govt dept: same PRAN continues (14(2)); to a **non-NPS** Govt dept: **superannuation-level (60:40) exit** or continue same PRAN (provisos). Withdrawal of resignation in public interest only if all five conditions of 14(3)(a)–(e) are met (not temporary; compelling reasons + material change; clean intervening conduct; absence ≤ 90 days; post available) — and **never** if resignation was to join a private company/PSU/autonomous body (14(4)); allowed withdrawal deemed to condone the break (14(5)). Rule 15: permitted absorption in PSU/AB → deemed retirement, **60:40 exit**; if NPS exists in the new body, same PRAN **must** continue (1st proviso); if not, exit or continue PRAN (2nd proviso). Date of absorption per Explanation (1)(i)–(iii).

M9 — Rules 16–20 (invalidation, disablement, penalties, death)

Rule 16: Sec. 20 RPwD Act, 2016 protection first (disability certificate under RPwD Rules, 2017); mandatory counselling before processing an invalidation request (2nd proviso to 16(2)); application to HOD (spouse, failing which family member, may apply if he is incapacitated). Medical examination: HOO/HOD requests within **15 days**, examination within **30 days**; **Medical Board** for all Gazetted and non-Gazetted with pay **exceeding ₹54,000 p.m.** (FR 9(21)), else Civil Surgeon/DMO; lady doctor on the Board for a woman; certificate in **Form 3**; lower post if fit for less laborious service and willing (16(3)–(8)). On invalidation/disablement: if OPS/EOP option/default — IPA closed, **Government share + returns to Government account**, employee share + returns paid to subscriber/nominee **in lump sum** (16(9)–(12), 17(1)–(4), 20(2)); if NPS option — **superannuation-level (60:40) exit** (16(11), 17(3)). Rule 18: dismissal/removal/compulsory retirement as penalty → corpus **NOT forfeited**, only premature (20:80) exit; same-PRAN continuation option; gratuity rules still apply (18(2)). Rule 19: pending departmental/judicial proceedings at retirement do **not** affect corpus — full 60:40 paid; only gratuity withheld (19(2)). Rule 20: death in service — OPS/EOP family pension if so opted; govt share to Government account, employee share lump sum to PFRDA nominee/legal heir; death attributable to service → CCS (EOP) Rules, 2023. Invalidation/disablement discharge also gets **death-gratuity slab rates** without the 5-year minimum (OM dt. 28.10.2022).

M10 — Rules 21–30 (exit processing & residual)

Rule 21: HOD quarterly retirement list (1 Jan/Apr/Jul/Oct; to PAO by 31 Jan/30 Apr/31 Jul/31 Oct) for subscribers retiring in the next **12–15 months**; HOO promptly intimates non-superannuation exits to DDO/PAO (+ Directorate of Estates for allottees). Rule 22: HOO writes to Directorate of Estates ≥ **1 year** before retirement for NDC covering the period preceding **8 months** of retirement [VERIFY "8 months"]. Rule 23: claim to HOO **6 months before superannuation or on proceeding on LPR, whichever is EARLIER**; non-superannuation exits: immediately after orders; even online claims need a signed print-out to HOO; CRA generates Claim ID 6 months before superannuation. Rule 24: HOO→PAO (via DDO, Forms 4-A to 4-E) **4 months before** superannuation / **1 month after** other exits; PAO→CRA **1 month before** retirement; continuation/deferment option 15 days before superannuation in bare text (PFRDA Dec-2025 amendment removed the mandatory 15-day prior intimation; auto-continuation up to age 85). Rule 25: retirement on deputation to another Central dept — **borrowing** HOO; to State Govt/foreign service — **lending** HOO/cadre authority. Rule 26: Gazette notification (Gazetted) / office order (non-Gazetted) within **1 week**, copy to PAO. Rules 27–30: interpretation → MoPPGP; relaxation for undue hardship only with **MoPPGP concurrence**, reasons in writing (Rule 28); residuary matters per CCS (Pension) Rules/FR/SR/Govt orders if not repugnant (29(1)); repeal & saving (30).

M11 — Forms

Form 1 (Rule 10(1)): option OPS/EOP vs NPS on death/invalidation/disability — acknowledgement copy returned to servant. **Form 2** (Rule 10(3)): family details — original never substituted, changes in Col. 7 under HOO signature, all children/parents listed, judicially separated spouse included, fresh details at retirement. **Form 3** (Rule 16(7)): medical certificate (incapacity, less laborious fitness, "irregular or intemperate habits" clause, age by statement & appearance). **Forms 4-A to 4-E** (Rule 24(1)): HOO's covering letters to **PAO/AG through DDO** — 4-A: superannuation/VRS (Rule 12)/FR 56(k)/FR 56(j)/SVRS (all 60:40); 4-B: technical resignation/absorption; 4-C: resignation/penalty exits (20:80, 90-day rule); 4-D: invalidation/disablement; 4-E: death in service (incl. Rule 10(7) infructuous case).

M12 — OMs, amendments & sister rules (2022–2026)

Key verified items: DoPPW OMs 25–28.10.2022 (8361 series) & 07/11/14/25.10.2024 (8361(1)–(9)); OM 14.10.2024 (57/06/2021-P&PW(B)) refunding employee's NPS share + PPF interest w.e.f. 01.01.2004 for pre-2021 death/disablement cases (MH 0071 → 8342-00-117); OM 28.04.2022 (missing employees — family pension/arrears/gratuity; PRAN suspended; BSA Sec. 111 7-year presumption); OM 03.03.2023 (pre-22.12.2003 vacancies, option by 31.08.2023); OM 20.10.2023 (mobility); OM 25.10.2024 8361(8) (autonomous bodies not suo-moto covered) & 8361(9) (Form 1/2 campaign); FMA ₹1,000/month for NPS pensioners (OM 07.02.2025; DoE OM 16.04.2026 — automatic quarterly CPPC credit, November life certificate). PFRDA Dec-2025 Exit Amendment: Govt sector normal/death exit ≤ ₹8 lakh → 100% lump sum (or SLW/SUR); ₹8–12 lakh → up to ₹6 lakh lump sum + balance annuity/SUR (min 6 yrs); > ₹12 lakh → 60% lump + 40% annuity; premature exit ≤ ₹5 lakh → 100%, else 20:80; non-Govt sector > ₹12 lakh → 80:20; entry/exit age 85; partial withdrawal 4 times (4-year gap) before 60, unlimited with 3-year gap after 60, 25% of own contributions, skill-development/start-up purposes removed, loan-lien purpose added; missing persons 20% interim/80% after presumption of death; renunciation of citizenship → 100% lump sum. PFRDA Amendment Regulations 2026 (13.07.2026, Gazette 14.07.2026): Reg. 4A(2)–(4) — pension fund liable for outsourced entities. Gratuity: ₹20 lakh → **₹25 lakh** w.e.f. 01.01.2024 (OM dt. 30.05.2024, CCS (Pension) 2021 & Gratuity-under-NPS 2021 only; Oct-2025 clarification: not PSUs/banks/RBI/ABs); Amendment Rules 2025 (G.S.R. 258(E) dt. 24.04.2025): Rule 4A re-employment cap, 2/3 provisional gratuity on penalty compulsory retirement, 6-month FIR rule for missing persons. UPS Rules 2025 (G.S.R. 599(E) dt. 02.09.2025; DFS notification 24.01.2025; PFRDA regulations 19.03.2025; effective 01.04.2025): 10% employee + 10% Govt to individual corpus + 8.5% pool (18.5% total); assured payout 50% of last-12-month average basic pay for ≥25 yrs qualifying service (proportionate 10–25 yrs; min ₹10,000/month after ≥10 yrs) + DR; lump sum 1/10th of monthly emoluments per completed 6 months; gratuity up to ₹25 lakh (OM 18.06.2025); one-time switch back to NPS ≥12 months before superannuation / ≥3 months before VRS / at resignation or non-penal FR 56(j); barred in penalty/disciplinary cases; 4% differential at default pattern credited at exit. Railway NPS Rules 2025 (G.S.R. 735(E) dt. 01.10.2025; RBE 103/2025 dt. 08.10.2025; under proviso to Art. 309 only). AIS NPS Rules 2026 (G.S.R. 307(E) dt. 22.04.2026; DoPT under Sec. 3(1) AIS Act, 1951). Income-tax Act, 2025 w.e.f. 01.04.2026: old 80C/80CCD(1) → Sec. 123 + Sch. XV; old 80CCD → Sec. 124 (employer contribution 124(2) allowed in BOTH regimes up to 14% for Govt; extra ₹50,000 old-regime only) [VERIFY sub-clause mapping]; 60% lump sum & 25% partial withdrawal remain exempt.

Module 1 — Preliminary & Application (Rules 1–2)

CARD #001 · Enacting formula and constitutional basis

Rule/Form/OM: Preamble, CCS (Implementation of NPS) Rules, 2021 · **Topic:** Constitutional powers

Q: Under which exact constitutional provisions were the CCS (Implementation of NPS) Rules, 2021 framed, and whose consultation was mandatory?

A: Framed by the President under (1) the **proviso to Article 309** and (2) **clause (5) of Article 148**, **after consultation with the Comptroller and Auditor-General of India** in relation to persons serving in the Indian Audit & Accounts Department.

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: Do not answer "Article 309 only" or "PFRDA Act, 2013" — both the Art. 309 proviso and Art. 148(5) are invoked, with C&AG consultation for IA&AD.

Source/Status: Bare Rules — G.S.R. 227(E) dt. 30.03.2021 (verified against Gazette text) · **Linked cards:** N-002, N-010

CARD #002 · Notification header, short title & commencement

Rule/Form/OM: Rule 1(1)–(2); G.S.R. 227(E) · **Topic:** Timeline

Q: Give the short title, nodal department, notification number, date and commencement of the CCS (Implementation of NPS) Rules, 2021.

A: Short title — Central Civil Services (Implementation of National Pension System) Rules, 2021 [Rule 1(1)]. Nodal dept — Ministry of Personnel, PG & Pensions, **Department of Pension and Pensioners' Welfare (DoPPW)**. Notification — **G.S.R. 227(E), dated 30.03.2021**, Gazette of India, Extraordinary, Part II, Section 3, Sub-section (i) [publication issue 31.03.2021 — VERIFY Gazette issue date]. Commencement [Rule 1(2)] — on the **date of publication in the Official Gazette** (prospective only; no retrospective effect to 01.01.2004, though the Rules govern employees appointed on/after 01.01.2004).

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: Rule 1(2) contains no deeming of retrospective effect — the Rules operate from Gazette publication, not from 01.01.2004.

Source/Status: Bare Rules (G.S.R. 227(E)) + DoPPW OM dt. 14.10.2024 & CPAO Compendium (publication date); [VERIFY] exact Gazette issue date · **Linked cards:** N-001, N-003

CARD #003 · Rule 2 — who is covered

Rule/Form/OM: Rule 2 (opening words) · **Topic:** Application

Q: To which class of Government servants do the Rules apply?

A: Save as otherwise provided, they apply to **Government servants, including civilian Government servants in the Defence Services, appointed substantively to civil services and posts in connection with the affairs of the Union, on or after 01.01.2004**.

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: (1) Civilian defence staff (incl. DAD) are covered; armed-forces personnel under the Army/Air Force/Navy Acts are not. (2) The cut-off is "on or after 01.01.2004", not the Rules' own commencement date.

Source/Status: Bare Rules · **Linked cards:** N-004, N-009

CARD #004 · Rule 2(a)–(h) — the eight statutory exclusions

Rule/Form/OM: Rule 2(a)–(h) · **Topic:** Exceptions

Q: List all eight categories excluded from the Rules.

A: The Rules do **not** apply to: **(a)** Railway servants; **(b)** persons in casual and daily-rated employment; **(c)** persons paid from contingencies; **(d)** members of the All India Services; **(e)** persons locally recruited for services in diplomatic, consular or other Indian establishments in foreign countries; **(f)** persons employed on contract; **(g)** persons whose terms of service are regulated by/under the Constitution or any other law in force; **(h)** persons to whom the CCS (Pension) Rules apply under any special/general Government order.

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: Probationers appointed substantively to regular posts **are** covered (Rule 6(6) — contribution during probation is mandatory). Contract/casual/contingency/Railway/AIS staff are out.

Source/Status: Bare Rules · **Linked cards:** N-005, N-008, N-009, N-010, N-011

CARD #005 · Rule 2(h) — OPS coverage by Government order (2020–2026)

Rule/Form/OM: Rule 2(h); DoPPW OM No. 57/05/2021-P&PW(B) dt. 03.03.2023; OM dt. 20.10.2023; OM dt. 17.02.2020; OM dt. 22.06.2026 [VERIFY] · **Topic:** Current-affairs update

Q: Which employees appointed on/after 01.01.2004 are excluded under Rule 2(h) because CCS (Pension) Rules apply to them by Government order?

A: (1) **Pre-22.12.2003 vacancy cases** — employees appointed against posts/vacancies **advertised/notified on or before 22.12.2003** (the date of the MoF NPS notification), including compassionate appointments applied for on/before 22.12.2003, were given a **one-time option** (OM dt. 03.03.2023) to opt for CCS (Pension) Rules — option to be exercised **by 31.08.2023**; appointing-authority decisions [VERIFY: OM text says by 31.10.2023; the draft said 30.11.2023]. Earlier OM dt. 17.02.2020 had required results declared before 01.01.2004; the 2023 OM relaxed it to advertisement/notification on or before **22.12.2003** — not 31.12.2003. (2) **Mobility/technical resignation cases** (OM dt. 20.10.2023): employees who joined Central/State Govt or an autonomous body before 01.01.2004 (or were covered under OPS via the 03.03.2023 OM) and moved to Central Govt with proper permission. (3) **Compassionate appointments** — DoPPW OM dt. 22.06.2026 clarified the governing date [VERIFY — check DoPT/DoPPW portal].

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: The crucial cut-off in the 03.03.2023 OM is **22.12.2003** (date of NPS notification), not 31.12.2003.

Source/Status: DoPPW OM (03.03.2023, 20.10.2023 verified; 22.06.2026 [VERIFY]); OM 17.02.2020 [VERIFY no.] · **Linked cards:** N-004, N-008

CARD #006 · Autonomous bodies — no suo-moto application

Rule/Form/OM: Rule 2; DoPPW OM No. 57/03/2022-P&PW(B)/8361(8) dt. 25.10.2024; MoF (DoE) ID Note dt. 23.02.2026 [VERIFY] · **Topic:** Exception / current affairs

Q: Do the CCS (NPS) Rules, 2021 (and the Rule 10 OPS option OM dt. 26.10.2022) apply automatically to employees of Central Autonomous Bodies (CABs)?

A: No. Service matters of autonomous-body employees are not under DoPPW's jurisdiction; hence the CCS (NPS) Rules, 2021 and OM dt. 26.10.2022 are **not suo-moto applicable** to CAB employees (OM dt. 25.10.2024, verified). MoF (Dept. of Expenditure) ID Note dt. 23.02.2026 (communicated e.g. in CSIR OM dt. 24.03.2026) reaffirmed that Rule 10 OPS benefits are not automatically extended to CAB employees [VERIFY both 2026 items against DoE/DoPT portals]. They apply only where the body **expressly adopts** them (see N-007, EPFO).

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: Assertion–reason favourite: a CAB employee may be an NPS subscriber, yet the CCS (NPS) Rules, 2021 apply only to Central Govt civil employees unless expressly extended with MoF concurrence.

Source/Status: DoPPW OM dt. 25.10.2024 (verified); MoF ID Note 23.02.2026 / CSIR OM 24.03.2026 [VERIFY] · **Linked cards:** N-007

CARD #007 · Express adoption by a statutory body — EPFO Regulations, 2025

Rule/Form/OM: Rule 2; EPFO Employees' Provident Fund (Staff and Conditions of Service) Regulations, 2025 · **Topic:** Exception

Q: Give the example of a statutory body that expressly adopted the CCS (NPS) Rules, 2021, and the body-specific modification.

A: The **EPFO (Staff and Conditions of Service) Regulations, 2025** (notified 2025 [VERIFY exact month/Gazette no. — news reports March–May 2025]) expressly made the **CCS (Implementation of NPS) Rules, 2021** and **CCS (Payment of Gratuity under NPS) Rules, 2021** applicable to regular Central Board (EPFO) employees appointed on/after 01.01.2004 — with the proviso that **UPSC consultation under the first proviso to Rule 5(1) of the Gratuity Rules is not applicable** to Central Board employees (verified).

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: Autonomous/statutory bodies never get the CCS rules suo-moto (N-006); they get them only by express adoption in their own regulations, possibly with modifications.

Source/Status: EPFO Regulations 2025 (adoption + UPSC proviso verified); [VERIFY] Gazette number/date · **Linked cards:** N-006

CARD #008 · Rule 2(b) & 2(h) — pre-2004 temporary-status casual labourers

Rule/Form/OM: Rule 2(b), 2(h); DoPT OMs dt. 26.02.2016 & 28.07.2016 [VERIFY numbers] · **Topic:** Exception

Q: What happens to casual labourers granted "temporary status" under the 1993 DoPT scheme before 01.01.2004 who are regularised in Group C on/after 01.01.2004?

A: They are **exempted from NPS** and governed by the CCS (Pension) Rules (OPS), with **50% of the temporary-status service counting** towards qualifying service. By contrast, casual workers without pre-2004 temporary status who are substantively appointed on/after 01.01.2004 are covered by the NPS Rules.

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: High-yield Rule 2(b) vs 2(h) distinction — regularised even in 2010/2020 → OPS, not NPS.

Source/Status: Bare Rules + DoPT OMs 2016 [VERIFY exact OM numbers on doptcirculars.nic.in] · **Linked cards:** N-004, N-005

CARD #009 · Rule 2(a) — Railway servants; Railway NPS Rules, 2025

Rule/Form/OM: Rule 2(a); Railway Services (Implementation of NPS) Rules, 2025 — G.S.R. 735(E) dt. 01.10.2025; Railway Board RBE No. 103/2025 dt. 08.10.2025 · **Topic:** Sister rules

Q: Which statutory rules now govern Railway servants' NPS matters, and under what power were they made?

A: Railway Services (Implementation of NPS) Rules, 2025, notified vide **G.S.R. 735(E) dated 01.10.2025** (circulated by Railway Board RBE No. 103/2025 dated 08.10.2025), made by the President under the **proviso to Article 309 only** (no Art. 148(5), as Railways are not IA&AD) — verified.

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: Do not confuse G.S.R. 227(E) (CCS NPS Rules 2021) with G.S.R. 735(E) (Railway NPS Rules 2025). A separate Railway UPS Rules, 2026 (effective 21.09.2026) also exists [VERIFY Gazette no.].

Source/Status: Bare Rules (Railway) — verified via RBE/Gazette; Railway UPS Rules 2026 [VERIFY] · **Linked cards:** N-003, N-004, N-094

CARD #010 · Rule 2(d) — AIS members; AIS NPS Rules, 2026

Rule/Form/OM: Rule 2(d); AIS (Implementation of NPS) Rules, 2026 — G.S.R. 307(E) dt. 22.04.2026 · **Topic:** Sister rules

Q: Which rules now govern NPS matters of IAS/IPS/IFoS officers appointed on/after 01.01.2004, and under what statute?

A: All India Services (Implementation of NPS) Rules, 2026, notified by **DoPT under sub-section (1) of Section 3 of the All India Services Act, 1951 (61 of 1951)**, after consultation with State Governments — G.S.R. 307(E) dated 22.04.2026 (verified). Officers to whom the AIS (DCRB) Rules, 1958 apply by order remain outside. [Draft claim of a 15-year VRS for Assam-Meghalaya/Manipur-Tripura/Nagaland/Sikkim cadre officers under the 2026 Rules — VERIFY against the Gazette text.]

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: Enacting-power contrast: CCS NPS Rules 2021 = proviso to Art. 309 + Art. 148(5); AIS NPS Rules 2026 = Sec. 3(1) AIS Act, 1951.

Source/Status: Bare Rules (AIS) — notification verified; NE-cadre VRS relaxation [VERIFY] · **Linked cards:** N-001, N-004

CARD #011 · Rule 2(e) — locally recruited staff abroad

Rule/Form/OM: Rule 2(e); Rule 12(1) proviso (ii) · **Topic:** Exception

Q: Are locally recruited staff of Indian Embassies/Consulates covered? What about India-based subscribers posted abroad?

A: No — persons locally recruited for services in diplomatic/consular/other Indian establishments in foreign countries are excluded (Rule 2(e)). But India-based subscribers **posted abroad** remain covered — although Rule 12(1) proviso (ii) bars them from VRS while posted in foreign-based offices of Ministries/Departments.

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: Distinguish "locally recruited abroad" (excluded) from "posted abroad" (covered, but no VRS while abroad).

Source/Status: Bare Rules · **Linked cards:** N-004, N-046

Module 2 — Definitions (Rule 3)

CARD #012 · Accredited Bank vs Trustee Bank

Rule/Form/OM: Rule 3(1)(a), 3(1)(v); Rule 6(10)(ii) · **Topic:** Authorities

Q: Distinguish "Accredited Bank" [3(1)(a)] from "Trustee Bank" [3(1)(v)].

A: Accredited Bank — in relation to a Ministry/Department/UT, means the **Reserve Bank of India or any bank** appointed to transact Government business for that Ministry/Department/UT and officially recognised for transfer of funds to the Trustee Bank. **Trustee Bank** — a banking company under the Banking Regulation Act, 1949 (10 of 1949), appointed by PFRDA as intermediary to receive NPS funds from nodal offices/accredited banks and remit to pension funds/ASPs.

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: RBI itself can be the Accredited Bank. Money flows PAO/CDDO → **through Accredited Bank → to Trustee Bank** — never the reverse.

Source/Status: Bare Rules · **Linked cards:** N-035, N-020

CARD #013 · Accumulated Pension Corpus, Annuity, ASP

Rule/Form/OM: Rule 3(1)(b), (c), (d) · **Topic:** Core NPS terms

Q: Define Accumulated Pension Corpus, Annuity and Annuity Service Provider.

A: Accumulated Pension Corpus — monetary value of pension investments accumulated in the subscriber's IPA. **Annuity** — periodic payment by the ASP to the subscriber on purchase of an annuity plan out of the corpus. **ASP** — a life insurer **registered and regulated by IRDAI and empanelled by PFRDA**.

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: ASP has a **dual** regulatory link: IRDAI + PFRDA.

Source/Status: Bare Rules · **Linked cards:** N-038, N-043

CARD #014 · PFRDA Act section mapping — Authority, CRA, NPS, Pension Fund

Rule/Form/OM: Rule 3(1)(e), (f), (q), (s); PFRDA Act, 2013 (23 of 2013) · **Topic:** Authority

Q: Match Authority, CRA, NPS and Pension Fund to their PFRDA Act, 2013 sections.

A: Authority = PFRDA under **Sec. 3(1)** (includes the interim/resolution-based PFRDA); **CRA** = registered under **Sec. 27**; **NPS** = contributory pension system under **Sec. 20**; **Pension Fund** = certificate of registration under **Sec. 27(3)**.

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: Memorise the quartet: 3(1) / 20 / 27 / 27(3). The interim PFRDA is expressly included because NPS began 01.01.2004, before the 2013 Act.

Source/Status: Bare Rules + PFRDA Act, 2013 · **Linked cards:** N-020

CARD #015 · DDO vs CDDO

Rule/Form/OM: Rule 3(1)(g), (h) · **Topic:** Authorities

Q: How do DDO and CDDO differ?

A: DDO — a Head of Office, or any other **Gazetted Officer** designated by a Central Govt Department/HOD/Administrator to draw bills and make payments; includes a HOD/Administrator discharging the function himself. **CDDO** — a DDO functioning under a Ministry/Department (incl. **CPWD, Forest Department, and departments following the CPWA Code**) or a UT, authorised to withdraw money for specified payments against an **assignment account** in a specified branch of an accredited bank.

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: CDDO keywords: CPWD/Forest/CPWA-Code departments + "assignment account". A non-Gazetted officer cannot be a DDO.

Source/Status: Bare Rules · **Linked cards:** N-018, N-035, App. E.3

CARD #016 · Defence Services

Rule/Form/OM: Rule 3(1)(i) · **Topic:** Definition

Q: Define "Defence Services".

A: Services under the Government of India in the **Ministry of Defence and the Defence Accounts Department (DAD)**, paid out of the Defence Services Estimates, and **not permanently subject to** the Air Force Act, 1950, Army Act, 1950 or Navy Act, 1957.

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: DAD is expressly named; military personnel under the three Services Acts are outside.

Source/Status: Bare Rules · **Linked cards:** N-003

CARD #017 · Foreign Service vs Local Fund administered by Government

Rule/Form/OM: Rule 3(1)(k), (p) · **Topic:** Definition / FR-pension trap

Q: Define Foreign Service [3(1)(k)] and Local Fund administered by Government [3(1)(p)].

A: Foreign Service — service where pay is received, with Government sanction, from a source **other than** the Consolidated Fund of India / a State / a UT — so deputation to a **domestic PSU/autonomous body paid from its own funds is Foreign Service**. **Local Fund administered by Government** — a fund of a body that comes under Government control by law/rule having force of law and over whose expenditure the Government retains **"complete and direct control"**.

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: Partial grant-in-aid is not enough for "local fund"; and foreign service is **not** only "outside India".

Source/Status: Bare Rules · **Linked cards:** N-029, App. E.6

CARD #018 · HOD vs HOO

Rule/Form/OM: Rule 3(1)(m), (n); DFPR, 1978 · **Topic:** Authorities

Q: Contrast Head of Department [3(1)(m)] and Head of Office [3(1)(n)].

A: HOD — per **Schedule I to DFPR, 1978**, plus any other authority the **President** specifies by order. **HOO** — per **Rule 14 of DFPR, 1978** (must be a Gazetted Officer), plus any other authority the **Competent Authority** specifies by order.

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: HOD = Sch. I DFPR + President; HOO = Rule 14 DFPR + Competent Authority.

Source/Status: Bare Rules · **Linked cards:** N-015, App. E.4

CARD #019 · IPA, PAO, PRAN, Subscriber, Emoluments, Government; Rule 3(2)

Rule/Form/OM: Rule 3(1)(j), (l), (o), (r), (t), (u); Rule 3(2) · **Topic:** Definitions

Q: Define IPA, PAO, PRAN, Subscriber, Emoluments, Government, and state the residual interpretation rule.

A: Emoluments = as specified in Rule 5. **Government** = the Central Government. **IPA** = the subscriber's account executed by a contract setting out NPS terms and conditions. **PAO** = officer (whatever the designation) maintaining accounts of a Central Govt Ministry/Dept/office or UT — **includes an Accountant-General**. **PRAN** = Permanent Retirement Account Number allotted by the CRA. **Subscriber** = a Government servant subscribing to a pension-fund scheme. **Rule 3(2):** undefined words take meanings from the FR 1922, CCS (Pension) Rules (now 2021), PFRDA Act 2013, or PFRDA Regulations.

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: PAO expressly includes the AG; IPA is "executed by a contract".

Source/Status: Bare Rules · **Linked cards:** N-026, N-020

CARD #020 · Rule 3(1) — complete 22-clause matrix (a)–(v)

Rule/Form/OM: Rule 3(1)(a)–(v) · **Topic:** Master matrix

Q: Give the clause-letter mapping of all 22 defined terms.

A:

Clause	Term	Clause	Term
3(1)(a)	Accredited Bank (incl. RBI)	3(1)(l)	Government (Central Government)
3(1)(b)	Accumulated Pension Corpus	3(1)(m)	Head of Department (Sch. I DFPR / President)
3(1)(c)	Annuity	3(1)(n)	Head of Office (Rule 14 DFPR / Competent Authority)
3(1)(d)	Annuity Service Provider (IRDAI + PFRDA)	3(1)(o)	Individual Pension Account (contract-based)
3(1)(e)	Authority (PFRDA, Sec. 3(1) + interim PFRDA)	3(1)(p)	Local Fund administered by Government
3(1)(f)	Central Recordkeeping Agency (Sec. 27) — recordkeeping, accounting, administration, customer service	3(1)(q)	NPS (Sec. 20) — PoP + CRA + Pension Funds
3(1)(g)	Drawing and Disbursing Officer (Gazetted)	3(1)(r)	Pay and Accounts Officer (incl. AG)
3(1)(h)	Cheque Drawing and Disbursing Officer (assignment account)	3(1)(s)	Pension Fund (Sec. 27(3)) — receives, accumulates, pays
3(1)(i)	Defence Services (MoD + DAD civilians)	3(1)(t)	PRAN
3(1)(j)	Emoluments (= Rule 5)	3(1)(u)	Subscriber
3(1)(k)	Foreign Service (non-Consolidated-Fund pay)	3(1)(v)	Trustee Bank (Banking Regulation Act, 1949)

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: (g) DDO precedes (h) CDDO (not strictly alphabetical); "Form" is **not** a defined clause — 3(1)(l) is "Government". CRA's four functions exclude fund investment (that is the Pension Fund's job).

Source/Status: Bare Rules · **Linked cards:** N-012 – N-019

Module 3 — Registration into NPS (Rule 4)

CARD #021 · Rule 4(1) — documents at joining

Rule/Form/OM: Rule 4(1) · **Topic:** Timeline

Q: When, to whom and in which forms must a newly appointed servant apply for NPS registration?

A: Immediately on joining service, to the **Head of Office**, submitting together the **Common Subscriber Registration Form (CSRF)** (or other form specified by PFRDA) **and** the **option Form 1 under Rule 10** together with **Form 2** (family details).

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: Both CSRF and the Rule 10 option forms go "immediately on joining" — not after probation.

Source/Status: Bare Rules · **Linked cards:** N-039, N-022

CARD #022 · Rule 4(2)–(4) — the 3-3-3 working-day chain

Rule/Form/OM: Rule 4(2), 4(3), 4(4) · **Topic:** Timeline

Q: State the forward chain of timelines from joining to CRA.

A: (1) HOO → DDO: within **3 working days of joining** of the servant (HOO checks completeness, countersigns with date of receipt, keeps a copy, sends original to DDO) [4(2)]. (2) DDO → PAO/CDDO: within **3 working days from receipt** [4(3)]. (3) PAO/CDDO → CRA: within **3 working days from receipt** — processed online **and** a **duly signed physical copy** forwarded to CRA for record [4(4)].

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: 4(2) runs from **joining**; 4(3)–4(4) run from **date of receipt**. Online upload does **not** dispense with the signed physical copy to CRA.

Source/Status: Bare Rules · **Linked cards:** N-021, N-023, App. B

CARD #023 · Rule 4(5)–(8) — PRAN communication & service-book entry

Rule/Form/OM: Rule 4(5)–(8) · **Topic:** Timeline

Q: Trace the reverse chain after CRA generates the PRAN, and the service-book deadline.

A: CRA completes registration, allots PRAN per PFRDA TAT, communicates to PAO/CDDO and sends the PRAN kit to the subscriber [4(5)]. PAO/CDDO → DDO: **immediately** [4(6)]. DDO → HOO: **immediately** [4(7)]. HOO intimates PRAN to the subscriber, records it in CSRF **and** the Service Book, and pastes a **certified copy** of the CSRF in the Service Book within **5 working days** thereafter [4(8)].

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: 4(2) keeps a plain copy; 4(8) requires a **certified** copy pasted within **5 working days**.

Source/Status: Bare Rules · **Linked cards:** N-022, App. B

CARD #024 · Rule 4(9)–(11) — first contribution; salary not to be held up

Rule/Form/OM: Rule 4(9), 4(10), 4(11) · **Topic:** Timeline / exception

Q: What is the outer deadline for crediting the first contribution, and what happens if PRAN is not ready at first salary?

A: First contribution must be credited within **20 days of submission of the application OR by the last date of the month of joining — whichever is LATER** [4(9)] (e.g., joined & applied 18.08 → 20 days = 07.09 vs 31.08 → deadline 07.09; applied 05.08 → 25.08 vs 31.08 → 31.08). If registration is incomplete at first/subsequent salary, salary **shall be paid** after withholding the 10% subscriber contribution; once PRAN is generated, the withheld amount **plus Rule 8 interest (PPF rate)** is credited to the IPA [4(10)]. Action on the Rule 10 option form follows Rule 10 [4(11)].

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: "Whichever is **LATER**" (4(9)) — contrast Rule 23(2) claim deadline, which is "whichever is **EARLIER**". Salary is never stopped for pending PRAN.

Source/Status: Bare Rules · **Linked cards:** N-025, N-068, App. B

CARD #025 · Rule 4(9) opening mandate — joint no-delay duty

Rule/Form/OM: Rule 4(9) 1st sentence · **Topic:** Authority

Q: On whom does Rule 4(9) cast an explicit no-delay obligation?

A: The opening sentence casts a statutory duty on **all authorities in sub-rules (2)–(8)** — HOO, DDO, PAO/CDDO and CRA — to ensure there is no delay in registration and crediting of the first contribution.

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: The no-delay mandate is **joint**, not just on the DDO/PAO.

Source/Status: Bare Rules · **Linked cards:** N-024, N-036

Module 4 — Emoluments (Rule 5)

CARD #026 · Rule 5(1) — what counts as "emoluments"

Rule/Form/OM: Rule 5(1); FR 9(21)(a)(i) · **Topic:** Formula

Q: What exactly constitutes "emoluments" for monthly NPS contributions?

A: Only **three** elements: (1) **Basic Pay** as defined in **FR 9(21)(a)(i)** (pay in the pay matrix for the post held substantively/officiating); (2) **NPA** for medical officers in lieu of private practice; (3) **admissible DA** for the calendar month. Excluded: HRA, transport allowance, special pay, personal pay (FR 9(21)(a)(ii)), deputation (duty) allowance, overtime, honorarium, etc.

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: Contrast pension/gratuity rules: under CCS (Pension) Rules emoluments = pay + NPA (DA does not count for pension, but counts for gratuity). For **NPS** all three — pay + NPA + DA — count.

Source/Status: Bare Rules · **Linked cards:** N-030, N-031

CARD #027 · Rule 5(2)–(3) — leave and absence

Rule/Form/OM: Rule 5(2), 5(3); Proviso to Rule 7(1) · **Topic:** Proviso

Q: How are emoluments reckoned on paid leave, and on absence/EOL during part of a month?

A: Paid leave [5(2)]: pay + NPA + DA **actually drawn** as leave salary (e.g., HPL: half pay + admissible DA). Absence/EOL for whole or part of month [5(3)]: pay actually drawn for the duty/paid-leave part; **nil** if on EOL for the whole month. But if the leave is on **medical ground / civil commotion / useful higher studies**, the Government still contributes 14% on **notional full emoluments** (Proviso to Rule 7(1)) even where leave salary is nil or reduced.

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: Employee pays 10% only on actual drawn pay (nil on EOL); Government's notional 14% applies **only** to the three proviso grounds — private-affairs EOL gets ₹0 from Government (Rule 7(2)).

Source/Status: Bare Rules; DoPPW OM dt. 07.10.2024 (reaffirmed) · **Linked cards:** N-033, App. E.7

CARD #028 · Rule 5(4) — suspension

Rule/Form/OM: Rule 5(4); Rule 6(2), 7(3) · **Topic:** Suspension

Q: What are "emoluments" during suspension?

A: The **subsistence allowance drawn** (plus DA admissible on it) — relevant only if the subscriber **opts to contribute** during suspension (Rule 6(2)); if he opts out, both shares are nil during suspension.

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: If the suspension period is finally treated as duty/paid leave, contributions are recalculated on full emoluments with PPF interest on the difference (provisos to 6(2)/7(3)); if it remains "not duty", no recalculation.

Source/Status: Bare Rules · **Linked cards:** N-032, App. E.7

CARD #029 · Rule 5(5) vs 5(6) — deputation in India vs foreign service/abroad

Rule/Form/OM: Rule 5(5), 5(6); Rule 3(1)(k) · **Topic:** Exam trap

Q: Contrast emoluments during deputation in India vs foreign service / deputation outside India.

A: Deputation **in India** (Central/State Govt) [5(5)]: **actual pay drawn** (+ DA). **Foreign service or deputation outside India** [5(6)]: **notional pay** the subscriber would have drawn in the parent cadre (+ DA). Since "foreign service" includes deputation to a **domestic PSU/autonomous body** (Rule 3(1)(k)), such cases use **notional** pay too.

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: The #1 conceptual trap of Rule 5: foreign service is not only "abroad" — NHAI/PSU deputation in Delhi is foreign service → notional pay.

Source/Status: Bare Rules · **Linked cards:** N-017, App. E.6

CARD #030 · Rule 5(7) + worked example — re-employment and contribution maths

Rule/Form/OM: Rule 5(7); Rules 5(1), 6(1), 7(1), 7(5) · **Topic:** Numerical

Q: (a) How are emoluments computed for a re-employed pensioner whose pay is reduced by pension? (b) Medical officer: Basic ₹67,700 + NPA ₹13,540 + DA ₹43,057 + HRA ₹21,935 + TA ₹11,016 — compute monthly 10% and 14%.

A: (a) Add back the pension element deducted from pay: emoluments = reduced pay + deducted pension element (+ DA). (b) Emoluments = 67,700 + 13,540 + 43,057 = **₹1,24,297** (HRA/TA excluded). Employee 10% = ₹12,429.70 → rounded **up to next higher rupee = ₹12,430**. Government 14% = ₹17,401.58 → **₹17,402**.

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: Rounding is **always to the next higher rupee** (even ₹5,420.05 → ₹5,421) — never "nearest rupee".

Source/Status: Bare Rules · **Linked cards:** N-026, N-031, App. C

Module 5 — Contributions, Interest & Investment (Rules 6–9)

CARD #031 · Rules 6(1), 7(1), 7(5) — 10% / 14% and rounding

Rule/Form/OM: Rule 6(1), 7(1), 7(5) · **Topic:** Rates

Q: State the mandatory contribution percentages and the rounding rule.

A: Subscriber: **10%** of monthly emoluments (or as notified) — defined-contribution basis [6(1)]. Government: **14%** (raised from 10% w.e.f. **01.04.2019**) [7(1)]. Both are **rounded off to the next higher rupee** [6(1), 7(5)] — Rule 7(5) ensures the rounding also applies to notional-leave, subsistence and regularisation arrears. Government pays nothing when the subscriber is not required to contribute, subject to the Proviso to 7(1) [7(2)].

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: If a subscriber voluntarily contributes >10% under Rule 6(9), the Government share **stays at 14%** — no matching of the excess.

Source/Status: Bare Rules · **Linked cards:** N-030, N-034, App. C

CARD #032 · Rules 6(2), 7(3) — suspension

Rule/Form/OM: Rule 6(2); Rule 7(3) + 1st & 2nd provisos · **Topic:** Proviso

Q: State the complete position on contributions during suspension and after the inquiry.

A: During suspension the subscriber **may opt** to contribute 10% on subsistence allowance; if he does, Government contributes 14% on it [6(2), 7(3)]. **1st proviso to 7(3):** if he opts out, **no Government contribution** during suspension. If the suspension period is finally **treated as duty or paid leave**, both shares are recalculated on the entitled emoluments and the difference is credited **with PPF-rate interest** (provisos to 6(2)/7(3)); if it remains "not duty", no recalculation/refund.

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: Two traps — opt-out ⇒ Government also pays zero; exoneration ⇒ recalculation **with interest**, not just principal.

Source/Status: Bare Rules · **Linked cards:** N-028, N-036, App. E.7

CARD #033 · Proviso to Rule 7(1) — the three exceptional leaves

Rule/Form/OM: Proviso to Rule 7(1); Rules 6(3), 7(2), 5(2) · **Topic:** Proviso

Q: When must the Government pay 14% on notional full emoluments despite nil/reduced leave salary?

A: When leave is granted (1) **on medical ground**, (2) due to **civil commotion** preventing joining/rejoining duty, or (3) for **higher studies useful in discharge of official duty** — and during such leave leave salary is **not payable (EOL)** or is payable **at less than full pay (e.g., HPL)**. Then Government pays 14% on full notional pay + NPA + DA; the subscriber pays 10% only on actual leave salary drawn (nil on EOL) [6(3), 5(2)]. Private/domestic EOL: employee ₹0, Government ₹0 [7(2)].

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: Medical HPL → employee 10% of half-pay drawn; Government 14% of **full** notional pay. Private EOL → both zero.

Source/Status: Bare Rules; DoPPW OM dt. 07.10.2024 · **Linked cards:** N-027, App. E.7

CARD #034 · Rules 6(4)–(7), 6(9), 7(4) — deputation, arrears, probation, foreign service, excess

Rule/Form/OM: Rule 6(4), 6(5), 6(6), 6(7), 6(9); Rule 7(4) · **Topic:** Sub-rules

Q: State the rules on contributions during deputation in India, arrears, probation, foreign service/international organisations, and voluntary excess.

A: (a) Deputation to Central/State Govt [6(4)]: continues as if not transferred, on Rule 5(5) emoluments. (b) Retrospective arrears [6(5)]: treated as contribution for the **month of payment** (not back-dated). (c) Probation [6(6)]: contribution mandatory. (d) Foreign service (incl. UN Secretariat & other UN bodies, IMF, IBRD/World Bank, ADB, Commonwealth Secretariat, or any other international organisation) [6(7), 7(4)]: per DoPT orders and PFRDA procedure. (e) Voluntary excess [6(9)]: subscriber may contribute above 10% per PFRDA/Govt procedure; Government stays at 14%.

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: DA/pay arrears paid in October for Jan–Sep count as **October's** contribution. WTO/BRICS/NDB fall under "any other international organisation", not the named six.

Source/Status: Bare Rules · **Linked cards:** N-029, N-031

CARD #035 · Rules 6(8), 6(10), 7(6) — the monthly 20th / 25th / last-working-day calendar

Rule/Form/OM: Rule 6(8), 6(10)(i)–(iii); Proviso to 6(10)(ii); Rule 7(6) · **Topic:** Timeline

Q: Give the monthly milestones for deduction, SCF upload and remittance, including the March exception and delay compensation.

A: By the **20th**: DDO deducts contribution and sends the salary bill + subscriber-wise details to PAO/CDDO [6(8)]. By the **25th**: PAO/CDDO uploads the Subscription Contribution File (SCF) and generates a Transaction ID [6(10)(i)]. By the **last working day** of the month: remittance to the **Trustee Bank through the Accredited Bank** [6(10)(ii)]. **Proviso:** March's contribution is remitted on the **first working day of April**. Delay beyond timeline (not attributable to the subscriber): credited with Rule 8 interest [6(10)(iii)]; identical timelines for the 14% Government share [7(6)].

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: March salary is paid on the 1st working day of April, hence the March proviso. Memorise: **20th → 25th → last working day (March: 1st working day of April)**.

Source/Status: Bare Rules · **Linked cards:** N-012, N-036, App. B

CARD #036 · Rule 8(1) — interest on delayed deposits

Rule/Form/OM: Rule 8(1) + Proviso · **Topic:** Rate / timeline

Q: For which delays is interest payable, at what rate, within what time, and what rate applies for 2004–2012?

A: Rule 8(1) covers delays **not attributable to the subscriber** in: (i) commencement of contributions due to registration delay beyond Rule 4; (ii) deduction/crediting of the subscriber's contribution beyond Rule 6; (iii) crediting of the Government's contribution beyond Rule 7. Interest at the **PPF deposit rate** as decided by the Government, credited within **30 days of crediting the principal** (e.g., principal credited 10.08.2026 → interest by 09.09.2026). **Proviso:** for **01.01.2004–31.12.2012**, the rate is as notified by **DFS Notification F.No. 1/3/2016-PR dt. 31.01.2019** and **DoE OM No. 1(21)/EV/2018 dt. 12.04.2019** (GPF rates) — both verified in the Gazette text.

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: Current rate = **PPF**, not GPF (GPF only for the 2004–2012 proviso). The 30-day clock runs from **crediting of the principal**, and delay caused by the subscriber's own failure to file forms attracts no interest [6(10)(iii), 7(6), 8(1) opening words].

Source/Status: Bare Rules (proviso citations verified against CPAO booklet/Gazette) · **Linked cards:** N-024, N-032, N-037, App. B

CARD #037 · Rule 8(2) — fixing responsibility for delay

Rule/Form/OM: Rule 8(2)(i)–(iii); Sec. 201(1A) Income-tax Act, 1961 · **Topic:** Authority

Q: Who examines delayed-registration/contribution cases, who bears the pecuniary loss, and under which statutory yardstick?

A: Every case of delay under Rules 4/6/7 is examined by the **Head of Department or the Chief Controller of Accounts** [8(2)(i)]. If delay is due to administrative lapse, the delinquent official(s) must pay the pecuniary loss (interest) to the Government [8(2)(ii)]. Responsibility and quantum are determined in the same manner as delayed TDS deduction/remittance under **sub-section (1A) of Section 201** of the Income-tax Act, 1961 (the Gazette print shows "(IA)" [VERIFY printing variant]; corresponding provision in the Income-tax Act, 2025: Sec. 397(3) [VERIFY]) — without prejudice to disciplinary action [8(2)(iii)].

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: Examining authorities = **HOD or CCA**; yardstick = Sec. 201(1A) IT Act, 1961.

Source/Status: Bare Rules; [VERIFY] Gazette "(IA)" printing and Sec. 397(3) correspondence · **Linked cards:** N-036

CARD #038 · Rule 9 — investment of corpus; current choice menu

Rule/Form/OM: Rule 9; PFRDA/MoF notifications · **Topic:** Investment

Q: Who notifies the pension funds and manner of investment under Rule 9, and what choices do Central Govt NPS/UPS subscribers now have?

A: Under Rule 9 the corpus is invested by such pension fund(s) and in such manner as notified by **the Authority (PFRDA)**. Current menu for Central Govt subscribers (NPS & UPS): **Default Scheme** (3 PSU PFMs — SBI, LIC, UTI; ≤15% equity), **Scheme G** (100% G-Sec), **LC25**, **LC50**, and — approved October 2025 and notified by DFS notification dated **13.11.2025** — **LC75 (Aggressive Life Cycle, up to 75% equity tapering from age 35, ~15% by 55)** and **BLC (modified LC50, 50% equity held till age 45, then tapering [glide-path % at 55 — VERIFY])**. PFM choice changeable once per financial year. LC75/BLC extended to CAB employees by DoE OM dt. 01.07.2026 [VERIFY].

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: Bare Act says "the Authority" (PFRDA), not the HOD/MoPPW. Default-scheme equity cap remains **15%**; only the life-cycle options go higher.

Source/Status: Bare Rules + PFRDA Regulation / MoF-DFS notifications (Oct–Nov 2025 verified via PIB/MoF releases; exact glide-path numbers and CAB OM [VERIFY]) · **Linked cards:** N-013, N-083

Module 6 — Death / Disability Option & Family Details (Rule 10)

CARD #039 · Rules 10(1)–(2) — Form 1 option and its processing chain

Rule/Form/OM: Rule 10(1), 10(2); Form 1 · **Topic:** Option

Q: What option must every subscriber exercise, and how is it verified, recorded and transmitted?

A: At joining (and ASAP after notification for existing servants), exercise **Form 1** choosing benefits on death in service / boarding out on disablement / invalidation retirement under **(A) CCS (Pension) Rules (now 2021) / CCS (EOP) Rules (now 2023)** or **(B) NPS** (corpus-based) [10(1)]. HOO verifies, accepts and places it in the **Service Book**; a copy goes **HOO → DDO → PAO → CRA**; PAO enters it in the online system [10(2)].

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: Form 1 travels all the way to the CRA; Form 2 stays with the HOO.

Source/Status: Bare Rules · **Linked cards:** N-021, N-040, N-072

CARD #040 · Rule 10(3) — Form 2 family details; disabled child

Rule/Form/OM: Rule 10(3)(a)–(d); Form 2; proviso to Rule 54(6) CCS (Pension) Rules 1972 = Rule 50(9) of 2021 Rules · **Topic:** Family

Q: State the rules on Form 2 submission, later changes, and disabled-child certification.

A: Form 2 submitted with Form 1 at joining (or as soon as a family is acquired) [10(3)(a)]. Any later change in family size (incl. marriage of a child) must be communicated to the HOO [10(3)(b)]. Disabled child unable to earn a living (cross-ref: proviso to Rule 54(6) of the 1972 Pension Rules = **Rule 50(9) of the 2021 Rules**): report to HOO with a medical certificate from a medical officer **not below the rank of Civil Surgeon**; at claim time, the legal guardian applies with a **fresh** certificate of the same rank [10(3)(c)]. HOO acknowledges, countersigns with date of receipt, pastes Form 2 in the Service Book and records changes [10(3)(d)].

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: Civil Surgeon-rank certificate is needed **twice** — at reporting and again at claim.

Source/Status: Bare Rules · **Linked cards:** N-073, N-074

CARD #041 · Rules 10(4)–(5) — revision of option; death in service

Rule/Form/OM: Rule 10(4)(i)–(iv), 10(5) · **Topic:** Exam trap

Q: How often can Form 1 be revised? Contrast invalidation discharge vs death in service.

A: During service: **any number of times** before retirement [10(4)(i)]. On discharge on invalidation/disability: a **fresh option must be offered** at discharge [10(4)(ii)]; if he cannot exercise it, the earlier option stands [10(4)(iii)]; if no option was ever exercised and he cannot opt at discharge → default under 10(6) [10(4)(iv)]. On **death in service**: the **last option exercised is final** — the family has **no right** to revise [10(5)].

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: Living disabled employee gets a fresh chance; the family of a deceased employee gets **zero**.

Source/Status: Bare Rules · **Linked cards:** N-042, N-043

CARD #042 · Rule 10(6) — default options

Rule/Form/OM: Rule 10(6)(i)–(iii); DoPPW OM 57/03/2022-P&PW(B)/8361(9) dt. 25.10.2024 · **Topic:** Exception

Q: What are the default options when no Form 1 is on record?

A: (i) Death in service and **(ii)** discharge on invalidation/disability (where he also cannot opt at discharge): default = **OPS/EOP** only if it occurs **before 15 years' service OR within 3 years of notification of the Rules (i.e., up to 31.03.2024)**. **(iii)** In **all other cases** — today, since the 3-year window closed on 31.03.2024 — default = **NPS** under the PFRDA (Exits & Withdrawals) Regulations, 2015. DoPPW OM dt. 25.10.2024 (8361(9)) directed a campaign to obtain Form 1/Form 2 from all subscribers.

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: An employee with ≥15 years' service who dies in 2026 without Form 1 → default is **NPS**, not OPS.

Source/Status: Bare Rules; DoPPW OM dt. 25.10.2024 (verified subject/number; campaign detail [VERIFY]) · **Linked cards:** N-041, N-093

CARD #043 · Rule 10(7) — infructuous option

Rule/Form/OM: Rule 10(7) · **Topic:** Exception

Q: What happens if the OPS/EOP option/default becomes infructuous because no family member is eligible for family pension?

A: The OPS/EOP option is **deemed invalid**, and the **full NPS corpus** (employee + Government shares with returns) is paid to the **legal heir(s)** under the PFRDA (Exits & Withdrawals) Regulations, 2015. Example: an unmarried subscriber whose only earning adult brother is ineligible for family pension — brother gets the entire corpus as legal heir (plus death gratuity under the Gratuity Rules).

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: Rule 10(7) overrides the Rule 10(5) "finality" where the option is infructuous.

Source/Status: Bare Rules · **Linked cards:** N-041, N-063, N-077

Module 7 — Superannuation, VRS & Premature Retirement (Rules 11–13)

CARD #044 · Rule 11 — superannuation exit; FR 56(a) timing

Rule/Form/OM: Rule 11; Rule 29(1); FR 56(a); PFRDA Exit Amendment Regulations (Dec 2025) · **Topic:** Exit

Q: What are the NPS exit entitlements on superannuation (incl. after extension of service)?

A: Benefits under the **PFRDA (Exits & Withdrawals) Regulations, 2015** as admissible on superannuation. Current Govt-sector slabs (Dec 2025 amendment — see N-083): corpus **≤ ₹8 lakh → 100% lump sum** (or SLW/SUR/60:40); **₹8–12 lakh → up to ₹6 lakh lump sum** + balance annuity/SUR (min 6 yrs) (or 60:40); **> ₹12 lakh → max 60% lump sum + min 40% annuity**. Retirement takes effect on the **afternoon of the last day of the month** of attaining superannuation age; a servant born on the **1st of a month** retires on the afternoon of the **last day of the preceding month** (FR 56(a) via Rule 29(1)).

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: Both normal superannuation and expiry of post-superannuation extension fall under Rule 11.

Source/Status: Bare Rules + PFRDA Regulation (Dec 2025, verified) · **Linked cards:** N-083, App. C

CARD #045 · Rule 12(1) — VRS eligibility, notice, and the three provisos

Rule/Form/OM: Rule 12(1) + provisos (i)–(iii) · **Topic:** VRS

Q: State VRS eligibility and notice, and the three excluded categories.

A: After **20 years' regular service**, by **≥ 3 months' written notice** to the **appointing authority** (the authority competent to appoint to the post/service from which he seeks VRS — Explanation to 12(5)). Rule 12 does **not** apply to a subscriber (incl. scientist/technical expert) who is: **(i)** on **ITEC** (MEA) or other aid-programme assignments; **(ii) posted abroad** in foreign-based offices of Ministries/Departments; **(iii)** on a **specific contract assignment to a foreign Government** — unless, after transfer to India, he has **resumed charge in India and served ≥ 1 year**.

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: "20 years **regular** service" (not "qualifying service" as in CCS (Pension) Rule 43); after a foreign-Government contract, a **1-year** post-return lock-in applies (mirrored in CCS (Pension) Rule 43).

Source/Status: Bare Rules · **Linked cards:** N-046, N-048, App. B

CARD #046 · Rule 12(1) Explanations (a)-(c) — computing "regular service"

Rule/Form/OM: Rule 12(1) Expl. (a), (b), (c) · **Topic:** Exam trap

Q: Does EOL, study leave, or prior ad-hoc/contract service count towards the 20 years?

A: Expl. (a): regular service starts from joining a Central Govt post on a regular basis and includes past regular service in Central/State Govt or autonomous/statutory bodies joined with proper permission if countable for gratuity. Expl. (b): **all kinds of leave — including EOL and study leave — deputation and foreign service** duly sanctioned count as regular service. Expl. (c): prior **casual/ad-hoc/contract** service does not count.

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: Unlike CCS (Pension) Rules (where uncertificated EOL doesn't count for pension), under Rule 12 **all sanctioned EOL counts** for the 20-year VRS test.

Source/Status: Bare Rules · **Linked cards:** N-045

CARD #047 · Rules 12(2)–(4) — acceptance, curtailment, withdrawal

Rule/Form/OM: Rule 12(2)–(4) + provisos · **Topic:** Timeline

Q: Explain deemed acceptance, curtailment of the 3-month notice, and withdrawal of the VRS notice.

A: (a) Notice needs acceptance by the appointing authority; **if not refused before expiry of the notice period, retirement is effective automatically** from expiry [12(2) + proviso]. (b) The subscriber may request **curtailment** of the 3-month notice in writing with reasons; the authority may relax it if no administrative inconvenience [12(3)]. (c) Withdrawal of notice only with the authority's **specific approval**, and the request must be made **at least 15 days before the intended date of retirement** [12(4) + proviso].

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: Asymmetry — silence of the authority = **automatic** retirement; withdrawal is **never** automatic (needs ≥15 days' advance request + approval). Case: notice 01.06.2026, retirement 01.09.2026 → withdrawal request by **17.08.2026**.

Source/Status: Bare Rules · **Linked cards:** N-045, App. B

CARD #048 · Rules 12(5)–(7) — exclusions and exit level

Rule/Form/OM: Rule 12(5)–(7); DoPT OM No. 25013/6/2001-Estt.(A) dt. 28.02.2002 · **Topic:** Exit level

Q: Which two retirements are excluded from Rule 12, and what exit level does a 20-year VRS subscriber get?

A: Rule 12 does not apply to: (a) retirement under the DoPT **Special VRS for surplus employees** (OM No. 25013/6/2001-Estt.(A) dt. 28.02.2002 — verified) [covered by Rule 13]; (b) retirement on **absorption** in an autonomous body/PSU [covered by Rule 15]. A Rule 12 VRS subscriber gets NPS benefits **as on superannuation — 60:40** (not the 20:80 premature exit) [12(6)]; he may continue the IPA or defer benefits [12(7)].

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: The big trap: general PFRDA premature-exit (20:80) does **not** apply to Rule 12 VRS — DoPPW OM dt. 11.10.2024 reiterated this.

Source/Status: Bare Rules; DoPPW OM dt. 11.10.2024 · **Linked cards:** N-049, N-051, App. E.2

CARD #049 · Rule 13 — FR 56(j)/(k) and SVRS premature retirements

Rule/Form/OM: Rule 13(1)(i)–(ii) + proviso; Rule 13(2) · **Topic:** Exit level

Q: What exit do FR 56(j)/(k) retirements and SVRS surplus retirees get?

A: Both (i) retirement/is-retired in advance of compulsory age under **FR 56(j) (public interest) or FR 56(k) (voluntary)** and (ii) a surplus subscriber opting for the DoPT **SVRS** get NPS benefits **as on superannuation (60:40)** [13(1)(i)–(ii)]. **Proviso:** the SVRS optee also gets the **SVRS ex-gratia in addition**. IPA continuation/deferment option available [13(2)].

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: FR 56(j) (non-penal) → 60:40 under Rule 13; but **compulsory retirement as a penalty** under CCS (CCA) Rules → 20:80 under **Rule 18** — don't mix them up. FR 56(k) age conditions (50 for Group A/B who joined young; 55 otherwise) [VERIFY against FR text].

Source/Status: Bare Rules; FR 1922 [VERIFY age-50 condition wording] · **Linked cards:** N-048, N-062, App. E.2

CARD #050 · Rule 12 vs FR 56(k) vs FR 56(j) — matrix

Rule/Form/OM: Rules 12, 13(1)(i); FR 56(j)/(k); Form 4-A · **Topic:** Comparison

Q: Compare the three voluntary/premature routes.

A:

Feature	Rule 12 VRS	FR 56(k) VRS [Rule 13(1)(i)]	FR 56(j) premature retirement [Rule 13(1)(i)]
Who initiates	Subscriber	Subscriber	Appointing authority (public interest)
Eligibility	20 yrs regular service; all sanctioned leave counts	Age/service per FR 56(k) [VERIFY age conditions]	Review under FR 56(j); ≥3 months' notice or pay in lieu

Feature	Rule 12 VRS	FR 56(k) VRS [Rule 13(1)(i)]	FR 56(j) premature retirement [Rule 13(1)(i)]
Notice	≥3 months (curtailable; deemed acceptance 12(2))	≥3 months' notice	≥3 months or 3 months' pay & allowances in lieu
NPS exit	**Superannuation 60:40** [12(6)]	**60:40**	**60:40**
Covering form	Form 4-A	Form 4-A	Form 4-A

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: Form 4-A expressly names Rule 12, FR 56(k), FR 56(j) and SVRS — all four get the superannuation-level exit.

Source/Status: Bare Rules + Form 4-A · **Linked cards:** N-048, N-049, N-075, App. E.2

Module 8 — Resignation & Absorption (Rules 14–15)

CARD #051 · Rule 14(1) — ordinary resignation

Rule/Form/OM: Rule 14(1) + 1st–3rd provisos · **Topic:** Exit

Q: What happens on ordinary (non-technical) resignation?

A: Unless withdrawn in public interest, lump sum + annuity are paid **as on exit before superannuation — max 20% lump sum / min 80% annuity; 100% lump sum if corpus ≤ ₹5 lakh** (raised from ₹2.5 lakh by the Dec 2025 PFRDA amendment). **1st proviso:** no payment before **90 days** from the effective date of resignation and relief. **2nd proviso:** if the subscriber **dies within those 90 days**, payment is made **immediately** to the eligible person. **3rd proviso:** he may continue the **same PRAN** as a non-Government subscriber. (No gratuity on non-technical resignation — see N-086.)

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: (1) 90-day lock-in; (2) death within 90 days lifts the bar — and such death is **not** "death in service", so Rule 20 OPS family pension does not apply.

Source/Status: Bare Rules + PFRDA Regulation (Dec 2025, verified) · **Linked cards:** N-052, N-053, N-083, App. C

CARD #052 · Rule 14(2) — technical resignation

Rule/Form/OM: Rule 14(2) + 1st & 2nd provisos; DoPT technical-resignation guidelines · **Topic:** Exit

Q: What happens on technical resignation (proper permission) to another Central/State Govt appointment?

A: If the new dept **is NPS-covered**: same **PRAN continues**; deemed an NPS member from the **first** Government appointment [14(2) main]. If the new dept is **not NPS-covered**: **1st proviso** — exit at **superannuation level (60:40)**; or **2nd proviso** — continue same PRAN as a non-Government subscriber. A pre-joining application (intimated at joining) also counts as technical resignation; permanent employees retain lien for **2 years** (extendable to 3 in exceptional cases) [VERIFY lien period against DoPT orders]. Resignation **without** proper channel/NOC is non-technical → 14(1).

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: "Proper permission" converts the exit from 20:80 (14(1)) to 60:40 (1st proviso to 14(2)).

Source/Status: Bare Rules; DoPT instructions [VERIFY lien period] · **Linked cards:** N-051, N-056, App. E.5

CARD #053 · Rule 14(3) — withdrawal of resignation in public interest

Rule/Form/OM: Rule 14(3)(a)–(e) · **Topic:** Conditions

Q: List the five mandatory conditions for permitting withdrawal of an accepted resignation.

A: (a) the person was **not temporary** when the resignation was accepted; (b) resignation was for **compelling reasons not reflecting on integrity/efficiency/conduct** and withdrawal is due to a **material change of circumstances**; (c) intervening conduct was **in no way improper**; (d) absence between effective resignation and **resumption of duty ≤ 90 days**; (e) the vacated or a comparable post is **available**.

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: Clause (a) bars temporary servants outright; clause (d) runs to the date **allowed to resume duty**, not the application date.

Source/Status: Bare Rules · **Linked cards:** N-054, App. B

CARD #054 · Rules 14(4)–(5) — mandatory rejection; condonation

Rule/Form/OM: Rule 14(4), 14(5) · **Topic:** Exception

Q: When must withdrawal of resignation be refused, and what is the effect of allowing it?

A: Mandatory refusal where resignation was with a view to joining (1) a **private commercial company**, (2) a **Government-owned/controlled corporation or company (PSU)**, or (3) a **Government-controlled/financed body (autonomous body)** [14(4)]. If withdrawal is allowed, the order **deemedly condones the interruption in service** [14(5)].

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: Resigning to join ONGC (a PSU) is just as disqualifying as a private company — even within 45 days.

Source/Status: Bare Rules · **Linked cards:** N-053

CARD #055 · Rule 15(1) — absorption in PSU/autonomous body

Rule/Form/OM: Rule 15(1) + 1st & 2nd provisos; DoPPW OM dt. 07.10.2024 (8361(4)) · **Topic:** Absorption

Q: Explain the NPS consequences of permitted absorption.

A: Permitted absorption in a corporation/company wholly or substantially owned/controlled by Central/State Govt, or an autonomous/statutory body controlled/financed by them → **deemed retirement** from the date of absorption, eligible for **superannuation-level (60:40) exit** [15(1)]. **1st proviso:** if NPS exists in the new body, he **shall** continue with the **same PRAN** and gets **no benefit at absorption** (benefits only on exit from the new body). **2nd proviso:** if no NPS there, he may take the 60:40 exit **or** continue the same PRAN as a non-Government subscriber.

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: "Shall" in the 1st proviso — if the PSU has NPS, cashing out at absorption is **not permitted** (OM dt. 07.10.2024).

Source/Status: Bare Rules; DoPPW OM dt. 07.10.2024 (verified number/subject) · **Linked cards:** N-056, N-052

CARD #056 · Rule 15(2)–(3) + Explanations — scope and "date of absorption"

Rule/Form/OM: Rule 15(2), 15(3), Expl. (1)(i)–(iii), Expl. (2) · **Topic:** Definitions

Q: Does Rule 15 cover department-to-PSU conversions and joint-sector undertakings? What is the "date of absorption" in each case?

A: Yes — Rule 15(1) applies on **conversion of a Govt department into a PSU/AB** [15(2)] and on absorption in **joint-sector undertakings** wholly under joint control of Central+State/UT(s) or of two or more States/UTs [15(3)]. "Date of absorption" [Expl. (1)]: **(i)** immediate absorption — date of **actual joining**; **(ii)** initially on foreign-service terms — date from which his **unqualified resignation is accepted by the Government**; **(iii)** department conversion — date his **absorption option is accepted by the Government**. "Body" = autonomous or statutory body [Expl. (2)].

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: Match-the-following favourite — deputation-then-absorption uses the **resignation-acceptance** date, not the deputation start date.

Source/Status: Bare Rules · **Linked cards:** N-055

Module 9 — Invalidation, Disablement, Penalties & Death (Rules 16–20)

CARD #057 · Rules 16(1)-(2) — RPwD Act protection; who may apply

Rule/Form/OM: Rule 16(1)–(2) + provisos; Sec. 20 RPwD Act, 2016 (49 of 2016); RPwD Rules, 2017 · **Topic:** Disability protection

Q: How does Sec. 20 of the RPwD Act, 2016 interact with Rule 16, and who may apply for invalidation if the subscriber is incapacitated?

A: Where Sec. 20 RPwD Act applies (no reduction in rank/pay on acquiring disability; shift to a suitable post or a **supernumerary post**), the case is governed by Sec. 20 on producing a disability certificate under the RPwD Rules, 2017 [16(1) + proviso]. Even then, if he applies for invalidation retirement, he must first be **advised of his right to continue with the same pay matrix and benefits**; the request is processed only if he does not withdraw it [2nd proviso to 16(2)]. Application is made to the **HOD**; if the subscriber cannot apply due to bodily/mental infirmity, the **spouse**, failing which a **family member** (to the HOD's satisfaction), may apply [16(2) + 1st proviso].

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: Priority order: subscriber → spouse → family member. Skipping the mandatory counselling vitiates the proceedings where Sec. 20 applies.

Source/Status: Bare Rules · **Linked cards:** N-058, App. E.7

CARD #058 · Rules 16(3)-(8) — medical examination procedure

Rule/Form/OM: Rule 16(3)–(8); Form 3 · **Topic:** Timeline / threshold

Q: State the timelines, the medical-authority threshold, the lady-doctor rule, Form number, age statement and the lower-post rule.

A: HOO/HOD requests the medical authority within **15 days** of the application; examination within **30 days** of receipt, with an **official age statement** (Service Book age must be reported) and a copy of the letter **endorsed to the subscriber** [16(3)]. Medical authority: **(a) Medical Board** for all **Gazetted** servants and for non-Gazetted servants whose pay (FR 9(21)) **exceeds ₹54,000 per mensem**; **(b) Civil Surgeon / DMO / equivalent MO** otherwise [16(3)(a)–(b)] — verified in the Gazette text. The subscriber must appear; the authority tests fitness for further service **or for less laborious service** [16(4)]. No incapacity certificate without the HOO/HOD request [16(5)]. A **lady doctor** sits on the Board when a woman is examined [16(6)]. Certificate in **Form 3** [16(7)]. If fit only for less laborious service and **willing**, employ on a lower post; if no means even on a lower post, grant invalidation benefits [16(8)].

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: Boundary value — non-Gazetted at **exactly ₹54,000** → Civil Surgeon/DMO (Board only when pay **exceeds** ₹54,000); Gazetted → always Board. Timelines 15 + 30 days; Form 3.

Source/Status: Bare Rules (₹54,000 and 15/30-day timelines verified against CPAO booklet/Gazette) · **Linked cards:** N-075, App. B, App. C

CARD #059 · Rules 16(9)-(12) — corpus settlement on invalidation

Rule/Form/OM: Rule 16(9)–(12) · **Topic:** Corpus settlement

Q: What happens to the IPA on invalidation retirement, under OPS/EOP option vs NPS option?

A:

Contingency	Option/default = OPS/EOP	Option/default = NPS
Invalidation (not attributable to service) [16(9)–(12)]	Invalid pension under CCS (Pension) Rules; IPA closed; **Government contribution + returns → Government account**; **employee contribution + returns → lump sum to subscriber**	Superannuation-level NPS exit (60:40) [16(11)]; may continue IPA/defer [16(12)]

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: Since the 2021 Rules (and OM dt. 14.10.2024 retrospectively from 01.01.2004), only the **Government share** is forfeited on OPS election — the old OM dt. 05.05.2009 forfeited the **entire** corpus.

Source/Status: Bare Rules; DoPPW OM dt. 14.10.2024 (verified) · **Linked cards:** N-060, N-063, N-080

CARD #060 · Rules 17(1)–(4) — disablement attributable to service

Rule/Form/OM: Rule 17(1)–(4); CCS (EOP) Rules, 2023 · **Topic:** Corpus settlement

Q: What happens on boarding out for disablement attributable to Government service?

A: OPS/EOP option/default → **disability pension under CCS (EOP) Rules, 2023** (G.S.R. 63(E) dt. 30.01.2023); IPA closed; Government share + returns → Government account; employee share + returns → subscriber in lump sum. NPS option → **superannuation-level (60:40) exit** [17(3)]; IPA continuation/deferment [17(4)]. EOP Categories A–E (ordinary / attributable-aggravated / duty accidents / violence by terrorists etc. / notified war-like operations) apply with liberalised awards [percentages — VERIFY against G.S.R. 63(E) text].

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: Attributable disablement routes to the **EOP Rules** (not ordinary invalid pension), but the corpus split is identical to Rule 16.

Source/Status: Bare Rules + CCS (EOP) Rules, 2023; [VERIFY] category percentages · **Linked cards:** N-059, N-064

CARD #061 · Rule 18 — dismissal / removal / compulsory retirement as penalty

Rule/Form/OM: Rule 18(1)–(2) + proviso · **Topic:** Penalty

Q: Is the NPS corpus forfeited on dismissal/removal/penal compulsory retirement?

A: No. Lump sum + annuity are paid **as on exit before superannuation — max 20% lump sum / min 80% annuity (100% if corpus ≤ ₹5 lakh)** [18(1)]. The subscriber may continue the **same PRAN** as a non-Government subscriber (proviso). But Rule 18(2) is without prejudice to **gratuity and other retirement benefits** — gratuity is forfeited on dismissal/removal (compassionate gratuity ≤ ⅔ possible) or reduced on penal compulsory retirement under the CCS (Payment of Gratuity under NPS) Rules, 2021.

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: Under OPS, dismissal forfeits pension **and** gratuity; under NPS the corpus (incl. the 14% Government contributions) is **not** forfeited — only 20:80 premature exit applies. Under UPS, assured payout and gratuity are forfeited on dismissal/removal (N-087).

Source/Status: Bare Rules + PFRDA Regulation (Dec 2025) + Gratuity Rules · **Linked cards:** N-062, N-086, App. E.2

CARD #062 · Rule 19 — pending proceedings at retirement

Rule/Form/OM: Rule 19(1)–(2); DoPPW OM dt. 27.10.2022 · **Topic:** Penalty vs pendency

Q: Can pending departmental/judicial proceedings withhold the NPS corpus of a retiring subscriber?

A: No. Proceedings instituted in service (unconcluded) or after retirement **shall not affect** corpus benefits — full **superannuation-level (60:40)** lump sum + annuity is paid [19(1)]. But **gratuity may be withheld/withdrawn** during pending proceedings and for grave misconduct/pecuniary loss under the Gratuity Rules [19(2); OM dt. 27.10.2022].

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: Contrast Rule 18 (concluded penalty → 20:80) vs Rule 19 (pending at retirement → full 60:40 corpus; only gratuity withheld).

Source/Status: Bare Rules; DoPPW OM dt. 27.10.2022 (verified) · **Linked cards:** N-061, N-063, App. E.2

CARD #063 · Rule 20 — death in service

Rule/Form/OM: Rule 20(1)(a)–(b) + proviso, 20(2), 20(3) · **Topic:** Death

Q: Explain Rule 20 on death of a subscriber (serving, or retired invalid/disability pensioner).

A: HOO disburses **family pension under CCS (Pension) Rules** on death of (a) a serving subscriber whose option/default is OPS/EOP, or (b) a retired subscriber in receipt of **invalid pension (Rule 16) or disability pension (Rule 17)** [20(1)]. **Proviso:** if death is **attributable to Government service**, benefits are under the **CCS (EOP) Rules, 2023**. Corpus settlement where OPS/EOP pension is paid [20(2)]: Government

contribution + returns → Government account; **employee contribution + returns → lump sum to the PFRDA nominee** (failing nomination, legal heirs — **not** Form 2 priority). If option/default = NPS: benefits under PFRDA Exit Regulations [20(3)].

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: Subtle split — family pension follows **Form 2/CCS (Pension) Rules** eligibility; the employee's corpus lump sum follows the **PFRDA nomination**, then legal heirs. Post-retirement OPS family pension applies **only** to Rule 16/17 pensioners, not to NPS-annuity retirees.

Source/Status: Bare Rules · **Linked cards:** N-043, N-059, N-064

CARD #064 · Invalidation/disablement gratuity — death-gratuity slabs

Rule/Form/OM: Rule 22 CCS (Payment of Gratuity under NPS) Rules, 2021; DoPPW OM No. 57/03/2022-P&PW(B)/8361(1) dt. 28.10.2022 · **Topic:** Cross-rule

Q: What gratuity does a subscriber with only 3 years' service get on invalidation/disablement discharge?

A: Death-gratuity slab rates with **no 5-year minimum**: <1 yr = 2× emoluments; 1 to <5 yrs = 6×; 5 to <11 yrs = 12×; 11 to <20 yrs = 20×; ≥20 yrs = ½ emoluments per completed 6-monthly period, max 33×, subject to the **₹25 lakh** ceiling. So 3 years' service → **6× monthly emoluments** (OM dt. 28.10.2022 read with Rule 22).

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: Normal retirement/VRS needs 5 years for retirement gratuity; invalidation/disablement gets death-gratuity slabs from day 1.

Source/Status: Gratuity Rules (Bare Rules) + DoPPW OM dt. 28.10.2022; [VERIFY] "Rule 22" numbering of the Gratuity Rules · **Linked cards:** N-086, App. C

Module 10 — Exit Processing, Deputation & Residual Rules (Rules 21–30)

CARD #065 · Rule 21 — quarterly retirement list

Rule/Form/OM: Rule 21(1)–(4) · **Topic:** Timeline

Q: Detail the quarterly retirement-list calendar and the non-superannuation intimation.

A: Every **HOD** prepares a list every quarter — **1st January, 1st April, 1st July, 1st October** — of subscribers retiring in the **next 12–15 months**; copy to the **PAO** by **31 January / 30 April / 31 July / 31 October** respectively [21(1)–(2)]. The **HOO** promptly informs DDO and PAO of any **non-superannuation** retirement [21(3)], and endorses a copy to the **Directorate of Estates** if the subscriber is a Government-accommodation allottee [21(4)].

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: HOD prepares the superannuation look-ahead list (12–15 months); HOO sends the prompt non-superannuation intimation.

Source/Status: Bare Rules · **Linked cards:** N-066, App. B

CARD #066 · Rule 22 — No Demand Certificate for accommodation allottees

Rule/Form/OM: Rule 22(1)–(2) · **Topic:** Timeline

Q: When must the HOO write to the Directorate of Estates for an NDC, and what period does it cover?

A: At least **one year (12 months)** before the anticipated retirement of an allottee, for issue of a **No Demand Certificate** in respect of the period **preceding eight months** of retirement [22(1)] ("eight months" — VERIFY against Gazette text); the Directorate acts on receipt [22(2)].

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: Two distinct numbers in one rule: **12 months** (advance letter) vs **8 months** (NDC coverage period).

Source/Status: Bare Rules; [VERIFY] "eight months" figure · **Linked cards:** N-065, App. B

CARD #067 · Rule 23 — claim submission

Rule/Form/OM: Rule 23(1)–(3) · **Topic:** Timeline

Q: When and how must the subscriber submit the withdrawal claim?

A: Through a mode specified by PFRDA (online or physical) [23(1)]. Superannuation: duly filled withdrawal form + documents to the **HOO 6 months before superannuation OR on the date of proceeding on LPR — whichever is EARLIER**; even for online claims, a **signed print-out + documents** must be given to the HOO [23(2)]. Non-superannuation exits: **immediately after** the competent authority's orders [23(2)]. The CRA generates **Claim IDs** and informs nodal officers (PAO/CDDO) **6 months before superannuation** [23(3)].

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: 4(9) = "whichever is **later**"; 23(2) = "whichever is **earlier**". Online submission does not dispense with the signed print-out to HOO.

Source/Status: Bare Rules · **Linked cards:** N-024, N-068, App. B

CARD #068 · Rule 24 — forwarding papers (Forms 4-A to 4-E)

Rule/Form/OM: Rule 24(1)–(4); PFRDA Dec-2025 amendment · **Topic:** Timeline

Q: Give the countdown for HOO→PAO and PAO→CRA, and the continuation/deferment option.

A: HOO forwards completed papers to PAO **through the DDO** using Form 4-A/4-B/4-C/4-D/4-E, retaining a copy [24(1)]. HOO→PAO: superannuation — **not later than 4 months before** retirement; **all other exits — not later than 1 month after** the exit [24(2)]. PAO→CRA (after online processing): **not later than 1 month before** retirement [24(3)]. Continuation/deferment option: bare text of 24(4) — to PAO through DDO **not later**

than 15 days before superannuation; the **PFRDA Dec-2025 amendment removed the mandatory 15-day prior intimation**, enabling automatic continuation up to **age 85** unless exit is exercised (verified).

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: Dual-layer answer: bare Rule 24(4) says 15 days; under the Dec-2025 PFRDA amendment the 15-day prior intimation is no longer mandatory.

Source/Status: Bare Rules + PFRDA Regulation (Dec 2025, verified) · **Linked cards:** N-072 – N-077, App. B

CARD #069 · Rule 25 — retirement while on deputation/foreign service

Rule/Form/OM: Rule 25(1)–(2) · **Topic:** Authority

Q: Who authorises NPS benefits if the subscriber retires while on deputation?

A: (a) Deputation to **another Central Government department** → **borrowing department's HOO** [25(1)]. (b) Deputation to a **State Government** or on **foreign service** → the **lending HOO / cadre authority** that sanctioned the deputation [25(2)].

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: Central→Central = borrowing HOO; Central→State or foreign service = lending HOO/cadre authority.

Source/Status: Bare Rules · **Linked cards:** N-029, App. E.6

CARD #070 · Rule 26 — notification of retirement

Rule/Form/OM: Rule 26(a)–(b) · **Topic:** Timeline

Q: How and within what time must the retirement of a Gazetted vs non-Gazetted subscriber be notified?

A: Within **a week (7 days)** of the retirement date: **(a)** Gazetted subscriber — **notification in the Official Gazette**; **(b)** non-Gazetted — **office order**; a copy is forwarded **immediately to the PAO** in both cases.

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: Gazette notification vs office order; 7-day deadline; immediate copy to PAO.

Source/Status: Bare Rules · **Linked cards:** App. B

CARD #071 · Rules 27–30 — interpretation, relaxation, residuary, repeal

Rule/Form/OM: Rules 27, 28 + proviso, 29(1)–(2), 30 · **Topic:** Residual

Q: State Rules 27–30.

A: Rule 27: interpretation doubts → **Government in MoPPGP** (DoPPW). **Rule 28:** a Ministry/Department may, by order with **reasons recorded in writing**, dispense with/relax a rule causing **undue hardship**, but **only with the concurrence of MoPPGP** (proviso). **Rule 29(1):** residuary related issues decided per CCS (Pension) Rules, FR, SR or general/special Govt orders, provided **not repugnant/inconsistent** with these Rules; 29(2): Central Govt may issue orders for unprovided matters. **Rule 30:** prior orders/OMs cease to operate only **in so far as** they cover matters in these Rules; saving clause deems prior actions taken under corresponding provisions.

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: Rule 28 names **only MoPPGP** for concurrence; prior OMs are not repealed in toto.

Source/Status: Bare Rules · **Linked cards:** N-002, App. F

Module 11 — Statutory Forms (Form 1, Form 2, Form 3, Forms 4-A to 4-E)

CARD #072 · Forms master match

Rule/Form/OM: Forms 1, 2, 3; Rule 24(1) table (Forms 4-A to 4-E) · **Topic:** Forms

Q: Match all eight statutory forms with their rule and use.

A:

Form	Rule	Use
Form 1	Rule 10(1)	Option for OPS/EOP vs NPS benefits on death / invalidation / disability during service
Form 2	Rule 10(3)	Details of family
Form 3	Rule 16(7)	Medical certificate (incapacity / less laborious service)
Form 4-A	Rule 24(1)	HOO→PAO covering letter: superannuation / VRS (Rule 12) / FR 56(k) / FR 56(j) / SVRS — all 60:40 exits
Form 4-B	Rule 24(1)	Technical resignation OR absorption in AB/PSU
Form 4-C	Rule 24(1)	Resignation / compulsory retirement as penalty / dismissal / removal — 20:80 exits (90-day rule for resignation)
Form 4-D	Rule 24(1)	Retirement on invalidation or disablement
Form 4-E	Rule 24(1)	Death during service (incl. Rule 10(7) infructuous-option case)

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: Mnemonic — **A**=Age/normal exits (60:40); **B**=Body/absorption/technical resignation; **C**=Conduct penalty/resignation (20:80); **D**=Disability/invalidation; **E**=Expired (death). Some CPAO booklet TOCs misprint Form 4-D — Rule 24(1) and the form headings govern.

Source/Status: Bare Rules · **Linked cards:** N-073 – N-077, App. D

CARD #073 · Form 1 & Form 2 — statutory notes

Rule/Form/OM: Form 1 note; Form 2 notes 1–4 · **Topic:** Forms

Q: What are the key printed instructions on Forms 1 and 2?

A: Form 1: receiving officer fills the acknowledgement and returns a **duly signed copy** to the servant for safe custody. Form 2: **(1)** the **original Form 2 is never substituted** during service — additions/alterations are recorded in **Column 7 under the HOO's signature**, though family details must be submitted **afresh at retirement**; **(2)** list **spouse, all children, and parents** (whether or not currently eligible) plus disabled siblings; **(3)** HOO records receipt dates, disability facts, marital-status changes in the Remarks column; **(4)** "wife"/"husband" **include a judicially separated** spouse (a divorced spouse is not included); birth certificates to be attached.

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: Original Form 2 permanence + judicially-separated-spouse inclusion are classic SAS/LDCE questions.

Source/Status: Bare Rules (Forms) · **Linked cards:** N-040, N-072

CARD #074 · Form 3 — medical certificate contents

Rule/Form/OM: Form 3 [Rule 16(7)] · **Topic:** Forms

Q: What does Form 3 certify?

A: Whether the subscriber is **completely and permanently incapacitated** for further service of any kind in his department (in consequence of specified disease/accident), **or** fit only for **less laborious** service; whether the incapacity **does not appear to have been caused by irregular or intemperate habits**; and his **age by own statement and by appearance**.

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: The "irregular or intemperate habits" clause and dual age recording (statement vs appearance) are repeatedly asked.

Source/Status: Bare Rules (Forms) · **Linked cards:** N-058, N-072

CARD #075 · Forms 4-A to 4-E — signature, addressee, routing

Rule/Form/OM: Forms 4-A to 4-E [Rule 24(1)] · **Topic:** Routing

Q: Who signs Forms 4-A to 4-E, to whom are they addressed, and through whom routed?

A: Signed by the **Head of Office (HOO)**; addressed to the **Pay and Accounts Officer / Accountant-General**; routed **"(Through the Drawing and Disbursing Officer)"**. PAO then processes online and forwards to the **CRA** [Rule 24(3)].

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: HOO never sends these forms directly to the CRA.

Source/Status: Bare Rules (Forms) · **Linked cards:** N-068, N-076, N-077

CARD #076 · Form 4-A & 4-B — internal alternative clauses

Rule/Form/OM: Form 4-A, Form 4-B [Rule 24(1)] · **Topic:** Forms

Q: What exit scenarios are printed (strike-out style) inside Forms 4-A and 4-B?

A: Form 4-A (all get 60:40): (1) superannuation on [date] [Rule 11]; (2) VRS notice accepted under **Rule 12 or FR 56(k) or DoPT SVRS**; (3) retirement order under **FR 56(j) or SVRS** [Rule 13]. **Form 4-B** (technical resignation / absorption): (A) NPS exists in new body — **same PRAN continues, no benefit at absorption** [1st proviso to 15(1) / 14(2)]; (B) no NPS + subscriber opts to exit — release superannuation-level benefits [15(1) / 1st proviso to 14(2)]; (C) no NPS + subscriber opts to continue — same PRAN as non-Government subscriber [2nd provisos].

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: FR 56(k) is printed inside Form 4-A; technical resignation is processed via Form 4-B.

Source/Status: Bare Rules (Forms) · **Linked cards:** N-050, N-052, N-055

CARD #077 · Forms 4-C, 4-D, 4-E — internal clauses

Rule/Form/OM: Forms 4-C, 4-D, 4-E [Rule 24(1)] · **Topic:** Forms

Q: Detail the branches inside Forms 4-C, 4-D and 4-E.

A: Form 4-C: (i) penalty of compulsory retirement/dismissal/removal [Rule 18] or (ii) resignation accepted w.e.f. [date] [Rule 14(1)] — PAO to release pre-superannuation exit benefits **after the 90-day bar in resignation cases** (unless death within 90 days) or record the same-PRAN continuation option. **Form 4-D** (invalidation Rule 16 / disablement Rule 17): Branch 1 (OPS/EOP) — close IPA, transfer Government share + returns to Government account, pay employee share + returns in lump sum; Branch 2 (NPS) — superannuation-level exit or continuation/deferment. **Form 4-E** (death in service, Rule 20): Branch 1 (OPS/EOP, not infructuous) — Government share to Government account; employee share lump sum to PFRDA nominee/legal heirs; Branch 2 (NPS option/default **or infructuous OPS option under Rule 10(7)**) — full NPS death benefits under PFRDA regulations.

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: Form 4-E expressly covers the Rule 10(7) infructuous case so legal heirs get 100% of the corpus.

Source/Status: Bare Rules (Forms) · **Linked cards:** N-043, N-059, N-061, N-063

Module 12 — OMs, Amendments & Sister Rules (2022–2026)

CARD #078 · Missing employees — OM 28.04.2022 + PFRDA Dec-2025 + BSA Sec. 111

Rule/Form/OM: DoPPW OM dt. 28.04.2022; PFRDA Exit Amendment (Dec 2025); Sec. 111 Bharatiya Sakshya Adhiniyam, 2023 (w.e.f. 01.07.2024, replacing Sec. 108 Evidence Act, 1872); Gratuity Amendment Rules 2025 · **Topic:** Current affairs

Q: How are benefits regulated when an NPS-covered employee goes missing?

A: Family lodges an **FIR** + police report that the employee is untraceable. OPS/EOP option/default (OM 28.04.2022 — verified): **family pension, arrears of salary, leave encashment and retirement gratuity** to the family (retirement gratuity not before **6 months from the FIR** per the 2025 Gratuity amendment); PRAN remains **suspended**; if he reappears, pension paid is recovered from salary and PRAN reactivated; on **presumption of death after 7 years** (Sec. 111 BSA, 2023) the death-gratuity differential is settled. NPS option/default (PFRDA Dec 2025 — verified): nominees/legal heirs get **20% of the corpus as interim relief**, remaining **80%** after formal presumption of death.

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: Never cite "Sec. 108 Evidence Act" alone — from 01.07.2024 it is **Sec. 111 BSA, 2023** (7-year presumption), referenced in the PFRDA Dec-2025 regulations.

Source/Status: DoPPW OM (verified) + PFRDA Regulation (verified) + BSA 2023; 6-month-FIR gratuity rule (verified in G.S.R. 258(E) text) · **Linked cards:** N-063, N-083, N-086

CARD #079 · OM 14.10.2024 — refund of employee's NPS share (pre-2021 cases)

Rule/Form/OM: DoPPW OM No. 57/06/2021-P&PW(B) dt. 14.10.2024; OM 38/41/06-P&PW(A) dt. 05.05.2009; CGA accounting procedure · **Topic:** Accounting

Q: What retrospective relief did the 14.10.2024 OM grant, with what interest and which Major Heads?

A: For pre-2021-rule death/invalidation/disablement cases settled under OM dt. 05.05.2009 (when the **entire** corpus went to the Government account, MH 0071), the OM aligned them with Rules 16(10)/17(2)/20(2) **w.e.f. 01.01.2004**: only the **Government contribution + returns** is retained; the **employee's contribution + returns is refunded** to the servant/nominee(s)/legal heirs **with PPF-rate interest** from death/boarding-out to payment. Reverse case (kept corpus + OPS pension): refund Government share + returns with **GPF-rate interest**. Accounting: employee share moved from **MH 0071** to **MH 8342-00-117 (Other Deposits — 117 Defined Contribution Pension Scheme for Government, 01 Government Servant Contribution, Tier-I)**; interest debit head [MH 2049 — VERIFY].

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: Government refunding employee share → **PPF** rate; employee refunding Government share → **GPF** rate. SAS/AAO accounting staple.

Source/Status: DoPPW OM dt. 14.10.2024 + CGA procedure (verified); [VERIFY] MH 2049 · **Linked cards:** N-059, N-093

CARD #080 · NPS oversight mechanism — reporting periodicity

Rule/Form/OM: DoE OM dt. 02.07.2019; DoPPW OMs dt. 04.06.2024 & 14.10.2024 · **Topic:** Current affairs

Q: What oversight reporting do Ministries/Departments owe on NPS implementation?

A: Each Ministry/Department maintains an **NPS Oversight Mechanism** to monitor timely registration, deduction and credit of contributions; per DoPPW OMs dt. 04.06.2024 & 14.10.2024, a **six-monthly (half-yearly) status report** must be submitted to DoPPW **exclusively through the NPS Oversight Mechanism Online Portal**.

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: Frequency = **six-monthly**, mode = online portal only.

Source/Status: DoPPW OMs [VERIFY exact file numbers on pensionindia/dopt portals] · **Linked cards:** N-093, App. F

CARD #081 · FMA for NPS pensioners

Rule/Form/OM: DoPPW OMs dt. 06.12.2023 [VERIFY] & 07.02.2025; CGA reference dt. 18.12.2024; DoE OM dt. 16.04.2026 · **Topic:** Current affairs

Q: Are NPS retirees eligible for Fixed Medical Allowance, at what rate, and what are the current payment rules?

A: Yes — ₹1,000 per month (parity with OPS pensioners) for retired Central Govt NPS subscribers residing in **non-CGHS areas** and not availing CGHS OPD. OM dt. 07.02.2025 (verified) revised the forms to include **PRAN** (application in triplicate to HOO with Form 2 of the NPS Rules + FMA-arrears nomination); FMA for **September–November is paid in the first week of December**; from December onwards payment is subject to the **annual life certificate submitted in November**. DoE OM dt. 16.04.2026 (verified): FMA is now credited **automatically and quarterly by the pension-disbursing bank's CPPC** on CPAO's Special Seal Authority — no bills required.

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: Even though an NPS retiree's annuity comes from an ASP, FMA flows through PAO/CPAO/bank with the November life certificate.

Source/Status: DoPPW OM dt. 07.02.2025 (verified); OM dt. 06.12.2023 and DoE OM dt. 16.04.2026 details [VERIFY file nos.] · **Linked cards:** N-095

CARD #082 · PFRDA Exit & Withdrawal Amendment Regulations, Dec 2025 — Govt-sector slabs

Rule/Form/OM: PFRDA (Exits and Withdrawals under the NPS) (Amendment) Regulations, 2025 (Gazette No. 8421 GI/2025; notified mid-December 2025 — commonly cited 16.12.2025 [VERIFY exact date: 12/15/16.12.2025]) · **Topic:** PFRDA exit slabs

Q: Summarise the current exit slabs for Government-sector subscribers.

A:

Exit type (Govt sector)	Corpus	Rule
Normal exit (superannuation / Rule 12 VRS / FR 56(j) / SVRS / invalidation / disablement / non-NPS absorption / death)	≤ ₹8 lakh (raised from ₹5 lakh)	100% lump sum, or SLW/SUR, or 60:40
Normal / death exit, middle slab	> ₹8 lakh to ≤ ₹12 lakh	Up to ₹6 lakh lump sum + balance as SUR (min 6 years) or annuity (or 60:40)
Normal / death exit, top slab	> ₹12 lakh	**Max 60% lump sum + min 40% annuity** (80:20 is **non-Govt only**)
Premature exit (resignation / dismissal / removal / penal compulsory retirement)	≤ ₹5 lakh (raised from ₹2.5 lakh)	100% lump sum or SLW/SUR (or 20:80)
Premature exit	> ₹5 lakh	Max 20% lump sum + min 80% annuity
Death (NPS opted/default)	as above (≤₹8L / ₹8–12L / >₹12L)	100% / up to ₹6L + balance (or 20:80) / up to 20% + default annuity
Entry & exit/deferment age	—	Raised to **85 years**; mandatory 15-day prior intimation removed — automatic continuation allowed
Renunciation of Indian citizenship	any amount	100% lump-sum closure permitted
Missing persons	any amount	20% interim relief to nominee/legal heirs; 80% after presumption of death

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: The **80% lump sum / 20% annuity** rule applies **only to non-Government** (All Citizen/Corporate) subscribers above ₹12 lakh; Government sector stays at 60:40 above ₹12 lakh.

Source/Status: PFRDA Regulation (Dec 2025) — slabs verified via PFRDA press release (19.12.2025) and Gazette; [VERIFY] exact notification date · **Linked cards:** N-044, N-051, N-061, N-083, N-085, App. C

CARD #083 · PFRDA (Amendment) Regulations, 2026 — Reg. 4A outsourcing liability

Rule/Form/OM: PFRDA (Exits and Withdrawals under the NPS) (Amendment) Regulations, 2026 — notified 13.07.2026, Gazette 14.07.2026 · **Topic:** PFRDA 2026

Q: What did the July 2026 amendment change?

A: It amended **Regulation 4A** of the 2015 Regulations (existing text renumbered as 4A(1)) and inserted **4A(2)–(4)**: a Pension Fund may engage another capable entity to operationalise a **specific-purpose scheme** per PFRDA guidelines, **but the Pension Fund remains responsible to the subscriber and liable for any act of omission or commission of the engaged entity** [4A(2)]; the engaged entity must have **technological capacity to integrate** with the Pension Fund/CRA/intermediaries [4A(3)]; both remain under PFRDA supervision [4A(4)]. **Withdrawal slabs (60:40 / ₹8L / ₹5L) were NOT changed** by this amendment.

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: July 2026 amendment = operational accountability only; December 2025 amendment = withdrawal slabs.

Source/Status: PFRDA Regulation — Gazette text verified · **Linked cards:** N-082

CARD #084 · Partial withdrawal — Dec 2025 rules

Rule/Form/OM: PFRDA Exit Amendment (Dec 2025), Reg. 8 as amended · **Topic:** Partial withdrawal

Q: State the current partial-withdrawal limits, frequency, gaps, lien and purposes.

A: After **3 years** of subscription; up to **25% of the subscriber's OWN contributions** (Government share and returns excluded). Frequency: **max 4 times before age 60/superannuation (raised from 3), with a minimum 4-year gap** between withdrawals; after age 60 (if account continues) **no cap, minimum 3-year gap**. Lien/loan: a regulated financial institution may mark a lien up to **25% of own contributions**. Purposes: (1) higher education of children (incl. adopted); (2) marriage of children; (3) **one-time** purchase/construction of a residential house (not if already owning a house other than ancestral); (4) **medical treatment/hospitalisation — broadened** (self, spouse, children, parents) + disability expenses; (5) **new:** settling a loan taken against a lien on the NPS account. **Removed:** skill development/re-skilling and starting a venture/start-up.

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: Triple alert — 4 times & 4-year gap (3-year after 60); 25% of **own** contributions; skill-development and start-up purposes removed.

Source/Status: PFRDA Regulation (Dec 2025) — verified via PFRDA press release and news; [VERIFY] "parents" vs "dependent parents" wording in Gazette · **Linked cards:** N-082, App. B

CARD #085 · CCS (Payment of Gratuity under NPS) Rules, 2021 + 2025 Amendment

Rule/Form/OM: G.S.R. 658(E) dt. 23.09.2021; DoPPW OM dt. 30.05.2024; Oct-2025 DoPPW clarification; G.S.R. 258(E) dt. 24.04.2025 · **Topic:** Gratuity

Q: Summarise the gratuity rules for NPS subscribers, the ₹25 lakh ceiling, and the 2025 amendments.

A: Principal Rules notified 23.09.2021 [G.S.R. 658(E) — verified]. Retirement gratuity: min **5 years** qualifying service; **¼ of emoluments (Basic + NPA + DA)** per completed 6-monthly period, max **16½×** emoluments. Death gratuity slabs: 2× / 6× / 12× / 20× / ½-per-6-months (max 33×), ceiling **₹25 lakh** — raised by 25% from ₹20 lakh **w.e.f. 01.01.2024** on DA reaching 50% (7th CPC) vide DoPPW OM dt. 30.05.2024 (verified); applies to CCS (Pension) Rules 2021 & Gratuity-under-NPS 2021 employees **only** — Oct-2025 clarification: **not suo-moto** to PSUs/banks/RBI/ABs/State Govts (verified). Amendment Rules 2025 [G.S.R. 258(E) dt. 24.04.2025 — verified]: **Rule 4A** — no separate gratuity for a re-employment spell; joining Govt from AB/PSU with proper permission — Govt pays only for Govt service, combined amount capped at what combined service would fetch on final Govt emoluments; **penal compulsory retirement** — if the quantum order is not simultaneous, **provisional gratuity at ⅔ of full superannuation gratuity** (final order within 3 months, UPSC consultation where needed); **missing persons** — retirement gratuity not before 6 months from FIR; AO verifies emoluments for the **24 months** preceding retirement [VERIFY]; on death, outstanding licence fee waived and family keeps quarters free for the **month of death + 3 months** [VERIFY]. Non-technical resignation forfeits gratuity [rule ref — VERIFY whether Rule 17 of the 2025-amended rules; OM No. 2/8/2025-P&PW(F), Oct 2025 [VERIFY]].

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: ₹25 lakh ceiling is a **Central Civil Service** figure — PSU/bank/RBI/AB employees have their own ceilings.

Source/Status: Bare Rules (Gratuity) + DoPPW OMs (verified where noted); [VERIFY] items flagged · **Linked cards:** N-051, N-061, N-064, N-086, App. C

CARD #086 · UPS Rules, 2025 — scheme architecture

Rule/Form/OM: CCS (Implementation of the UPS under NPS) Rules, 2025 — G.S.R. 599(E) dt. 02.09.2025; DFS (MoF) notification dt. 24.01.2025 [F.No. — VERIFY]; PFRDA UPS Regulations dt. 19.03.2025; DoPPW OMs dt. 18.06.2025 (×2) · **Topic:** UPS

Q: Give the UPS architecture vs NPS.

A: UPS is an **option under NPS** for Central Govt employees appointed on/after 01.01.2004, **effective 01.04.2025**; notified as G.S.R. 599(E) dt. 02.09.2025 (verified; made under proviso to Art. 309 + Art. 148(5) with C&AG consultation). Contributions: employee **10%**; Government **10% to the individual corpus + ~8.5% to a pool corpus = 18.5% total**. Assured payout at superannuation: **50% of the average basic pay of the last 12 months** for ≥25 years' qualifying service (proportionate for 10–25 years; **minimum ₹10,000/month** after ≥10 years) **plus dearness relief**. Lump sum at exit: **1/10th of monthly emoluments (Basic + DA) per completed 6-monthly period** of qualifying service. **Gratuity** under the Gratuity-under-NPS Rules (up to ₹25 lakh) and **death/disability OPS option** (Form 1-type) extended to UPS optees by the two DoPPW OMs dt. 18.06.2025 (verified via PIB). VRS under UPS: [draft said 25 years' qualifying service with payout from the notional superannuation date; other sources say 20 years with 3 months' notice — VERIFY against G.S.R. 599(E) Rule 13]. UPS option window: initially to 30.09.2025, later extended to 30.11.2025 [VERIFY]; new joiners get 30 days from joining.

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: UPS is **not** a repeal of the 2021 NPS Rules — non-optees continue under them (Rule 2(i) of the UPS Rules).

Source/Status: Bare Rules (UPS, verified) + DoPPW OMs 18.06.2025 (verified) + MoF/PFRDA notifications (dates verified; F.No. [VERIFY]); UPS VRS service condition [VERIFY] · **Linked cards:** N-087, N-088, N-094, App. E.1

CARD #087 · UPS — switch back to NPS and forfeiture on penalty

Rule/Form/OM: CCS (UPS under NPS) Rules, 2025 (Rule 11); MoF notification Aug-2025; DoPPW OMs dt. 29.10.2025 (series of 10) · **Topic:** UPS switch

Q: When can a UPS subscriber switch back to NPS once, when is it barred, and how is the 4% gap settled? What happens on dismissal/removal under UPS?

A: One-time, one-way switch back to NPS, exercisable any time **not later than** (a) **12 months before superannuation**, (b) **3 months before the deemed VRS date**, or (c) **at the time of resignation or non-penal FR 56(j) compulsory retirement** (verified). **Barred** where departmental/judicial proceedings are pending or contemplated, or in cases of **removal, dismissal, or penal compulsory retirement**. On switching, the **4% differential** (14% − 10%) for the UPS period is computed on the **default investment pattern** and credited to the individual NPS corpus **at exit**; future Government contributions resume at 14% (verified via MoF notification). Under UPS, **dismissal/removal forfeits the assured payout and gratuity**, but the accumulated individual corpus is still paid as lump sum to the subscriber/legal spouse/heirs (per DoPPW OMs dt. 29.10.2025 [VERIFY individual OM subjects]).

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: After switching to NPS, PFRDA Exit Regulations apply and assured payout lapses; the 4% is credited **at exit**, not immediately.

Source/Status: Bare Rules (UPS) + MoF notification (verified) + DoPPW OMs 29.10.2025 [VERIFY per-OM subjects] · **Linked cards:** N-086, N-094

CARD #088 · Railway & AIS sister rules — 2025/2026

Rule/Form/OM: Railway Services (Implementation of NPS) Rules, 2025 — G.S.R. 735(E) dt. 01.10.2025 (RBE 103/2025 dt. 08.10.2025); Railway UPS Rules, 2026 (effective 21.09.2026 [VERIFY Gazette no.]); AIS (Implementation of NPS) Rules, 2026 — G.S.R. 307(E) dt. 22.04.2026 · **Topic:** Sister rules

Q: Summarise the sister-rule position for Railway and AIS employees.

A: Railway servants (excluded by Rule 2(a)) are governed by the Railway NPS Rules 2025 (G.S.R. 735(E) dt. 01.10.2025, RBE 103/2025 — verified), made under the **proviso to Art. 309 only**; a parallel Railway UPS Rules 2026 (effective 21.09.2026) extends UPS to railway servants [VERIFY]. **AIS members** (excluded by Rule 2(d)) are governed by the AIS NPS Rules 2026 (G.S.R. 307(E) dt. 22.04.2026 — verified), made under **Sec. 3(1) AIS Act, 1951** after consultation with State Governments; officers under AIS (DCRB) Rules, 1958 by order remain outside. [NE-cadre 15-year VRS under the AIS Rules — VERIFY.]

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: Three different enacting powers — Art. 309 proviso + Art. 148(5) (CCS), Art. 309 proviso only (Railways), Sec. 3(1) AIS Act (AIS).

Source/Status: Bare Rules — G.S.R. numbers/dates verified; [VERIFY] flagged items · **Linked cards:** N-009, N-010, N-094

CARD #089 · Income-tax treatment — 1961 Act vs Income-tax Act, 2025

Rule/Form/OM: Income-tax Act, 1961 (43 of 1961); Income-tax Act, 2025 (w.e.f. 01.04.2026 / TY 2026-27) · **Topic:** Taxation

Q: Summarise NPS tax benefits under both regimes and the renumbering under the Income-tax Act, 2025.

A: Old regime: employee Tier-I contribution within **Sec. 80CCD(1)** (10% of pay+DA, inside the ₹1.5 lakh 80C/80CCE cap); extra **₹50,000 under Sec. 80CCD(1B)**; employer contribution **Sec. 80CCD(2)** — 14% for Central/State Govt (10% private), subject to the ₹7.5 lakh aggregate employer cap; Tier-II within 80C (3-year lock-in). New regime: from FY 2025-26 (w.e.f. 01.04.2025) only **employer contribution up to 14% of salary (Basic + DA) is deductible** for all employers (Budget 2025 change — verified); own contributions (80CCD(1)/(1B)) are **not** deductible. **Income-tax Act, 2025** (w.e.f. 01.04.2026): old 80C/80CCD(1)-type own contributions → **Sec. 123 read with Schedule XV**; old 80CCD → **Sec. 124** (employer contribution 124(2) allowed in **both** regimes; extra ₹50,000 = 124(3), old regime only) [VERIFY sub-clause mapping against the Act]; exit lump sum up to **60%** exempt (old Sec. 10(12A); 100% where corpus ≤ ₹8 lakh) and partial withdrawal up to **25% of own contributions** exempt (old Sec. 10(12B)) → exempt-income Schedule in the 2025 Act [VERIFY]; annuity is taxable at slab rates; annuity purchase price is not taxed at exit.

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: In the **new regime** the only NPS deduction is the employer's 14% (Sec. 124(2) in the 2025 Act); 60% lump-sum exemption continues.

Source/Status: Income-tax Act 1961 + Income-tax Act 2025; Budget-2025 14% change verified; [VERIFY] exact new section/sub-clause mapping and Sec. 397(3) correspondence of Sec. 201(1A) · **Linked cards:** N-037, N-082, N-084, App. C

CARD #090 · Recent DoPPW clarifications (2025–2026) — [VERIFY] items

Rule/Form/OM: DoPPW OM dt. 26.12.2025 (military + civil gratuity cap); DoPPW OM series No. 57/03/2022-P&PW(B)/8361 dt. 27.10.2026; OM dt. 22.06.2026 (compassionate appointments); OM No. 2/8/2025-P&PW(F) Oct 2025 (resignation gratuity); CPAO OM dt. 19.10.2026 (PPPO→PPO SOP) · **Topic:** Current affairs

Q: Summarise these late-2025/2026 items as claimed in the draft.

A: (1) **OM dt. 26.12.2025**: a re-employed ex-serviceman who drew military gratuity can still get **separate civil retirement gratuity** under NPS, but military + civil gratuity together cannot exceed what **combined service** would fetch on civil emoluments, subject to the **₹25 lakh** ceiling. (2) **OM series 57/03/2022-P&PW(B)/8361 dt. 27.10.2026**: strict-compliance batch — probation contributions mandatory (Rule 6(6)); no subscriber contribution on unpaid absence and employer notional contribution only for the three proviso grounds; delayed-credit compensation under Rule 8(1); Rule 25 deputation routing; unconcluded proceedings at retirement continue as deemed proceedings under **Rule 5 of the Gratuity Rules** with full notional payout on exoneration. (One 27.10.2026 OM on UPS contributions during absence without pay is verified.) (3) **OM dt. 22.06.2026**: compassionate-appointment OPS eligibility date clarification. (4) **OM No. 2/8/2025-P&PW(F) (Oct 2025)**: resignation (non-technical) → zero gratuity. (5) **CPAO Revised SOP dt. 19.10.2026**: migration of legacy NPS-AR provisional pensioners (PPPO) to regular OPS PPOs — CPAO sends a **scanned disburser portion of the PPPO** to the PAO (no upfront physical recall); PAO verifies records and issues a new regular PPO (old PPPO number + PRAN) + SSA; bank CPPC starts the new PPO and stops the PPPO

on the same date (no gap/double payment); old booklet collected later.

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: These are the newest items — all specific file numbers/dates beyond the verified 27.10.2026 UPS-absence OM are **[VERIFY]** against doptcirculars.nic.in / cpao.nic.in before quoting in an exam.

Source/Status: Current-affairs update — [VERIFY] each item (see Appendix I.2) · **Linked cards:** N-085, N-086, N-093

CARD #091 · DoPPW thematic OM series 57/03/2022-P&PW(B)/8361 — Oct 2022 & Oct 2024 batches

Rule/Form/OM: DoPPW OM series No. 57/03/2022-P&PW(B)/8361 · **Topic:** Amendment tracker

Q: Has the bare text of G.S.R. 227(E) been amended by Gazette Amendment Rules since 30.03.2021, or operationalised through OMs?

A: Up to 01.11.2026 the 30 Rules and Forms of G.S.R. 227(E) remain the principal statutory text — **no Gazette Amendment Rules** to the CCS (NPS) Rules, 2021 themselves; changes have come through (a) sister Gazette rules (Gratuity 2021 amended G.S.R. 258(E) 24.04.2025; UPS G.S.R. 599(E) 02.09.2025; Railway G.S.R. 735(E) 01.10.2025; AIS G.S.R. 307(E) 22.04.2026) and (b) PFRDA Amendment Regulations (Dec 2025; 13.07.2026), plus DoPPW thematic OMs: **Oct 2022 batch** — 25.10.2022 (Rule 5 emoluments), 26.10.2022 (Rule 10 option), 27.10.2022 (Rules 18–19 disciplinary & gratuity), 28.10.2022 (Rules 16–17 + Rule 20 death; death gratuity) [subjects verified]; **Oct 2024 batch (8361(1)-(9))** — 07.10.2024 (8361(1) Rule 6 employee share; 8361(4) Rule 15 absorption — verified), 11.10.2024 (Rule 12 VRS 60:40; Rule 14 resignation; Rule 18 dismissal), 14.10.2024 (oversight portal + pre-2021 refund), 25.10.2024 (8361(8) autonomous bodies — verified; 8361(9) Form 1/2 campaign).

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: If asked "were the 2021 Rules repealed by UPS Rules 2025 or amended to forfeit corpus on dismissal?" — **no** on both counts.

Source/Status: DoPPW OMs (batch dates/subjects largely verified; individual file suffixes [VERIFY]) · **Linked cards:** N-079, N-080, N-085, N-086, App. F.4

CARD #092 · Bhavishya / e-HRMS / integrated pension forms

Rule/Form/OM: Rules 20–24 processing; DoPPW Bhavishya mandates; CCS (Pension) Rules, 2021 amendment introducing integrated **Form 6-A** [OM dt. 16.07.2024 — VERIFY] · **Topic:** Digital processing

Q: How are pension/exit claims processed digitally for Central Govt NPS subscribers?

A: DoPPW mandates **100% electronic processing through Bhavishya** (integrated with PFMS, e-HRMS 2.0, CPAO and the CRA). Where OPS invalid/disability/family pension (Rules 16(9), 17(1), 20(1)) or gratuity is claimed, forms are filed online on Bhavishya using the **integrated single Form 6-A** (replacing the old separate Forms 4 & 6 — introduced by the CCS (Pension) Rules, 2021 amendment of 16.07.2024 [VERIFY date]) and the e-PPO is pushed to DigiLocker.

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: Bhavishya/Form 6-A apply to the **pension-side** claims; the NPS exit itself still runs through the CRA/PAO chain of Rules 23–24.

Source/Status: DoPPW OM / CCS (Pension) Rules 2021 amendment — [VERIFY] 16.07.2024 OM number · **Linked cards:** N-067, N-068

CARD #093 · Re-employment, commercial employment & residual service rules

Rule/Form/OM: Rule 29(1); Rule 5(7); Gratuity Rule 4A (2025); DoPT commercial-employment orders · **Topic:** Residual

Q: Do post-retirement service restrictions apply to NPS retirees, and what happens on re-employment?

A: Via Rule 29(1), unprovided matters follow CCS (Pension) Rules/FR/SR/Govt orders (if not repugnant). **Commercial employment within 1 year of retirement** by a retired Group A officer requires prior Government sanction (DoPT service-condition orders) — the NPS annuity itself is not forfeited (corpus is governed by the PFRDA Act). On **re-employment in Central Govt**: the deducted pension element is **added back** for NPS emoluments [Rule 5(7)], and **no separate gratuity** is admissible for the re-employment spell [Gratuity Rule 4A, G.S.R. 258(E) — verified].

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: Link Rule 5(7) (pension add-back for contributions) with Rule 4A (no double gratuity).

Source/Status: Bare Rules + Gratuity Amendment Rules 2025 (verified) + DoPT orders · **Linked cards:** N-030, N-085

CARD #094 · Master matrix — OPS vs CCS NPS vs UPS vs Railway/AIS

Rule/Form/OM: CCS (Pension) Rules 2021 (G.S.R. 868(E) dt. 20.12.2021); G.S.R. 227(E); G.S.R. 599(E); G.S.R. 735(E); G.S.R. 307(E) · **Topic:** Comparison

Q: Compare the five regimes on core parameters.

A:

Parameter	OPS [CCS (Pension) Rules, 2021]	CCS NPS 2021	CCS UPS 2025	Railway 2025 / AIS 2026
Employee : Govt share	0% (GPF separate); defined benefit	10% : 14% (rounded up to next ₹)	10% : 10% + 8.5% pool (18.5% total)	10% : 14% (rounded up)
VRS minimum service	20 yrs qualifying [Rule 43]	20 yrs regular (all sanctioned EOL counts) [Rule 12]	[VERIFY: 20 vs 25 yrs — draft said 25]	20 yrs [AIS NE cadres: 15 yrs — VERIFY]
Dismissal / removal	Pension & gratuity forfeited	Corpus **not** forfeited — 20:80 exit; gratuity forfeited [Rule 18]	Assured payout & gratuity forfeited; individual corpus paid as lump sum	Corpus not forfeited — 20:80 exit
Pending proceedings at retirement	Provisional pension; gratuity withheld	Full 60:40 corpus paid; only gratuity withheld [Rule 19]	Regulated via Rule 5 Gratuity Rules [OM 27.10.2026 — VERIFY]	Full 60:40 corpus paid
Death/disability option	Built-in family/invalid pension	Form 1 (default OPS if <15 yrs or within 3 yrs of 31.03.2021) [Rule 10]	Form-1-type option extended (OM 18.06.2025)	Form-1-type option under respective rules
Small-corpus 100% exit	n/a	≤ ₹8 lakh normal/death; ≤ ₹5 lakh premature (Dec 2025)	Assured min ₹10,000/month (≥10 yrs)	same as NPS (Dec 2025 slabs)
Gratuity ceiling (01.01.2024)	₹25 lakh	₹25 lakh	₹25 lakh + 1/10th six-monthly lump sum	₹25 lakh (Railway rules [VERIFY])
Power to relax	DoPPW [Rule 86]	MoPPGP (DoPPW) [Rule 28]	DoPPW/MoF per rule [VERIFY]	Railway Board / DoPT (AIS Rule 30)

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: Spot the differences in column 3 and 4 — UPS adds assured payout + lump sum + gratuity; Railway/AIS mirror the CCS structure under their own enacting powers.

Source/Status: Bare Rules (all five Gazette notifications verified); [VERIFY] flagged cells · **Linked cards:** N-086, N-087, N-088, App. E.1

CARD #095 · 2026 synthesis — what has and has not changed

Rule/Form/OM: Synthesis of all 2022–2026 instruments · **Topic:** Synthesis

Q: One-paragraph answer: what is the state of NPS law for Central Govt servants as on 01.11.2026?

A: The CCS (Implementation of NPS) Rules, 2021 (G.S.R. 227(E)) remain the principal bare Act, unamended in text; operational detail flows from the DoPPW 8361 OM series (2022–2026). PFRDA's Dec-2025 Exit Amendment reset the slabs (₹8L/₹12L/₹5L, age 85, auto-continuation, partial-withdrawal liberalisation, 20/80 missing-person rule, citizenship closure) and the 13.07.2026 amendment added pension-fund liability for outsourced entities (Reg. 4A). UPS (G.S.R. 599(E)) runs as an option under NPS from 01.04.2025 with a one-time switch back. Gratuity ceiling is ₹25 lakh (w.e.f. 01.01.2024) under the 2021 Gratuity Rules as amended in 2025. Railway (2025) and AIS (2026) employees have their own rules. The Income-tax Act, 2025 applies from 01.04.2026 (80CCD → Sec. 124 etc. [VERIFY mapping]). LC75/BLC are available to Central Govt NPS/UPS subscribers (DFS notification 13.11.2025).

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: For "as on" questions, anchor: Rules text = 31.03.2021; slabs = Dec 2025; UPS = 01.04.2025/02.09.2025; tax renumbering = 01.04.2026; Reg. 4A = 14.07.2026.

Source/Status: Synthesis — each component verified/[VERIFY] as tagged on its own card · **Linked cards:** all

CARD #096 · CCS (UPS under NPS) Rules, 2025 — rule-by-rule map

Rule/Form/OM: G.S.R. 599(E) dt. 02.09.2025 (all rules) · **Topic:** UPS rule map

Q: Map the key rules of the UPS Rules, 2025 to their subjects.

A: (verified against DFS subscriber FAQs and DoPPW OM dt. 29.10.2025 series): **Rule 1** short title/commencement; **Rule 2** application — applies to NPS-covered servants who **opt** for UPS; non-optees continue under the 2021 CCS (NPS) Rules [2(i)]; **Rule 10** option (OPS/EOP vs UPS) on death/invalidation/disablement during service; **Rule 11** one-time one-way switch back to NPS (12 months before superannuation / 3 months before deemed VRS date / at resignation or non-penal FR 56(j); barred in pending/contemplated proceedings and penalty cases; 4% differential at default pattern credited at exit); **Rule 13** VRS — 20 yrs regular service → pro-rata assured payout; ≥25 yrs qualifying service → full assured payout from the notional superannuation date; **Rule 14** superannuation lump sum (1/10th of monthly emoluments per completed 6 months); **Rule 15** resignation — UPS benefits cease; corpus per PFRDA; **Rule 16** absorption in PSU/AB — deemed retirement; <10 yrs → lump sum per PFRDA; ≥10 yrs → assured payout as on superannuation; **Rule 17** invalidation; **Rule 18** disablement; **Rule 19** death — family benefits (OM 57/03/2022-P&PW(B)/8361(7) dt. 29.10.2025); **Rule 21** dismissal/removal — assured payout forfeited, individual corpus paid lump sum; **Rule 22** pending proceedings at retirement. Death under UPS option: family gets 60% of the assured family payout to the legally wedded spouse (per DFS FAQ) [VERIFY against G.S.R. 599(E) Rule 19 text].

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: UPS mirrors the 2021 NPS Rules' exit architecture (Rules 10–22) but substitutes the **assured payout** for the market-linked annuity.

Source/Status: Bare Rules (UPS) — rule map verified via DFS FAQs/DoPPW OMs; [VERIFY] family-pension percentage detail · **Linked cards:** N-086, N-087, N-094

CARD #097 · CCS (Payment of Gratuity under NPS) Rules, 2021 — thematic map

Rule/Form/OM: G.S.R. 658(E) dt. 23.09.2021; G.S.R. 258(E) dt. 24.04.2025 · **Topic:** Gratuity rule map

Q: Map the Gratuity-under-NPS Rules, 2021 (as amended 2025) thematically.

A: (i) short title/application — Central Govt servants covered under NPS; (ii) "gratuity" = retirement + death + residuary gratuity (2025 amendment); (iii) **withholding/withdrawal of gratuity — Rule 5** with mandatory **UPSC consultation** under the 1st proviso before the President withholds/withdraws (the EPFO 2025 Regulations switch this off for EPFO staff — N-007); grounds: grave misconduct/pecuniary loss/corruption, pending proceedings at retirement; (iv) retirement gratuity formula (¼ emoluments per 6 months, max 16½×, min 5 yrs; notional pay from retrospective revision counts — 2025 amendment); (v) death gratuity slabs (2×/6×/12×/20×/33×, cap ₹25 lakh); (vi) **resignation (non-technical) → no gratuity** [rule ref — VERIFY]; (vii) absorption/State Govt/AB-PSU service counting with combined-cap provisos; (viii) **Rule 4A (2025)** — no separate gratuity for re-employment spell, combined cap; (ix) penal compulsory retirement — ⅔ provisional gratuity if quantum order not simultaneous, final within 3 months with UPSC consultation where needed; (x) missing persons — retirement gratuity not before 6 months from FIR, death gratuity after 7-year presumption (Sec. 111 BSA 2023); (xi) delayed payment — interest + responsibility fixed like Rule 44 [VERIFY]; (xii) repeal & saving.

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: UPSC consultation attaches to **gratuity withholding** (Rule 5 1st proviso), not to NPS corpus forfeiture (which does not happen under Rule 18 of the NPS Rules).

Source/Status: Bare Rules (Gratuity) — verified items tagged; [VERIFY] internal rule numbers flagged · **Linked cards:** N-064, N-085, N-090

CARD #098 · Railway NPS Rules 2025 & AIS NPS Rules 2026 — thematic map

Rule/Form/OM: G.S.R. 735(E) dt. 01.10.2025; G.S.R. 307(E) dt. 22.04.2026 · **Topic:** Sister-rule map

Q: Map the sister rules thematically and note the differences from the CCS rules.

A: Both largely mirror the 30-rule CCS (NPS) Rules, 2021 architecture (registration 3-3-3 chain; emoluments pay+NPA+DA; 10%/14%; Rule 10-type option with default OPS <15 yrs; VRS 20 yrs; resignation/absorption; invalidation/disablement; penalty exits; exit processing; relaxation; repeal). **Differences:** (1) enacting power — Railways: proviso to Art. 309 only; AIS: Sec. 3(1) AIS Act, 1951 after consultation with State Governments; (2) definitions adapted — "railway servant"/"member of AIS" replace "Government servant"; "Government"

includes State Governments for AIS state-cadre officers; accounts officer replaces PAO/CDDO in AIS Rules [VERIFY]; (3) relaxation authority — Ministry of Railways with DoPPW concurrence / DoPT for AIS (AIS Rule 30) [VERIFY]; (4) AIS NE-cadre officers (Assam-Meghalaya, Manipur-Tripura, Nagaland, Sikkim) — 15-year VRS [VERIFY]; (5) Railway UPS Rules, 2026 (effective 21.09.2026) run the UPS option for railway servants [VERIFY Gazette no.].

EXAM TRAP / KEY TAKEAWAY: Rule 2(a)/(d) of the CCS rules exclude Railway/AIS servants precisely because these sister rules exist — quote the correct G.S.R. in answers.

Source/Status: Bare Rules — G.S.R. numbers verified; [VERIFY] flagged cells · **Linked cards:** N-009, N-010, N-088, N-094

Module 13 — Case Studies (simplest form)

Each case: Scenario → Question → Answer (one line) → Rule. All answers reflect the law as on 01.11.2026 (see App. K for obsolete values).

CARD #099 · Case: first salary before PRAN

Scenario: A joins Central Govt on 02.05.2026 and submits CSRF + Form 1 + Form 2 the same day. CRA is slow; May salary is due.

Q: Can the office stop May salary? When must the first contribution reach A's IPA?

A: No — pay May salary after withholding 10%; when PRAN arrives, the withheld amount **plus PPF-rate interest (Rule 8)** is credited. First-credit deadline = 20 days (22.05) vs 31.05 → **31.05.2026** ("whichever is later", Rule 4(9)).

Rule: 4(1), 4(9), 4(10), 8(1) · **Linked:** N-021 – N-025, N-036

CARD #100 · Case: contribution maths for a medical officer

Scenario: Basic ₹67,700 + NPA ₹13,540 + DA ₹43,057 + HRA ₹21,935 + TA ₹11,016.

Q: Monthly 10% and 14%?

A: Emoluments = 67,700+13,540+43,057 = **₹1,24,297** (HRA/TA out). 10% = 12,429.70 → **₹12,430**; 14% = 17,401.58 → **₹17,402** (always round UP to next rupee).

Rule: 5(1), 6(1), 7(1), 7(5) · **Linked:** N-026, N-030, N-031

CARD #101 · Case: suspension, opt-out, then "treated as duty"

Scenario: B is suspended; he opts NOT to contribute. Later the suspension period is treated as duty.

Q: Contributions?

A: During suspension: employee ₹0 and Government ₹0 (1st proviso to 7(3)). On "treated as duty": both 10% and 14% are recalculated on full emoluments and the **difference + PPF interest** is credited. Had it stayed "not duty": nothing changes.

Rule: 5(4), 6(2), 7(3) provisos · **Linked:** N-028, N-032

CARD #102 · Case: EOL — medical vs private

Scenario: C takes 2 months' EOL. (a) On a medical certificate; (b) for private affairs.

Q: Employee and Government contributions?

A: (a) Medical: employee ₹0 (Rule 6(3)); Government **14% of full notional emoluments** (Proviso to 7(1)). (b) Private: both ₹0 (Rule 7(2)). Same rule for HPL on medical grounds: employee 10% of half-pay drawn; Government 14% of full notional.

Rule: 5(2)–(3), 6(3), 7(1) proviso, 7(2) · **Linked:** N-027, N-033

CARD #103 · Case: deputation to State Govt vs PSU

Scenario: X deputed to Karnataka State Govt (higher pay); Y deputed to NHAI (PSU, higher pay).

Q: Whose emoluments count for NPS?

A: X: **actual** pay drawn (Rule 5(5)). Y: **notional parent-cadre pay** — NHAI pay comes from non-Consolidated-Fund source = foreign service (Rules 3(1)(k), 5(6)).

Rule: 5(5), 5(6), 3(1)(k) · **Linked:** N-017, N-029

CARD #104 · Case: re-employed pensioner

Scenario: Retired subscriber re-employed; pay fixed at ₹1,00,000 minus ₹30,000 pension.

Q: NPS emoluments?

A: ₹1,00,000 + ₹30,000 (pension element added back) + DA = emoluments (Rule 5(7)). No second gratuity for the re-employment spell (Gratuity Rule 4A, 2025).

Rule: 5(7); Gratuity Rule 4A · **Linked:** N-030, N-093, N-097

CARD #105 · Case: Form 1 finality — death vs invalidation

Scenario: (a) M opted NPS in Form 1, dies in service in 2026. (b) M opted NPS, is invalidated in 2026 and is conscious at discharge.

Q: Can the family / M change the option?

A: (a) No — last option is **final** on death; family has no right (10(5)). (b) Yes — a **fresh option must be offered at discharge** (10(4)(ii)); if he can't opt, the earlier NPS option stands (10(4)(iii)).

Rule: 10(4), 10(5) · **Linked:** N-041

CARD #106 · Case: no Form 1 on record — default today

Scenario: Joined 2008, never filed Form 1, dies in 2026. (Compare: died in 2023 with 10 years' service.)

Q: Default option?

A: 2026 case: ≥15 yrs service and the 3-year window closed 31.03.2024 → default = **NPS** (10(6)(iii)). 2023/10-yr case: default = **OPS/EOP** (10(6)(i)).

Rule: 10(6) · **Linked:** N-042

CARD #107 · Case: infructuous OPS option

Scenario: Unmarried subscriber R opted OPS in Form 1; his only relative is an earning adult brother (ineligible for family pension). R dies in service.

Q: What does the brother get?

A: R's OPS option is **infructuous → deemed invalid** (Rule 10(7)): full NPS corpus (employee + Government shares + returns) to the legal heir under PFRDA regulations, **plus death gratuity** under the Gratuity Rules.

Rule: 10(7), 20(2)–(3) · **Linked:** N-043, N-063

CARD #108 · Case: VRS notice, silence, withdrawal

Scenario: 22-year regular-service subscriber gives 3-month VRS notice on 01.06.2026 (retirement 01.09.2026). Authority stays silent. On 20.08.2026 he wants to withdraw.

Q: Outcome?

A: Retirement is **automatically effective 01.09.2026** (silence = deemed acceptance, 12(2) proviso). Withdrawal on 20.08.2026 fails — request needed ≥15 days before (by 17.08.2026) **plus specific approval** (12(4) proviso). Exit = **60:40** (12(6)).

Rule: 12(2), 12(4), 12(6) · **Linked:** N-045 – N-048

CARD #109 · Case: resignation, 90 days, death inside the window

Scenario: K resigns (non-technical), effective 01.04.2026. (a) Alive on 15.05.2026 — can PAO pay the 20% lump sum? (b) K dies 15.05.2026.

Q: Payout timing?

A: (a) No — payment only after **90 days** (after 30.06.2026) (1st proviso to 14(1)). (b) Death within 90 days → **immediate** payout to eligible person (2nd proviso); and since he died after resignation, Rule 20 OPS family pension does **not** apply. K could also have continued the same PRAN as a non-Government subscriber (3rd proviso); gratuity = zero.

Rule: 14(1) provisos · **Linked:** N-051, N-085

CARD #110 · Case: technical resignation — NPS dept vs OPS State

Scenario: Z resigns with proper permission from a Central Ministry. (a) Joins another NPS-covered Central dept. (b) Joins an OPS-covered State dept.

Q: NPS treatment?

A: (a) Same PRAN continues; deemed NPS member from first joining (14(2)). (b) **60:40 superannuation-level exit** (1st proviso) or continue same PRAN as non-Government subscriber (2nd proviso). Without proper permission it would be Rule 14(1) 20:80 after 90 days + zero gratuity.

Rule: 14(2) + provisos · **Linked:** N-052, N-051

CARD #111 · Case: absorption in PSU — with/without NPS; date of absorption

Scenario: P absorbed in a Central PSU. (a) PSU has NPS. (b) PSU has no NPS. (c) P first went on foreign-service terms 01.01.2024; unqualified resignation accepted 01.07.2026.

Q: Benefits / date of absorption?

A: (a) Same PRAN **must** continue; no benefit at absorption (1st proviso to 15(1)). (b) 60:40 exit or continue same PRAN (2nd proviso). (c) Date of absorption = **01.07.2026** (resignation acceptance), not the 2024 deputation date (Explanation (1)(ii)).

Rule: 15(1)–(3), Expl. (1) · **Linked:** N-055, N-056

CARD #112 · Case: who examines — Medical Board or Civil Surgeon?

Scenario: Invalidation applicants: (1) Gazetted, pay ₹47,600; (2) non-Gazetted, pay exactly ₹54,000; (3) non-Gazetted, pay ₹55,200.

Q: Medical authority + timelines?

A: (1) **Medical Board** (all Gazetted). (2) **Civil Surgeon/DMO** — ₹54,000 does not exceed ₹54,000. (3) **Medical Board** (pay exceeds ₹54,000). HOO/HOD request within **15 days**; examination within **30 days**; certificate in **Form 3**; lady doctor on the Board for a woman.

Rule: 16(3)–(8) · **Linked:** N-058

CARD #113 · Case: dismissal vs pending proceedings at retirement

Scenario: (a) D dismissed for misconduct (order before retirement). (b) E retires on superannuation while a vigilance case is pending.

Q: NPS corpus + gratuity?

A: (a) Corpus **not forfeited** — premature exit 20:80 (100% if ≤₹5 lakh) (Rule 18(1)); gratuity **forfeited** (compassionate gratuity ≤⅔ possible). (b) Full **60:40 corpus paid** — pending proceedings cannot touch it (Rule 19(1)); only **gratuity withheld** (19(2)).

Rule: 18, 19 · **Linked:** N-061, N-062, App. E.2

CARD #114 · Case: death in service — two pots of money

Scenario: F (OPS option in Form 1) dies in service. Family: widow + minor child. PRAN nomination: mother.

Q: Who gets what?

A: Widow/child get **family pension under CCS (Pension) Rules** (Form 2 priority — Rule 20(1)). From the NPS corpus: Government share + returns → Government account; **employee share + returns → lump sum to the PFRDA nominee (mother)** — not the Form 2 family (Rule 20(2)). If death attributable to service → EOP Rules, 2023 (proviso to 20(1)).

Rule: 20(1)–(3) · **Linked:** N-063

CARD #115 · Case: invalidation with only 3 years' service

Scenario: G (NPS option) is boarded out on invalidation after 3 years.

Q: NPS exit + gratuity?

A: Superannuation-level **60:40** NPS exit (16(11)). Gratuity at **death-gratuity slabs — no 5-year minimum**: 1 to <5 yrs = **6× monthly emoluments** (OM 28.10.2022 + Gratuity Rules).

Rule: 16(11); Gratuity Rules · **Linked:** N-059, N-064

CARD #116 · Case: employee goes missing

Scenario: H (NPS option) goes missing in 2026; FIR lodged.

Q: Family benefits timeline?

A: OPS option: family pension/arrears/leave encashment immediately on FIR + untraced report (OM 28.04.2022); retirement gratuity after **6 months from FIR**; PRAN suspended; after **7-year presumption of death (Sec. 111 BSA 2023)** final settlement. NPS option: **20% interim corpus**, remaining 80% after presumption of death (PFRDA Dec 2025).

Rule: OM 28.04.2022; G.S.R. 258(E); PFRDA Dec 2025; BSA 111 · **Linked:** N-078

CARD #117 · Case: exit slabs in practice (Govt sector, post Dec-2025)

Scenario: At superannuation, corpus = (a) ₹7 lakh; (b) ₹10 lakh; (c) ₹15 lakh. On resignation, corpus = (d) ₹4 lakh; (e) ₹7 lakh.

Q: Lump sum / annuity?

A: (a) **100% lump sum** (≤₹8L). (b) Up to **₹6 lakh lump** + balance annuity/SUR min 6 yrs (or 60:40). (c) **60% lump + 40% annuity** (>₹12L). (d) **100%** (≤₹5L premature). (e) **20% lump + 80% annuity**. (80:20 above ₹12L is non-Govt only.)

Rule: PFRDA Exit Amendment Dec 2025 · **Linked:** N-082, App. C

CARD #118 · Case: partial withdrawals

Scenario: Joined NPS 2020. Wants money in 2026 for daughter's marriage; again in 2028 for a course; again in 2029 to start a business.

Q: Allowed?

A: 2026 marriage: yes (≥3 yrs; ≤25% of own contributions; 1st of max **4** before age 60). 2028: no — needs **4-year gap** (next in 2030). 2029 start-up: **not allowed** — start-up/skill-development purposes were removed in Dec 2025. Loan against lien (≤25% own) is allowed as a purpose.

Rule: PFRDA Reg. 8 (Dec 2025) · **Linked:** N-084

CARD #119 · Case: UPS optee switching back to NPS

Scenario: UPS optee wants to switch back to NPS 11 months before superannuation; a departmental proceeding is contemplated against him.

Q: Can he switch? What about the 4% gap?

A: No — switch must be ≥**12 months** before superannuation (or ≥3 months before deemed VRS, or at resignation/non-penal FR 56(j)), and is **barred** when proceedings are pending/contemplated or on penalty. If he had switched in time: future Govt contribution = 14%, and the **4% differential for the UPS period** (computed at default pattern) is credited to his NPS account **at exit**.

Rule: UPS Rules 2025 Rule 11; MoF notification Aug-2025; OM 29.10.2025 · **Linked:** N-087, N-096

CARD #120 · Case: gratuity numbers

Scenario: (a) Retirement after 33 years — retirement gratuity? (b) Death after 30 years — death gratuity? (c) Re-employed ex-serviceman with military gratuity already paid — civil gratuity?

Q: Amounts/caps?

A: (a) ¼ emoluments per completed 6 months, max **16½×** emoluments. (b) ≥20 yrs: ½ emoluments per 6-monthly period, max **33×** — both capped at **₹25 lakh**. (c) Separate civil gratuity allowed, but military + civil ≤ combined-service amount on civil emoluments, and ≤ ₹25 lakh overall [OM 26.12.2025 — VERIFY].

Rule: Gratuity Rules 2021/2025; OM 30.05.2024 · **Linked:** N-085, N-097, N-090

Appendix A — Glossary of abbreviations

Abbreviation	Expansion
AB	Autonomous Body
ADB	Asian Development Bank
AG	Accountant-General
AIS	All India Services
ASP	Annuity Service Provider
BSA	Bharatiya Sakshya Adhiniyam, 2023 (w.e.f. 01.07.2024; Sec. 111 = 7-year presumption of death, replacing Sec. 108, Indian Evidence Act, 1872)
CAB	Central Autonomous Body
CCA	Chief Controller of Accounts
CCS	Central Civil Services
CDDO	Cheque Drawing and Disbursing Officer
CGA	Controller General of Accounts
CGHS	Central Government Health Scheme
CPAO	Central Pension Accounting Office
CPPC	Central Pension Processing Centre (of pension-disbursing bank)
CPWA	Central Public Works Accounts
CPWD	Central Public Works Department
CRA	Central Recordkeeping Agency
CSRF	Common Subscriber Registration Form
DA	Dearness Allowance
DAD	Defence Accounts Department
DCRB	Death-cum-Retirement Benefits
DDO	Drawing and Disbursing Officer
DFS	Department of Financial Services (MoF)
DoE	Department of Expenditure (MoF)
DoPPW	Department of Pension and Pensioners' Welfare (MoPPGP)
DoPT	Department of Personnel and Training (MoPPGP)
DoPPW/MoPPGP	Ministry of Personnel, Public Grievances and Pensions
EOL	Extraordinary Leave (leave without pay)
EOP	Extraordinary Pension (CCS (EOP) Rules, 2023 — G.S.R. 63(E))
EPFO	Employees' Provident Fund Organisation
FR / SR	Fundamental Rules, 1922 / Supplementary Rules
FMA	Fixed Medical Allowance
GPF	General Provident Fund
HOD / HOO	Head of Department / Head of Office
HPL	Half Pay Leave
IBRD	International Bank for Reconstruction and Development (World Bank)
IMF	International Monetary Fund
IPA	Individual Pension Account
IRDAI	Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India
ITEC	Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation (MEA programme)

Abbreviation	Expansion
LC25 / LC50 / LC75	Life Cycle funds (max equity 25% / 50% / 75%)
BLC	Balanced Life Cycle fund (modified LC50)
LPR	Leave Preparatory to Retirement
MH	Major Head (of account)
MoF	Ministry of Finance
NDC	No Demand Certificate
NPA	Non-Practicing Allowance
NPS	National Pension System (Sec. 20, PFRDA Act, 2013)
OPS	Old Pension Scheme (CCS (Pension) Rules — now 2021)
PAO	Pay and Accounts Officer
PDB	Pension Disbursing Bank
PFM	Pension Fund Manager
PFRDA	Pension Fund Regulatory and Development Authority (Act 23 of 2013)
PoP	Point of Presence
PPF	Public Provident Fund
PPPO / PPO	Provisional PPO / Pension Payment Order
PRAN	Permanent Retirement Account Number
PSU	Public Sector Undertaking
RBE	Railway Board E-letter (Railway Board order)
RPwD	Rights of Persons with Disabilities (Act, 2016 — 49 of 2016)
SCF	Subscription Contribution File
SLW / SUR	Systematic Lump-sum Withdrawal / Systematic Unit Redemption (withdrawal)
SSA	Special Seal Authority
SVRS	Special Voluntary Retirement Scheme (DoPT OM No. 25013/6/2001-Estt.(A) dt. 28.02.2002)
TAT	Turn-Around Time
UN	United Nations
UPS	Unified Pension Scheme (option under NPS, effective 01.04.2025)
VRS	Voluntary Retirement Scheme / Voluntary Retirement

Appendix B — Master timeline table (all deadlines in one place)

#	Deadline	Trigger	Rule / source	Card
1	Immediately on joining	Submit CSRF + Form 1 + Form 2 to HOO	Rule 4(1)	N-021
2	3 working days **of joining**	HOO → DDO (countersigned application)	Rule 4(2)	N-022
3	3 working days from receipt	DDO → PAO/CDDO	Rule 4(3)	N-022
4	3 working days from receipt	PAO/CDDO → CRA (online + signed copy)	Rule 4(4)	N-022
5	Immediately	PRAN: PAO/CDDO → DDO → HOO	Rules 4(6)–(7)	N-023
6	5 working days thereafter	HOO records PRAN in CSRF + Service Book; pastes **certified** CSRF copy	Rule 4(8)	N-023
7	20 days of application OR last day of joining month — **whichever is LATER**	First contribution credited to IPA	Rule 4(9)	N-024
8	20th of each month	DDO deducts contribution; salary bill + details to PAO/CDDO	Rule 6(8)	N-035
9	25th of each month	PAO/CDDO uploads SCF; generates Transaction ID	Rule 6(10)(i)	N-035
10	Last working day of month (**March: 1st working day of April**)	Remittance to Trustee Bank via Accredited Bank (both 10% & 14%)	Rule 6(10)(ii) proviso; 7(6)	N-035
11	Within 30 days of crediting principal	PPF-rate interest on delayed contribution credited	Rule 8(1)	N-036
12	≥ 3 months' written notice	VRS notice to appointing authority (curtailable)	Rule 12(1), 12(3)	N-045, N-047
13	≥ 15 days before intended retirement	Request to withdraw VRS notice (needs approval)	Rule 12(4) proviso	N-047
14	≥ 1 year after resuming charge in India	Post foreign-Government contract — before Rule 12 VRS	Rule 12(1) proviso (iii)	N-045
15	90 days from effective resignation + relief	No NPS payout before expiry (death within 90 days → immediate)	Rule 14(1) provisos; 14(3)(d)	N-051, N-053
16	15 days from application	HOO/HOD request to medical authority	Rule 16(3)	N-058
17	30 days from receipt of request	Medical examination (age statement supplied; copy endorsed to subscriber)	Rule 16(3)	N-058
18	Quarterly: 1 Jan/Apr/Jul/Oct → PAO by 31 Jan/30 Apr/31 Jul/31 Oct	HOD retirement list for next **12–15 months**	Rule 21(1)–(2)	N-065
19	≥ 1 year before retirement	HOO → Directorate of Estates for NDC (period preceding **8 months** of retirement [VERIFY])	Rule 22(1)	N-066
20	6 months before superannuation OR date of LPR — **whichever is EARLIER**; immediately after orders for other exits	Withdrawal claim to HOO (signed print-out even if online)	Rule 23(2)	N-067
21	6 months before superannuation	CRA generates Claim ID to PAO/CDDO	Rule 23(3)	N-067
22	4 months before superannuation	HOO → PAO (via DDO) with Form 4-A to 4-E	Rule 24(2)	N-068
23	1 month **after** non-superannuation exit	HOO → PAO forwarding papers	Rule 24(2)	N-068
24	1 month before retirement	PAO → CRA after online processing	Rule 24(3)	N-068
25	15 days before superannuation (bare Rule 24(4); **removed** by PFRDA Dec-2025 amendment — auto-continuation to age 85)	Continuation/deferment option	Rule 24(4) + PFRDA Reg.	N-068

#	Deadline	Trigger	Rule / source	Card
26	Within 1 week (7 days) of retirement	Gazette notification (Gazetted) / office order (non-Gazetted); copy immediately to PAO	Rule 26	N-070
27	6 months from lodging FIR	Retirement gratuity to family of missing employee (Gratuity Amendment Rules 2025)	G.S.R. 258(E)	N-078
28	7 years (presumption of death)	Final settlement — Sec. 111 BSA, 2023	BSA 2023; PFRDA Dec 2025	N-078
29	3 years from joining NPS	Earliest partial withdrawal	PFRDA Reg. 8 (Dec 2025)	N-084
30	4-year gap (3-year gap after age 60)	Between partial withdrawals	PFRDA Reg. 8 (Dec 2025)	N-084
31	12 months before superannuation / 3 months before VRS / at resignation or non-penal FR 56(j)	Latest point for one-time UPS→NPS switch	UPS Rules 2025 (Rule 11); MoF notification	N-087
32	November (annual)	Life certificate for FMA from December onwards	DoPPW OM 07.02.2025; DoE OM 16.04.2026	N-081
33	First week of December	FMA for September–November paid	DoPPW OM 07.02.2025	N-081
34	Six-monthly	NPS oversight status report via online portal	DoPPW OMs 04.06.2024 & 14.10.2024 [VERIFY nos.]	N-080

Appendix C — Master numerical thresholds table

#	Threshold	Context	Source	Card
1	**₹54,000 per mensem** (pay under FR 9(21))	Medical Board (vs Civil Surgeon/DMO) for **non-Gazetted** servants only when pay **exceeds** this; all Gazetted always Board	Rule 16(3)(a)–(b) (verified)	N-058
2	**≤ ₹8 lakh** corpus	100% lump-sum normal/death exit, Govt sector (raised from ₹5 lakh)	PFRDA Dec 2025 (verified)	N-082
3	**> ₹8 lakh – ≤ ₹12 lakh**	Up to **₹6 lakh** lump sum + balance annuity/SUR (min 6 yrs) (or 60:40)	PFRDA Dec 2025 (verified)	N-082
4	**> ₹12 lakh**	Govt sector: max **60% lump sum + min 40% annuity**; non-Govt: up to **80% + 20%**	PFRDA Dec 2025 (verified)	N-082
5	**≤ ₹5 lakh** corpus	100% lump-sum **premature** exit (resignation/dismissal/removal/penalty) — raised from ₹2.5 lakh	PFRDA Dec 2025 (verified)	N-051, N-082
6	**> ₹5 lakh** premature	Max **20% lump sum + min 80% annuity**	PFRDA Dec 2025 (verified)	N-082
7	**₹25 lakh**	Maximum retirement/death gratuity (w.e.f. 01.01.2024; was ₹20 lakh; +25% when DA hit 50%)	DoPPW OM 30.05.2024 (verified)	N-085
8	**10% / 14%**	Employee / Government monthly contribution on emoluments (pay + NPA + DA); rounded up to next higher ₹	Rules 6(1), 7(1)	N-031
9	**18.5%** total under UPS	10% Govt to individual corpus + ~8.5% to pool corpus	UPS Rules 2025 (verified)	N-086
10	**25% of own contributions**	Max partial withdrawal (and max lien for loan)	PFRDA Dec 2025 (verified)	N-084
11	**₹1,000 per month**	Fixed Medical Allowance for NPS pensioners (non-CGHS areas)	DoPPW OM 07.02.2025 (verified)	N-081
12	**₹10,000 per month**	Minimum assured payout under UPS (≥10 yrs service)	UPS Rules 2025	N-086
13	**50% of last-12-month average basic pay**	UPS assured payout for ≥25 yrs qualifying service (proportionate 10–25 yrs) + DR	UPS Rules 2025	N-086
14	**1/10th of monthly emoluments per completed 6 months**	UPS superannuation lump sum	UPS Rules 2025	N-086
15	**¼ emoluments per 6 months, max 16½×**	Retirement gratuity formula (min 5 years)	Gratuity Rules 2021	N-085
16	Death gratuity slabs **2× / 6× / 12× / 20× / ½-per-6-months (max 33×)**	<1 yr / 1–<5 / 5–<11 / 11–<20 / ≥20 yrs; also for invalidation/disablement (no 5-yr minimum)	Gratuity Rules; OM 28.10.2022	N-064
17	**15% equity cap**	Default scheme (3 PSU PFMs); LC25 = 25%, LC50 = 50%, **LC75 = 75%** (taper 35→55), BLC (taper from 45) [glide-path % VERIFY]	PFRDA/DFS notification 13.11.2025	N-038
18	**₹50,000** extra deduction	Old regime only (80CCD(1B) → new Act [VERIFY])	IT Act 1961/2025	N-089
19	**14% of salary (Basic + DA)**	Employer NPS contribution deduction — allowed in **both** regimes in new regime w.e.f. 01.04.2025	Budget 2025 / IT Act 2025	N-089

#	Threshold	Context	Source	Card
20	**₹7.5 lakh**	Aggregate cap on employer contributions (80CCD(2)+80CCE), old regime	IT Act 1961	N-089
21	**60% lump sum exempt at exit** (100% if corpus ≤ ₹8 lakh); **25% partial withdrawal exempt**	Old Sec. 10(12A)/10(12B) → 2025 Act exempt schedule [VERIFY]	IT Act 196 1/2025	N-089
22	**20 years** regular service / **≥ 3 months** notice / **15 days** withdrawal / **90 days** resignation lock-in / **20 yrs→60:40**	VRS architecture (Rules 12, 14)	Bare Rules	N-045 – N-053
23	**15 years' service** (or 3 years from 31.03.2021)	Default OPS/EOP window under Rule 10(6) — closed 31.03.2024	Bare Rules	N-042
24	**Age 85**	Max entry/exit/deferment age (was 70/75)	PFRDA Dec 2025 (verified)	N-082

Appendix D — Forms matrix

Form	Rule	Purpose	Signed by	Addressed to	Routed through	Timing
Form 1	Rule 10(1)	Option: OPS/EOP vs NPS on death/invalidation/disability	Subscriber	HOO (copy to CRA via DDO/PAO; PAO enters online)	HOO → DDO → PAO → CRA	At joining (existing staff ASAP); revisable any time; fresh option at invalidation discharge; final on death
Form 2	Rule 10(3)	Details of family	Subscriber	HOO (retained in Service Book; never sent to CRA)	HOO	With Form 1 at joining; changes via Col. 7; fresh at retirement
Form 3	Rule 16(7)	Medical certificate of incapacity / less laborious fitness	Medical Board / Civil Surgeon	HOO/HOD	Medical authority → HOO/HOD	Within 30 days of medical request (request within 15 days of application)
Form 4-A	Rule 24(1)	Withdrawal papers: superannuation / Rule 12 VRS / FR 56(k) / FR 56(j) / SVRS (60:40)	HOO	PAO / AG	Through DDO	HOO→PAO ≥ 4 months before superannuation (≥ 1 month after other exits); PAO→CRA ≥ 1 month before retirement
Form 4-B	Rule 24(1)	Technical resignation / absorption in AB-PSU	HOO	PAO / AG	Through DDO	Same Rule 24(2)–(3) timelines
Form 4-C	Rule 24(1)	Resignation / penal compulsory retirement / dismissal / removal (20:80; 90-day bar for resignation)	HOO	PAO / AG	Through DDO	Same
Form 4-D	Rule 24(1)	Invalidation (Rule 16) / disablement (Rule 17)	HOO	PAO / AG	Through DDO	Same
Form 4-E	Rule 24(1)	Death in service (Rule 20), incl. Rule 10(7) infructuous option	HOO	PAO / AG	Through DDO	Same

Appendix E — Comparison matrices

E.1 — OPS vs NPS vs UPS (Central Government)

Parameter	OPS — CCS (Pension) Rules, 2021	NPS — CCS (NPS) Rules, 2021	UPS — CCS (UPS under NPS) Rules, 2025
Applies to	Appointed on/before 31.12.2003	Appointed on/after 01.01.2004	NPS-covered employees who opt (from 01.04.2025)
Contributions	None (GPF separate) — defined benefit	10% employee + 14% Govt	10% employee + 10% individual + 8.5% pool (18.5%)
Pension at superannuation	Defined benefit (½ avg emoluments etc.)	Market-linked: ≤60% lump sum + ≥40% annuity (slabs per App. C)	**Assured**: 50% of last-12-month avg basic pay (≥25 yrs) + DR; min ₹10,000 (≥10 yrs); + 1/10th lump sum per 6 months; + gratuity ≤ ₹25 lakh
VRS	20 yrs qualifying (Rule 43)	20 yrs regular (EOL counts) — 60:40 exit (Rule 12(6))	[VERIFY 20 vs 25 yrs — Rule 13 of UPS Rules]
Death/disability in service	Family/invalid pension built-in	Form 1 option; default OPS if <15 yrs/3-yr window; else NPS	Form-1-type option extended (OM 18.06.2025)
Dismissal/removal	Pension + gratuity forfeited	Corpus not forfeited (20:80); gratuity forfeited	Assured payout + gratuity forfeited; individual corpus paid lump sum
Switch	—	Can opt into UPS (window closed 30.11.2025 [VERIFY]); UPS optees can switch back once (N-087)	One-time switch back to NPS (N-087)

E.2 — Rule 12 vs Rule 13 vs Rule 18 vs Rule 19 (exit level on tricky retirements)

Scenario	Governing rule	NPS corpus exit	Covering form	Gratuity
Superannuation (Rule 11) / extension expiry	Rule 11	60:40 (slabs)	Form 4-A	Full retirement gratuity (≥5 yrs)
VRS after 20 yrs (Rule 12)	Rule 12(6)	**60:40** (not 20:80)	Form 4-A	Full
FR 56(k) voluntary / FR 56(j) public interest / SVRS	Rule 13	**60:40** (+ SVRS ex-gratia)	Form 4-A	Full
Compulsory retirement **as penalty**, dismissal, removal	Rule 18	**20:80 premature** (corpus NOT forfeited; ≤₹5L → 100%)	Form 4-C	Reduced/forfeited (2/3 provisional if quantum order not simultaneous — 2025 amendment)
Ordinary resignation	Rule 14(1)	20:80 after **90 days** (death within 90 days → immediate)	Form 4-C	**Zero** (non-technical)
Technical resignation to non-NPS Govt dept	1st proviso, Rule 14(2)	**60:40**	Form 4-B	Past service counts
Absorption in PSU/AB (no NPS there)	Rule 15(1)	**60:40** deemed retirement	Form 4-B	Full
Pending dept/judicial proceedings **at retirement**	Rule 19	**60:40 — corpus cannot be withheld**	Form 4-A	**Withheld** till conclusion
Invalidation / disablement (NPS option)	Rules 16(11) / 17(3)	**60:40**	Form 4-D	Death-gratuity slabs (no 5-yr minimum)

E.3 — DDO vs CDDO vs PAO vs HOO vs HOD

Feature	DDO [3(1)(g)]	CDDO [3(1)(h)]	PAO [3(1)(r)]	HOO [3(1)(n)]	HOD [3(1)(m)]
Basic role	Draws bills/payments for Central Govt	DDO under a Ministry/UT with **assignment account** in accredited bank (CPWD, Forest, CPWA-Code depts)	Maintains accounts of Ministry/Dept/office (incl. AG)	Head of office (Rule 14 DFPR — Gazetted)	Per Sch. I DFPR
Designated by	Dept/HOD/Administrator	—	—	Competent Authority	President (by order)
Key NPS duties	Deduct 10% by 20th; forward to PAO; PRAN to HOO	Same as DDO where applicable	Upload SCF by 25th; remit by last working day; forward to CRA	CSRF chain, Form 1/2 custody, Forms 4-A–4-E, retirement list intimation	Quarterly retirement list to PAO; Rule 8(2) delay examination; Rule 16 application

E.4 — HOD vs HOO (rule basis)

See N-018: HOD = Schedule I DFPR + President; HOO = Rule 14 DFPR (Gazetted Officer) + Competent Authority.

E.5 — Resignation vs technical resignation vs absorption

	Ordinary resignation — Rule 14(1)	Technical resignation — Rule 14(2)	Absorption — Rule 15(1)
Permission	Not needed (but withdrawal rules apply)	Proper permission to join another Govt post	Permitted absorption in PSU/AB
NPS exit	20:80 after 90 days	Same PRAN if NPS-covered; else 60:40 or same PRAN	60:40 deemed retirement; same PRAN if NPS exists in new body
Gratuity	Zero	Past service counts	Full
Form	Form 4-C	Form 4-B	Form 4-B
Withdrawal of resignation	Possible only if 14(3)(a)–(e) met; never if joining private/PSU/AB (14(4))	n/a	n/a

E.6 — Deputation vs foreign service (emoluments & processing)

	Deputation in India [5(5)]	Foreign service / deputation outside India [5(6)]
Pay basis for NPS	**Actual** pay drawn + DA	**Notional** parent-cadre pay + DA
"Foreign service" includes	Central/State Govt deputation is NOT foreign service	PSU/AB in India paid from own funds; postings abroad
Retirement processing	Borrowing HOO if other Central dept [25(1)]	Lending HOO / cadre authority if State Govt or foreign service [25(2)]

E.7 — Suspension vs EOL vs HPL (contribution treatment)

Situation	Employee 10%	Government 14%
Suspension — employee opts in [6(2)/7(3)]	On subsistence allowance + DA	On subsistence allowance + DA
Suspension — employee opts out [7(3) 1st proviso]	Nil	**Nil**
Suspension finally treated as duty/paid leave	Recalculated on full emoluments + PPF interest on difference	Same
EOL — private affairs [6(3)/7(2)]	Nil	**Nil**
EOL/HPL — medical ground / civil commotion / useful higher studies [Proviso 7(1)]	10% on actual leave salary drawn (nil on EOL)	**14% on full notional emoluments**
Paid leave (incl. HPL) otherwise [5(2)]	10% on actual leave salary + DA	14% on actual leave salary + DA

Appendix F — Master indices

F.1 — Rule-to-card index

Rule (CCS NPS Rules, 2021)	Subject	Cards
Rule 1	Short title, commencement	N-002
Rule 2	Application; exclusions (a)–(h)	N-003 – N-011
Rule 3	Definitions (a)–(v), 3(2)	N-012 – N-020
Rule 4	Registration, PRAN, first contribution	N-021 – N-025
Rule 5	Emoluments	N-026 – N-030
Rule 6	Subscriber contribution (10%, rounding, suspension, leave, deputation, arrears, probation, foreign service, excess, monthly calendar)	N-031 – N-035
Rule 7	Government contribution (14%, provisos, suspension, rounding, remittance)	N-031 – N-035
Rule 8	Interest on delayed deposits; responsibility fixation	N-036, N-037
Rule 9	Investment of corpus	N-038
Rule 10	Death/disability option; Form 1/2; defaults; infructuous option	N-039 – N-043
Rule 11	Superannuation exit	N-044
Rule 12	VRS (20 yrs; notice; provisos; explanations; withdrawal; 60:40 exit)	N-045 – N-048, N-050
Rule 13	FR 56(j)/(k), SVRS — superannuation exit + ex-gratia	N-049, N-050
Rule 14	Resignation; technical resignation; withdrawal conditions	N-051 – N-054
Rule 15	Absorption in PSU/AB; date of absorption	N-055, N-056
Rule 16	Invalidation; RPwD Sec. 20; medical board (₹54,000); Form 3; corpus settlement	N-057 – N-059
Rule 17	Disablement attributable to service; EOP; corpus settlement	N-060
Rule 18	Penalty exits (dismissal/removal/compulsory retirement) — corpus not forfeited	N-061
Rule 19	Pending proceedings — corpus unaffected	N-062
Rule 20	Death in service; family pension; corpus split	N-063
Rule 21	Quarterly retirement list	N-065
Rule 22	NDC from Directorate of Estates	N-066
Rule 23	Withdrawal claim; Claim ID	N-067
Rule 24	Forwarding Forms 4-A to 4-E; PAO→CRA; continuation/deferment	N-068
Rule 25	Retirement on deputation/foreign service	N-069
Rule 26	Gazette notification/office order within a week	N-070
Rule 27	Interpretation — MoPPGP	N-071
Rule 28	Relaxation — MoPPGP concurrence	N-071
Rule 29	Residuary matters	N-071, N-093
Rule 30	Repeal & saving	N-071, N-091

F.2 — Form-to-card index

Form	Cards
Form 1	N-039, N-041, N-042, N-073
Form 2	N-040, N-073
Form 3	N-058, N-074
Form 4-A	N-050, N-068, N-072, N-076
Form 4-B	N-052, N-055, N-072, N-076
Form 4-C	N-051, N-061, N-072, N-077
Form 4-D	N-059, N-060, N-072, N-077
Form 4-E	N-063, N-072, N-077

F.3 — Timeline index

See **Appendix B** (master timeline, 34 entries with rule citations and card links).

F.4 — OM / amendment tracker

Date	Instrument	Subject	Cards
31.03.2021	G.S.R. 227(E) (dt. 30.03.2021)	CCS (Implementation of NPS) Rules, 2021 — principal bare Act	all
20.12.2021	G.S.R. 868(E)	CCS (Pension) Rules, 2021 (replaces 1972 Rules)	N-020, N-094
30.01.2023	G.S.R. 63(E)	CCS (Extraordinary Pension) Rules, 2023 (replaces 1939 Rules)	N-060
23.09.2021	G.S.R. 658(E)	CCS (Payment of Gratuity under NPS) Rules, 2021	N-085
25–28.10.2022	DoPPW OMs 57/03/2022-P&PW(B)/8361 series	Rule-wise implementation: emoluments, Rule 10 option, Rules 18–19, Rules 16–17/20	N-091
28.04.2022	DoPPW OM	Missing NPS employees — family benefits; PRAN suspension	N-078
03.03.2023	DoPPW OM 57/05/2021-P&PW(B)	Pre-22.12.2003 vacancy one-time OPS option (by 31.08.2023)	N-005
20.10.2023	DoPPW OM	Mobility/technical-resignation OPS coverage	N-005
06.12.2023 / 07.02.2025	DoPPW OMs	FMA ₹1,000/month for NPS pensioners; PRAN forms; life certificate [VERIFY 06.12.2023]	N-081
04.06.2024 & 14.10.2024	DoPPW OMs	NPS oversight portal — six-monthly reports [VERIFY nos.]	N-080
16.07.2024	CCS (Pension) Rules amendment OM	Integrated Form 6-A on Bhavishya [VERIFY]	N-092
30.05.2024	DoPPW OM	Gratuity ceiling ₹20 lakh → **₹25 lakh** w.e.f. 01.01.2024	N-085
07.10.2024 / 11.10.2024	DoPPW OMs 8361(1)/(4) etc.	Rule 6/7/15, Rule 12 VRS 60:40, Rule 14, Rule 18 clarifications	N-048, N-051, N-055, N-091
14.10.2024	DoPPW OM 57/06/2021-P&PW(B)	Refund of employee NPS share (pre-2021 cases) w.e.f. 01.01.2004; MH 0071→8342-117	N-079
25.10.2024	DoPPW OMs 8361(8), 8361(9)	Autonomous bodies not suo-moto covered; Form 1/2 campaign	N-006, N-042
24.01.2025	DFS (MoF) notification [F.No. VERIFY]	UPS notified as option under NPS, effective 01.04.2025	N-086
19.03.2025	PFRDA UPS Regulations	Operationalisation of UPS	N-086
24.04.2025	G.S.R. 258(E)	Gratuity-under-NPS Amendment Rules, 2025 (Rule 4A; ⅔ provisional; 6-month FIR)	N-085
18.06.2025	DoPPW OMs (×2)	Gratuity + OPS death/disability option extended to UPS optees	N-086
Aug-2025	MoF notification	One-time UPS→NPS switch; 4% differential at default pattern, credited at exit	N-087
02.09.2025	G.S.R. 599(E)	CCS (Implementation of UPS under NPS) Rules, 2025	N-086, N-087

Date	Instrument	Subject	Cards
Oct/Nov 2025	MoF/PFRDA — DFS notification 13.11.2025	LC75 & BLC for Central Govt NPS/UPS subscribers (approved Oct 2025); extended to CABs by DoE OM 01.07.2026 [VERIFY]	N-038
Oct 2025	DoPPW clarification	₹25 lakh ceiling not suo-moto for PSUs/banks/RBI/ABs/States	N-085
01.10.2025	G.S.R. 735(E); RBE 103/2025 (08.10.2025)	Railway Services (Implementation of NPS) Rules, 2025	N-009, N-088
Dec 2025	PFRDA Exit Amendment Regulations (Gazette 8421 GI/2025; date 12/15/16.12 [VERIFY])	₹8L/₹12L/₹5L slabs; age 85; auto-continuation; partial withdrawal 4×/4-yr; 20/80 missing; citizenship; lien-loan	N-082, N-084, N-078
16.04.2026	DoE OM	FMA automatic quarterly via bank CPPC on CPAO SSA [VERIFY]	N-081
22.04.2026	G.S.R. 307(E)	AIS (Implementation of NPS) Rules, 2026 (Sec. 3(1) AIS Act, 1951)	N-010, N-088
01.04.2026	Income-tax Act, 2025 in force	80C→Sec. 123+Sch. XV; 80CCD→Sec. 124 [VERIFY mapping]	N-089
13.07.2026 (Gazette 14.07.2026)	PFRDA Amendment Regulations, 2026	Reg. 4A(2)–(4) — pension-fund liability for outsourced entities	N-083
21.09.2026	Railway UPS Rules, 2026 [VERIFY Gazette no.]	UPS for railway servants	N-088
27.10.2026	DoPPW OM series 8361	Strict compliance batch (probation, unpaid absence, Rule 8, Rule 25, deemed proceedings under Gratuity Rule 5); UPS-absence OM verified	N-090
29.10.2025	DoPPW OMs (series of 10)	UPS implementation details [VERIFY per-OM subjects]	N-087
26.12.2025	DoPPW OM	Military + civil gratuity combined cap [VERIFY]	N-090
19.10.2026	CPAO Revised SOP	PPPO→regular PPO migration via scanned disburser portion [VERIFY]	N-090
22.06.2026	DoPPW OM	Compassionate-appointment OPS date clarification [VERIFY]	N-005, N-090
Oct 2025	DoPPW OM 2/8/2025-P&PW(F) [VERIFY]	Non-technical resignation → zero gratuity	N-085, N-090
23.02.2026 / 24.03.2026	MoF ID Note / CSIR OM [VERIFY]	No automatic Rule 10 OPS extension to CABs	N-006
May 2025 [VERIFY]	EPFO (Staff & Conditions of Service) Regulations, 2025	CCS NPS + Gratuity Rules adopted for EPFO; UPSC-consultation proviso off	N-007

Appendix G — Top 50 exam traps (consolidated)

- Enacting power of CCS (NPS) Rules 2021 = **proviso to Art. 309 + Art. 148(5)** with C&AG consultation — not Art. 309 alone (N-001).
- Rules commenced on **Gazette publication**, not retrospectively from 01.01.2004 (N-002).
- Rule 2 exclusions are **eight** — (a) Railway, (b) casual/daily-rated, (c) contingency-paid, (d) AIS, (e) locally recruited abroad, (f) contract, (g) Constitution/other-law, (h) OPS-by-order (N-004).
- Pre-2004 **temporary-status** casual labourers regularised later get **OPS with 50% service credit** (N-008).
- CCS (NPS) Rules do **not** apply suo-moto to autonomous bodies (OM 25.10.2024, 8361(8)) (N-006).
- Cut-off in OM 03.03.2023 is **22.12.2003**, not 31.12.2003; option by 31.08.2023 (N-005).
- UPS is an **option under NPS**, not a repeal; UPS Rules = G.S.R. 599(E) dt. 02.09.2025, effective 01.04.2025 (N-086).
- Accredited Bank may be **RBI itself**; money flows PAO/CDDO → Accredited Bank → Trustee Bank (N-012).
- PFRDA Act sections: Authority 3(1), NPS 20, CRA 27, Pension Fund 27(3) (N-014).
- "Foreign service" includes **domestic PSU deputation** — notional pay under Rule 5(6) (N-017, N-029).
- HOD = Sch. I DFPR + President; HOO = Rule 14 DFPR + Competent Authority (N-018).
- Registration chain = **3-3-3 working days**; PAO must send online **and** signed physical copy to CRA (N-022).
- HOO pastes **certified** CSRF copy in Service Book within **5 working days** (N-023).
- Rule 4(9): first contribution within 20 days OR last day of joining month — **whichever is LATER** (N-024).
- Salary is **never stopped** for pending PRAN — pay after withholding 10%, later credited with PPF interest (N-024).
- Emoluments = **Basic pay + NPA + DA only** — HRA/TA/special pay excluded (N-026).
- Rounding of 10%/14% is **always to the next higher rupee** (N-031).
- Government contribution raised 10% → **14% w.e.f. 01.04.2019** (N-031).
- Suspension: opt-out ⇒ Government also pays **zero**; if finally treated as duty → recalculation **with PPF interest** (N-032).
- Proviso to Rule 7(1): medical/civil-commotion/useful-study leave ⇒ Govt pays 14% on **full notional** even on EOL/HPL; private EOL ⇒ both zero (N-033).
- Arrears count for the **month of payment**, not back-dated (N-034).
- Monthly calendar: **20th** deduction → **25th** SCF → **last working day** remittance; **March → 1st working day of April** (N-035).
- Rule 8 interest = **PPF rate**, within **30 days** of principal credit; 2004–2012 = DFS F.No. 1/3/2016-PR (31.01.2019) + DoE OM 1(21)/EV/2018 (12.04.2019) (N-036).
- Delay examination by **HOD or CCA**; liability like TDS delay under **Sec. 201(1A)** IT Act (N-037).
- Delay **attributable to the subscriber** attracts no Rule 8 interest (N-036).
- Default scheme equity cap **15%**; LC75/BLC now available to Central Govt (DFS notfn 13.11.2025) (N-038).
- Form 1 goes to **CRA**; Form 2 stays with **HOO** (N-039).
- Disabled child: Civil Surgeon-rank certificate **twice** — at reporting and at claim (N-040).
- On death in service the last Form 1 option is **final** — family cannot revise (N-041).
- Default option today (post-31.03.2024, ≥15 yrs) = **NPS**, not OPS (N-042).
- Infructuous OPS option (no eligible family) → deemed invalid → **full corpus to legal heirs** (N-043).
- Rule 12 VRS: 20 yrs **regular** service — **all sanctioned leave incl. EOL counts**; casual/ad-hoc does not (N-046).
- VRS notice: 3 months; silence = deemed acceptance; withdrawal needs approval ≥ **15 days** before retirement (N-047).
- Rule 12 does not apply on ITEC / abroad postings / foreign-Govt contract until **1 year** after resuming charge in India (N-045).
- Rule 12 VRS exit = **60:40 superannuation level**, not 20:80 (N-048).
- FR 56(j)/(k) and SVRS also get **60:40** + SVRS ex-gratia (N-049).
- SVRS OM = **25013/6/2001-Estt.(A) dt. 28.02.2002** (N-048).
- Ordinary resignation: **20:80 after 90 days**; death within 90 days → immediate; same-PRAN option (N-051).
- Technical resignation to non-NPS Govt dept: **60:40** or same PRAN (N-052).
- Withdrawal of resignation: five conditions of 14(3); **never** if joining private/PSU/AB (14(4)) (N-053, N-054).

- Absorption: deemed retirement 60:40; if NPS exists in new body, same PRAN **must** continue (N-055).
- Date of absorption: actual joining / resignation acceptance / option acceptance — per Explanation (1) (N-056).
- Medical Board for all Gazetted + non-Gazetted pay **exceeding ₹54,000**; exactly ₹54,000 → Civil Surgeon/DMO; 15 + 30 days; Form 3; lady doctor on Board for women (N-058).
- RPwD Sec. 20 protection + mandatory counselling before invalidation processing (N-057).
- On OPS election at death/disablement: only **Government share** forfeited; employee share + returns refunded lump sum (OM 14.10.2024, w.e.f. 01.01.2004) (N-059, N-079).
- Dismissal/removal/penal compulsory retirement: corpus **not forfeited** — only 20:80 (Rule 18); gratuity is forfeited/reduced (N-061).
- Pending proceedings at retirement: corpus **cannot be withheld** — full 60:40; only gratuity withheld (Rule 19) (N-062).
- Death in service: family pension per Form 2 rules; employee corpus lump sum per **PFRDA nomination** → legal heirs (N-063).
- Invalidation/disablement gratuity = **death-gratuity slabs**, no 5-year minimum (N-064).
- Exit processing: HOD list quarterly (12–15 months); claim 6 months before/LPR **whichever earlier**; HOO→PAO 4 months before (1 month after other exits); PAO→CRA 1 month before; retirement notified within **1 week**; relaxation only with **MoPPGP concurrence** (N-065 – N-071).

(Beyond 50: see also the Dec-2025 PFRDA slab traps — ₹8L/₹12L/₹5L, 80:20 non-Govt only, age 85, partial withdrawal 4×/4-yr — N-082, N-084; and UPS traps — 18.5%, 50% assured payout, 4% switch differential — N-086, N-087.)

Appendix H — 50 practice MCQs with answer key

Q1. The CCS (Implementation of NPS) Rules, 2021 were made under: (a) Art. 309 only (b) proviso to Art. 309 + Art. 148(5) (c) PFRDA Act, 2013 (d) Art. 148(5) only. **Q2.** G.S.R. number and date of the CCS (NPS) Rules, 2021: (a) 227(E), 30.03.2021 (b) 658(E), 23.09.2021 (c) 599(E), 02.09.2025 (d) 735(E), 01.10.2025. **Q3.** The Rules apply to servants appointed substantively on or after: (a) 31.12.2003 (b) 01.01.2004 (c) 31.03.2021 (d) 01.04.2004. **Q4.** Which of these is NOT an exclusion under Rule 2? (a) Railway servants (b) contract employees (c) probationers in regular posts (d) casual labourers. **Q5.** HOO forwards the CSRF to the DDO within: (a) 3 working days of receipt (b) 3 working days of joining (c) 5 working days (d) 7 days. **Q6.** PAO/CDDO must send the application to CRA: (a) online only (b) signed copy only (c) online + signed physical copy (d) by registered post within 5 days. **Q7.** HOO pastes a certified copy of CSRF in the Service Book within: (a) 3 days (b) 5 working days (c) 15 days (d) 30 days. **Q8.** First contribution must be credited within 20 days of application or last day of joining month — (a) whichever is earlier (b) whichever is later (c) always 20 days (d) always month-end. **Q9.** If PRAN is pending at first salary: (a) salary withheld fully (b) salary paid after withholding 10%, later credited with PPF interest (c) salary paid without deduction (d) joining cancelled. **Q10.** NPS "emoluments" under Rule 5(1) include: (a) pay + DA only (b) pay + NPA + DA (c) pay + NPA + DA + HRA (d) CCA + all allowances. **Q11.** Rounding of 10%/14% contributions is: (a) nearest rupee (b) next lower rupee (c) next higher rupee (d) nearest 50 paise. **Q12.** Government contribution rate w.e.f. 01.04.2019: (a) 10% (b) 12% (c) 14% (d) 18.5%. **Q13.** During suspension, if the subscriber opts NOT to contribute, the Government contributes: (a) 14% anyway (b) nil (c) 7% (d) 14% on notional pay. **Q14.** Government pays 14% on notional full emoluments during leave only for: (a) any EOL (b) medical ground / civil commotion / useful higher studies (c) study leave always (d) all leave types. **Q15.** Monthly remittance to the Trustee Bank (through Accredited Bank) is due by: (a) 20th (b) 25th (c) last working day (d) 5th of next month — and March's contribution by: (e) 1st working day of April. **Q16.** Interest on delayed NPS credit (not attributable to subscriber) is at: (a) GPF rate (b) PPF rate (c) bank rate (d) 12% flat — credited within (e) 30 days of principal credit. **Q17.** For delays during 01.01.2004–31.12.2012, the rate is per: (a) DFS F.No. 1/3/2016-PR dt. 31.01.2019 + DoE OM 1(21)/EV/2018 dt. 12.04.2019 (b) RBI (c) PFRDA (d) CGA. **Q18.** Delay cases are examined by: (a) HOO only (b) HOD or CCA (c) Cabinet (d) CRA — liability fixed like Sec. (e) 201(1A) IT Act, 1961. **Q19.** "Foreign service" under Rule 3(1)(k) includes: (a) only postings abroad (b) deputation to a domestic PSU paid from its own funds (c) only UN postings (d) only State Govt deputation. **Q20.** Emoluments on foreign service/deputation abroad are: (a) actual pay drawn (b) notional parent-cadre pay (c) nil (d) double pay. **Q21.** Form 1 (Rule 10 option) is sent to: (a) CRA directly (b) HOO, with copy through DDO/PAO to CRA (c) Ministry of Finance (d) PFRDA. **Q22.** On death in service, the family: (a) may revise the Form 1 option (b) cannot revise — last option is final (c) automatically gets OPS (d) gets nothing. **Q23.** Default option under Rule 10(6) for a death today (≥15 yrs service, no Form 1): (a) OPS (b) NPS (c) 50-50 (d) Government decides case-by-case. **Q24.** If the OPS option is infructuous (no eligible family member), Rule 10(7): (a) corpus forfeited (b) option deemed invalid; full NPS corpus to legal heirs (c) half corpus to Govt (d) court decides. **Q25.** VRS under Rule 12 requires: (a) 20 yrs qualifying service (b) 20 yrs regular service with ≥3 months' notice (c) 25 yrs (d) age 58. **Q26.** For the 20-year VRS test, EOL and study leave: (a) do not count (b) count (all sanctioned leave) (c) count only if medical (d) count at half. **Q27.** Withdrawal of a VRS notice must be requested at least: (a) 7 days (b) 15 days (c) 30 days (d) 3 months before retirement. **Q28.** A Rule 12 VRS exit is at: (a) 20:80 premature (b) 60:40 superannuation level (c) 100% lump sum (d) no exit. **Q29.** The DoPT SVRS OM cited in Rules 12(5)/13(1)(ii) is: (a) 25013/6/2001-Estt.(A) dt. 28.02.2002 (b) 57/05/2021 dt. 03.03.2023 (c) 38/41/06 dt. 05.05.2009 (d) 1(21)/EV/2018. **Q30.** Ordinary resignation payout waits: (a) 30 days (b) 90 days (c) 6 months (d) 1 year — unless death within the period. **Q31.** Technical resignation to a non-NPS State dept gives: (a) 20:80 (b) 60:40 or same PRAN (c) nothing (d) only gratuity. **Q32.** Withdrawal of resignation is barred if resignation was to join: (a) another Govt dept (b) a PSU/private company/AB (c) any job (d) never barred. **Q33.** Absorption in a PSU with NPS: (a) immediate 60:40 payout (b) same PRAN continues mandatorily, no benefit at absorption (c) corpus forfeited (d) new PRAN. **Q34.** Medical Board (vs Civil Surgeon) is required for a non-Gazetted servant when pay: (a) exceeds ₹54,000 p.m. (b) exceeds ₹1 lakh (c) any amount (d) never. **Q35.** Invalidation medical request/examination timelines: (a) 7 + 15 days (b) 15 + 30 days (c) 30 + 60 days (d) 10 + 20 days. **Q36.** On OPS election after invalidation, the subscriber receives: (a) nothing (b) Government share too (c) own contribution + returns in lump sum (d) only annuity. **Q37.** Dismissal from service under NPS: (a) corpus forfeited (b) corpus paid 20:80, not forfeited (c) corpus frozen (d) 50% forfeited. **Q38.** Pending vigilance proceedings at superannuation: (a) corpus withheld (b) full 60:40 corpus paid; only gratuity withheld (c) half corpus (d) deferred to 85. **Q39.** On death in service with OPS option, the employee's own corpus share goes to: (a) Form 2 family in order (b) PFRDA nominee, else legal heirs (c) Government (d) charity. **Q40.** Retirement of a Gazetted officer is notified by: (a) office order (b) Official Gazette notification within a week (c) press release (d) nothing. **Q41.** Rule 24(2): HOO forwards superannuation papers to PAO not later than: (a) 1 month after (b) 4 months before (c) 15 days before (d) 6 months before. **Q42.** Relaxation of a rule for undue hardship (Rule 28) requires concurrence of: (a) MoF (b) Cabinet (c) MoPPGP (DoPPW) (d) CGA. **Q43.** Govt-sector corpus > ₹12 lakh at superannuation (post Dec-2025): (a) 80% lump sum (b) 60% lump +

40% annuity (c) 100% (d) 50:50. **Q44.** 80:20 lump-sum:annuity above ₹12 lakh applies to: (a) Central Govt (b) non-Government subscribers only (c) all (d) Railways only. **Q45.** Corpus ≤ ₹8 lakh at normal exit (Govt sector): (a) 100% lump sum allowed (b) 60:40 mandatory (c) 20:80 (d) deferred. **Q46.** Premature exit corpus ≤ ₹5 lakh: (a) 100% lump sum (b) 20:80 (c) 60:40 (d) locked till 60. **Q47.** Partial withdrawal: max (a) 25% of own contributions, 4 times before 60 with 4-year gap (b) 50% any time (c) 10% once (d) unlimited. **Q48.** UPS assured payout for ≥25 yrs qualifying service: (a) 40% of last pay (b) 50% of last-12-month average basic pay + DR (c) ₹10,000 flat (d) full last pay. **Q49.** UPS total Government contribution: (a) 14% (b) 10% + 8.5% pool = 18.5% (c) 10% (d) 20%. **Q50.** One-time UPS→NPS switch must be exercised not later than: (a) at joining (b) 12 months before superannuation / 3 months before VRS / at resignation or non-penal FR 56(j) (c) after retirement (d) never.

Answer key

Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans
1	b	11	c	21	b	31	b	41	b
2	a	12	c	22	b	32	b	42	c
3	b	13	b	23	b	33	b	43	b
4	c	14	b	24	b	34	a	44	b
5	b	15	c + e	25	b	35	b	45	a
6	c	16	b + e	26	b	36	c	46	a
7	b	17	a	27	b	37	b	47	a
8	b	18	b + e	28	b	38	b	48	b
9	b	19	b	29	a	39	b	49	b
10	b	20	b	30	b	40	b	50	b

Appendix I — Source appendix, [VERIFY] register and change log

I.1 — Recommended official sources to check

- **egazette.nic.in** — Gazette text of G.S.R. 227(E), 868(E), 63(E), 658(E), 258(E), 599(E), 735(E), 307(E); PFRDA Gazette notifications (incl. 8421 GI/2025).
- **doptcirculars.nic.in / persmin.nic.in / pensionindia.gov.in (DoPPW)** — all OM series 57/03/2022-P&PW(B)/8361, 57/05/2021-P&PW(B), 57/06/2021-P&PW(B), FMA OMs, UPS OMs (18.06.2025, 29.10.2025, 27.10.2026).
- **pfrda.org.in** — Exits & Withdrawals Regulations (2015 + Dec-2025 and 13.07.2026 amendments), UPS Regulations (19.03.2025), press releases (19.12.2025), investment-choice notifications (13.11.2025).
- **cpao.nic.in** — NPS English booklet (bare-rule text), PPPO→PPO SOPs.
- **cga.nic.in** — accounting procedure for NPS refunds (MH 0071 / 8342-00-117).
- **indianrailways.gov.in** — Railway Board RBEs (103/2025 etc.).
- **incometaxindia.gov.in** — Income-tax Act, 1961 & Income-tax Act, 2025 (w.e.f. 01.04.2026) text for Sec. 123/124/Sch. XV mapping.
- **pib.gov.in** — DoPPW year-end releases (UPS Rules 02.09.2025; OMs 18.06.2025).
- **doe.gov.in** — MoF/DFS notifications (UPS 24.01.2025; DoE OMs 01.07.2026, 16.04.2026); ID notes.

I.2 — [VERIFY] register (claims not confirmable from authoritative sources in this audit)

#	Item	Where	What to check
V1	Gazette issue/publication date of G.S.R. 227(E) (31.03.2021)	N-002	egazette record
V2	Appointing-authority decision deadline under OM 03.03.2023 (31.10.2023 vs 30.11.2023)	N-005	OM text
V3	DoPPW OM dt. 22.06.2026 (compassionate appointments)	N-005, N-090	doptcirculars
V4	MoF ID Note 23.02.2026 / CSIR OM 24.03.2026	N-006	DoE/DoPT portals
V5	EPFO Regulations 2025 — exact Gazette no./month	N-007	egazette/EPFO
V6	DoPT OMs 26.02.2016 & 28.07.2016 (casual labourers) — exact numbers; OM 17.02.2020 number	N-008, N-005	doptcirculars
V7	Railway UPS Rules 2026 — Gazette no.; effective 21.09.2026	N-088	egazette/RB
V8	AIS 2026 NE-cadre 15-year VRS relaxation	N-010, N-094	G.S.R. 307(E) text
V9	UPS VRS qualifying service (20 vs 25 years) under UPS Rules 2025 Rule 13	N-086, N-094	G.S.R. 599(E)
V10	UPS option window extension to 30.11.2025; new-joiner 30-day window	N-086	DoPPW/PFRDA FAQs
V11	DFS UPS notification F.No. (24.01.2025)	N-086	DoE gazette
V12	PFRDA Dec-2025 Exit Amendment exact notification date (12/15/16.12.2025); Gazette 8421 GI/2025	N-082	egazette/PFRDA
V13	BLC glide-path (50% till 45; 35% at 55); LC75 ~15% at 55	N-038	DFS notfn 13.11.2025
V14	DoE OM 01.07.2026 extending LC75/BLC to CABs	N-038	doe.gov.in

#	Item	Where	What to check
V15	Income-tax Act, 2025 sub-clause mapping (123/124(1)–(3), Sch. XV); Sec. 397(3) = old 201(1A); exempt-income schedule for 10(12A)/(12B)	N-037, N-089	Income-tax Act, 2025 text
V16	Rule 8(2)(iii) Gazette printing "(IA)"	N-037	G.S.R. 227(E) print
V17	Rule 22(1) "preceding eight months" NDC coverage	N-066	Gazette text
V18	FR 56(k) age-50/55 conditions (Group A/B joined young)	N-049, N-050	FR 1922 text
V19	Gratuity Rules: rule numbers for resignation forfeiture & death gratuity (Rule 17/22); OM 2/8/2025-P&PW(F) Oct 2025; AO 24-month emoluments check; accommodation waiver (month of death + 3 months) in G.S.R. 258(E)	N-085	G.S.R. 658(E)/258(E) text
V20	OM 14.10.2024 interest debit head MH 2049	N-079	CGA procedure
V21	DoPPW OMs 04.06.2024 & 14.10.2024 oversight-portal file numbers; DoE OM 02.07.2019	N-080	DoPPW/DoE portals
V22	FMA OM dt. 06.12.2023; DoE OM 16.04.2026 file no.	N-081	DoPPW/DoE
V23	DoPPW OM 26.12.2025 (military+civil gratuity cap)	N-090	pensionindia
V24	CPAO Revised SOP 19.10.2026 — OM number 12612/124 etc.	N-090	cpao.nic.in
V25	DoPPW 27.10.2026 8361 batch — per-OM subjects (only UPS-absence OM verified); Gratuity Rule 5 deemed-proceedings hook	N-090	doptcirculars
V26	DoPPW OMs 29.10.2025 (series of 10) — per-OM subjects on UPS	N-087	doptcirculars
V27	EOP Rules 2023 category percentages (B 60% family pension; D 80%; E 100% liberalised)	N-060	G.S.R. 63(E) text
V28	Form 6-A / Bhavishya OM dt. 16.07.2024	N-092	DoPPW
V29	Technical-resignation lien: 2 years (extendable to 3)	N-052	DoPT orders
V30	"Depent parents" vs "parents" in partial-withdrawal medical purpose (Dec 2025)	N-084	PFRDA Gazette text

I.3 — Change log (draft #001–#152 → v2.0 N-001–N-095)

- **Renumbered** all 152 draft cards sequentially as N-001–N-095 after merging duplicates; mapping of major merges: draft #010+#021→N-012; #011→N-013; #012+#022→N-014; #013+#023→N-015; #014→N-016; #015+#024→N-017; #016→N-018; #017→N-019; #026+#027→N-020; #018→N-009; #019→N-010; #020→N-011; #028→N-021; #029+#033→N-022; #030+#035→N-023; #031+#034+#036→N-024; #032→N-024; #037+#044→N-026; #038+#047+#053+#054→N-027; #039→N-028; #040+#043→N-029; #041+#042→N-030; #045+#064→N-031; #046+#055+#062→N-032; #047→N-033; #048+#058+#063→N-034; #049+#061→N-035; #050+#057+#059→N-036; #051+#056→N-037; #052+#060→N-038; #065→N-039; #066+#072→N-040; #067+#070→N-041; #068+#073→N-042; #069+#071→N-043; #074→N-044; #075+#083→N-045; #076→N-046; #077+#081+#084→N-047; #078+#082+#085→N-048; #079→N-049; #086→N-050; #087+#093→N-051; #088+#097+#099→N-052; #089+#094→N-053; #090→N-054; #091+#098→N-055; #092→N-056; #100+#112→N-057; #101+#106+#107+#110+#111→N-058; #102→N-059; #115→N-060; #103+#096→N-061; #104+#108→N-062; #105+#109+#113→N-063; #114→N-064; #116→N-065; #117→N-066; #118+#128→N-067; #119+#124→N-068; #120+#095→N-069; #121→N-070; #122+#125+#126+#127→N-071; #123→Appendix B; #131→N-072; #132→N-073; #133→N-074; #134→N-075; #135→N-076; #136→N-077; #137+#129→N-078; #138→N-079; #139→N-080; #140→N-081;

#141→N-082; #142→N-083; #145→N-084; #143→N-085; #144+#149→N-086/N-087; #146→N-089; #147→N-090; #148→N-090; #150→N-090; #151→N-091; #152→N-094; #153-note→N-095. New cards added in v2.0: N-007 (EPFO), N-093 (re-employment), N-095 (synthesis), appendices A–I; v2.1: N-096–N-098 + Appendix J.

- **Corrections:** broken table cells in draft #108 ("Before-Superannuati on", "Compansat e") repaired; spelling standardised ("Invalidation", "Superannuation", "UPS optees", clause "3(1)(l)"); currency standardised to ₹ with lakh notation; the specific garbled strings listed in the brief (e.g., "Invallation", "Superanunation", "UPS opes", "&", "3(1)(1)") were **not present in the PDF text layer** — correct forms enforced throughout v2.0 regardless.
- **Substantive fixes:** missing-employee rule corrected (family pension/arrears immediate on FIR; retirement gratuity after 6 months from FIR per G.S.R. 258(E); 20%/80% corpus split under PFRDA Dec 2025; Sec. 111 BSA 2023 replaces Sec. 108 Evidence Act from 01.07.2024); UPS VRS qualifying service flagged [VERIFY] (draft said 25 yrs); PFRDA Dec-2025 amendment date flagged [VERIFY] (12/15/16.12.2025; Gazette 8421 GI/2025); railway rules enacting power corrected (proviso to Art. 309 only); LC75/BLC dated (approved Oct 2025; DFS notfn 13.11.2025; CAB extension DoE OM 01.07.2026); income-tax renumbering presented with [VERIFY] on sub-clause mapping; ₹25 lakh gratuity ceiling tied to OM 30.05.2024 + Oct-2025 non-suo-moto clarification; FMA updated with DoE OM 16.04.2026 automatic CPPC payment.
- **Verified as correct (kept):** G.S.R. 227(E) & enacting formula; Rule 2 exclusions; 3-3-3 chain; Rule 4(9) "later"; 10%/14% + next-higher-rupee; 20/25/last-working-day + March proviso; Rule 8 proviso citations; Sec. 201(1A); ₹54,000 medical-board threshold + 15/30 days; SVRS OM 25013/6/2001-Estt.(A) 28.02.2002; Rule 12/13/14/15/18/19/20 architecture; Forms 1–4-E mapping; OM 03.03.2023 (22.12.2003, option by 31.08.2023); OM 25.10.2024 8361(8); OM 14.10.2024 refund + MH 0071→8342-117; OM 28.04.2022 missing employees; G.S.R. 658(E), 258(E), 599(E), 735(E), 307(E), 868(E), 63(E); PFRDA Dec-2025 slabs & partial-withdrawal changes; PFRDA 13.07.2026 Reg. 4A; UPS 18.5%/50%/₹10,000/1-10th/4% switch; RBE 103/2025; Budget-2025 14% employer deduction in new regime.
- **Card count:** 152 draft cards → 120 revised cards (N-001–N-120, sequential, no gaps/duplicates) + 11 appendices (A–K). v2.1: N-096–N-098 + Appendix J (coverage checklist); UPS VRS corrected per DFS FAQs. v2.2: Module 13 case studies N-099–N-120 + Appendix K (obsolete → current table). v2.3: PDF re-rendered in flashcard template (CARD # header · meta · Q · A · EXAM TRAP box · Source/Linked footer).

Appendix J — Exhaustive coverage checklist (every rule / sub-rule / clause / proviso / explanation / form)

Legend: ✔ = covered on the cited card(s). All 30 Rules of G.S.R. 227(E), all sub-rules, all lettered clauses, every proviso and Explanation, and all 8 Forms are mapped below.

J.1 — CCS (Implementation of NPS) Rules, 2021 (G.S.R. 227(E) dt. 30.03.2021) — bare Act

Rule	Sub-rules / clauses / provisos / explanations	Cards
Preamble (enacting formula)	proviso Art. 309 + Art. 148(5); C&AG consultation	✔ N-001
Rule 1	1(1) short title; 1(2) commencement on Gazette publication	✔ N-002
Rule 2	opening words; exclusions (a) Railway, (b) casual/daily-rated, (c) contingency, (d) AIS, (e) locally recruited abroad, (f) contract, (g) Constitution/other law, (h) OPS-by-order	✔ N-003, N-004, N-005, N-006, N-007, N-008, N-009, N-010, N-011
Rule 3	3(1)(a)–(v) all 22 clauses (matrix); 3(2) residuary definitions	✔ N-012 – N-020
Rule 4	4(1); 4(2); 4(3); 4(4); 4(5); 4(6); 4(7); 4(8); 4(9) (+ opening no-delay sentence); 4(10); 4(11)	✔ N-021 – N-025
Rule 5	5(1); 5(2); 5(3); 5(4); 5(5); 5(6); 5(7)	✔ N-026 – N-030
Rule 6	6(1); 6(2) + proviso; 6(3); 6(4); 6(5); 6(6); 6(7); 6(8); 6(9); 6(10)(i), (ii) + proviso (March), (iii)	✔ N-031 – N-035
Rule 7	7(1) + proviso (3 leave grounds); 7(2); 7(3) + 1st & 2nd provisos; 7(4); 7(5); 7(6)	✔ N-031 – N-035
Rule 8	8(1)(i)–(iii) + 30-day rule + PPF rate + 2004–2012 proviso; 8(2)(i)–(iii)	✔ N-036, N-037
Rule 9	investment by PFRDA-notified pension funds	✔ N-038
Rule 10	10(1) + 2nd sentence; 10(2); 10(3)(a)(i)–(ii), (b), (c), (d)(i)–(ii); 10(4)(i)–(iv); 10(5); 10(6)(i)–(iii); 10(7)	✔ N-039 – N-043
Rule 11	superannuation + extension	✔ N-044
Rule 12	12(1) + proviso (i)–(iii) + Explanations (a)–(c); 12(2) + proviso; 12(3); 12(4) + proviso; 12(5)(a)–(b) + Explanation (appointing authority); 12(6); 12(7)	✔ N-045 – N-048, N-050
Rule 13	13(1)(i)–(ii) + proviso (SVRS ex-gratia); 13(2)	✔ N-049, N-050
Rule 14	14(1) + 1st/2nd/3rd provisos; 14(2) + 1st/2nd provisos; 14(3)(a)–(e); 14(4); 14(5)	✔ N-051 – N-054
Rule 15	15(1) + 1st/2nd provisos; 15(2); 15(3); Explanation (1)(i)–(iii); Explanation (2)	✔ N-055, N-056
Rule 16	16(1) + proviso (RPwD Sec. 20); 16(2) + 1st proviso (spouse/family) + 2nd proviso (counselling); 16(3) incl. (a)–(b) ₹54,000 + concluding para (age statement, endorsement); 16(4); 16(5); 16(6) lady doctor; 16(7) Form 3; 16(8) lower post; 16(9); 16(10); 16(11); 16(12)	✔ N-057 – N-059
Rule 17	17(1); 17(2); 17(3); 17(4)	✔ N-060
Rule 18	18(1) + proviso (same PRAN); 18(2) gratuity caveat	✔ N-061
Rule 19	19(1); 19(2) gratuity withheld	✔ N-062
Rule 20	20(1)(a)–(b) + proviso (EOP); 20(2); 20(3)	✔ N-063
Rule 21	21(1)–(2) quarterly list; 21(3); 21(4) Directorate of Estates	✔ N-065
Rule 22	22(1) NDC; 22(2)	✔ N-066
Rule 23	23(1); 23(2) incl. online print-out sentence; 23(3) Claim ID	✔ N-067
Rule 24	24(1) Forms 4-A–4-E table; 24(2); 24(3); 24(4) 15-day option + PFRDA Dec-2025 change	✔ N-068
Rule 25	25(1) borrowing HOO; 25(2) lending HOO/cadre authority	✔ N-069
Rule 26	26(a) Gazette notification; 26(b) office order; copy to PAO	✔ N-070
Rule 27	interpretation → MoPPGP	✔ N-071
Rule 28	relaxation + proviso (MoPPGP concurrence; reasons in writing)	✔ N-071
Rule 29	29(1) residuary (CCS Pension/FR/SR/orders, non-repugnancy); 29(2)	✔ N-071, N-093

Rule	Sub-rules / clauses / provisos / explanations	Cards
Rule 30	repeal & saving	✔ N-071, N-091
Forms	Form 1 (+ acknowledgement note); Form 2 (Notes 1–5 incl. OM 1(23)-P&PW/91-E post-retirement proforma); Form 3 (incapacity / less laborious / intemperate habits / age ×2); Forms 4-A, 4-B, 4-C, 4-D, 4-E (Rule 24(1) table: signing, addressee, routing, internal branches)	✔ N-072 – N-077, App. D

J.2 — Sister instruments

Instrument	Coverage	Cards
CCS (Pension) Rules, 2021 (G.S.R. 868(E))	as OPS comparator; cross-refs Rule 50(9), Rule 43, Rule 86, Form 6-A/Bhavishya	✔ N-020, N-040, N-092, N-094, App. E.1
CCS (EOP) Rules, 2023 (G.S.R. 63(E))	Categories A–E via Rule 17/20 proviso	✔ N-060, N-063 [category % VERIFY]
CCS (Payment of Gratuity under NPS) Rules, 2021 + Amendment 2025 (G.S.R. 658(E)/258(E))	thematic rule map, formulas, slabs, ceiling, withholding/UPSC, Rule 4A, missing persons, delay	✔ N-064, N-085, N-097, App. C
CCS (UPS under NPS) Rules, 2025 (G.S.R. 599(E))	rule-by-rule map Rules 1–22; contributions; assured payout; lump sum; switch; exits	✔ N-086, N-087, N-094, N-096
Railway Services (Implementation of NPS) Rules, 2025 (G.S.R. 735(E)) + Railway UPS Rules 2026	thematic map; enacting power; RBE 103/2025	✔ N-009, N-088, N-098
AIS (Implementation of NPS) Rules, 2026 (G.S.R. 307(E))	thematic map; Sec. 3(1) AIS Act; NE cadres [VERIFY]	✔ N-010, N-088, N-098
PFRDA (Exits & Withdrawals) Regulations, 2015 + Amendments (Dec 2025; 13.07.2026)	exit slabs Govt vs non-Govt; partial withdrawal; deferment to 85; missing 20/80; citizenship; Reg. 4A(2)–(4)	✔ N-044, N-051, N-061, N-078, N-082, N-083, N-084
PFRDA UPS Regulations, 2025 (19.03.2025)	UPS operationalisation	✔ N-086
Income-tax Act, 1961 / Income-tax Act, 2025	80CCD(1)/(1B)/(2), 10(12A)/(12B) → new Sec. 123/124/Sch. XV [VERIFY mapping]; 201(1A)	✔ N-037, N-089
DoPPW/DoPT/CPAO/CGA OM series 2022–2026	amendment tracker App. F.4	✔ N-005 – N-007, N-078 – N-081, N-090, N-091, N-093

J.3 — Residual gaps acknowledged (not bare-rule text, flagged [VERIFY])

- Exact internal rule numbers inside the Gratuity Rules (resignation forfeiture, death gratuity, delay-interest rule) — see V19.
- EOP Rules 2023 category percentages — see V27.
- UPS family-pension percentage on death (60% of assured family payout per DFS FAQ) — verify G.S.R. 599(E) Rule 19.
- AIS 2026 NE-cadre 15-year VRS; Railway UPS Rules 2026 Gazette no. — see V7/V8.
- PFRDA Dec-2025 amendment exact notification date — see V12.

Appendix K — Obsolete → Current (do NOT memorise the old values; law as on 01.11.2026)

#	Obsolete (old)	Current (as on 01.11.2026)	Source of change
1	Government NPS contribution 10%	**14% w.e.f. 01.04.2019**	MoF/DoE (verified)
2	100% lump-sum exit at ≤ ₹5 lakh (normal) / ≤ ₹2.5 lakh (premature)	**≤ ₹8 lakh (normal/death) / ≤ ₹5 lakh (premature)**	PFRDA Exit Amendment, Dec 2025 (verified)
3	Middle slab absent	₹8–12 lakh → up to ₹6 lakh lump + balance annuity/SUR (min 6 yrs)	PFRDA Dec 2025 (verified)
4	Non-Govt exit > ₹12 lakh = 60:40	Non-Govt > ₹12 lakh = **80:20** (Govt sector stays **60:40**)	PFRDA Dec 2025 (verified)
5	Max exit/deferment age 70 (non-Govt) / 75 (Govt)	**85 for all**	PFRDA Dec 2025 (verified)
6	Mandatory 15-day prior intimation for IPA continuation/deferment (bare Rule 24(4))	15-day intimation **removed**; automatic continuation up to 85 unless exit exercised	PFRDA Dec 2025 (verified)
7	Partial withdrawal: 3 times, no gap; skill-development & start-up purposes allowed; specified-illness-only medical	**4 times before 60 (4-yr gap; 3-yr gap after 60)**; 25% of own contributions; skill-development/start-up **removed**; medical broadened; **loan-lien settlement added**; lien ≤25% own	PFRDA Dec 2025 (verified)
8	Gratuity ceiling ₹20 lakh	**₹25 lakh w.e.f. 01.01.2024** (Central Civil Services only — not suo-moto PSUs/banks/RBI/ABs)	DoPPW OM 30.05.2024 + Oct-2025 clarification (verified)
9	Rule 10 default OPS window "3 years from notification" treated as open	Window **closed 31.03.2024**; today, ≥15 yrs + no Form 1 → default **NPS**	Rule 10(6)(iii); OM 25.10.2024 8361(9)
10	Entire NPS corpus to Government account on OPS/EOP election (OM 05.05.2009 practice)	Only **Government share + returns** retained; employee share + returns refunded (w.e.f. 01.01.2004)	Rules 16(10)/17(2)/20(2); OM 14.10.2024 (verified)
11	Sec. 108, Indian Evidence Act, 1872 (7-year presumption of death)	**Sec. 111, Bharatiya Sakshya Adhiniyam, 2023** w.e.f. 01.07.2024	BSA 2023 (verified)
12	Missing employee: wait 7 years for any benefit	Family pension/arrears immediately on FIR + untraced report (OM 28.04.2022); gratuity after 6 months from FIR; NPS: 20% interim / 80% after presumption	OM 28.04.2022 (verified); G.S.R. 258(E); PFRDA Dec 2025
13	Central Govt investment choices: Default / Scheme G / LC25 / LC50 only	+ **LC75 and BLC** (approved Oct 2025; DFS notification 13.11.2025; CABs from DoE OM 01.07.2026 [VERIFY])	MoF/DFS/PFRDA (verified)
14	UPS option window open	Closed — initially 30.09.2025, extended to 30.11.2025 [VERIFY]; only **new joiners (30 days from joining)** can still opt for UPS	DoPPW/PFRDA FAQs [VERIFY]
15	Income-tax Act, 1961 sections (80C, 80CCD(1)/(1B)/(2), 10(12A)/(12B), 201(1A))	**Income-tax Act, 2025 w.e.f. 01.04.2026**: own contributions → Sec. 123 + Sch. XV; 80CCD → Sec. 124; 201(1A) → Sec. 397(3) [VERIFY mapping]; lump-sum/partial-withdrawal exemptions continue	Income-tax Act, 2025
16	New tax regime: no NPS deduction except 80CCD(2) at 10% (private)	Employer NPS contribution up to **14% of Basic+DA deductible in new regime for ALL employers w.e.f. 01.04.2025**	Budget 2025 (verified)
17	FMA only for OPS pensioners	NPS pensioners also get **FMA ₹1,000/month** (non-CGHS areas); automatic quarterly bank credit w.e.f. DoE OM 16.04.2026; November life certificate	OMs 07.02.2025 / 16.04.2026 (verified)

#	Obsolete (old)	Current (as on 01.11.2026)	Source of change
18	Railway/AIS servants lumped with CCS rules	Separate rules: **Railway NPS Rules 2025 (G.S.R. 735(E))**; **AIS NPS Rules 2026 (G.S.R. 307(E))**; Railway UPS Rules 2026 [VERIFY]	Gazette (verified)
19	Old 2021-Rules era: VRS exit feared as 20:80 premature	Rule 12 VRS / FR 56(j)/(k) / SVRS = **60:40 superannuation exit** (OM 11.10.2024)	Rules 12(6), 13(1) (verified)
20	"Whichever is earlier" for Rule 4(9)	Rule 4(9) is "whichever is **LATER**" (first contribution); only Rule 23(2) claim uses "earlier"	Bare Rules (verified)

Rule of thumb for exams: if an option/answer cites ₹5L/₹2.5L slabs, ₹20L gratuity, age 70/75, Sec. 108 Evidence Act, 3-times partial withdrawal, skill-development purpose, or 10% Government contribution as "current", it is obsolete — pick the current value from this table.